European Commission

Study to support the stock-taking of the judicial training strategy for 2021-2024

Annexes

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ICF

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Annex 1 - Detailed intervention logic JTS

A detailed intervention logic has been developed as per the Better Regulation Toolbox (Tool #46) for the current JTS 2021-2024.[1] It provides an overview of how the policy intervention is expected to work and explains the causal mechanism through which an intervention is expected to bring the desired changes.

The intervention logic is composed of the following elements:

Need / rationale: This depicts the needs and rationale for the adoption of the JTS. Two specific needs were identified: (i) Creating common European judicial culture based on the principles of the rule of law, fundamental rights, legal certainty for the citizens and the independence of justice and (ii) Cultivating mutual trust among legal professionals and institutions to facilitate effective cross-border cooperation in civil and criminal law matters.

Objectives: The objectives are divided into a general objective and six specific objectives. Although the JTS does not have a specific section where the objectives are explicitly listed, the general objective is stipulated in the JTS as improving "justice professionals' training on EU law further, by extending policy intervention to new topics, professions and geographical areas, addressing the new challenges and setting new goals for 20212024". The specific objectives can be derived from each of the six focus areas (specific objectives – SO) of the JTS (sections 2 to 7), namely:

- SO1: Percentage of justice professionals that receive continuous training every year: 65% of judges, 15% of court staff, 15% of lawyers, 30% of notaries, 20% bailiffs, 5% judges on cross-border training activities.
- SO2: Improve other Justice professionals law training (prison staff, probation officers, mediators, court experts etc.).
- SO3: Improve the quality of training and provide effective training activities.

SO4: Improve knowledge of justice professionals on: rule of law, and fundamental rights; on new EU law and case law developments; non-legal knowledge and skills.

- SO5: Contribute to the upscaling of digital justice through training.
- SO6: Enhancing shared responsibility for training between Member States, training providers, national and European justice professions' organisations, and the EU.

The JTS's objectives are SMART as they have specific goals (e.g. enhancing EU law training), measurable targets in terms of number (see SO 1) and types of participants, achievable aims built on the 2011 strategy's successes, relevance to broader EU objectives through a focus on EU law training (see below), and time-bound strategies with set timelines, (e.g. 65% judges and prosecutors trained on EU law each year by 2024).

- **Inputs**: The inputs need to be differentiated between the European Commission, the Member States and the national and EU training providers receiving EU or national funding.
- **Outputs** are the immediate level and direct results of implementing the actions of the JTS. They also need to be differentiated between the European Commission, the Member States and the national and EU training providers receiving EU or national funding.

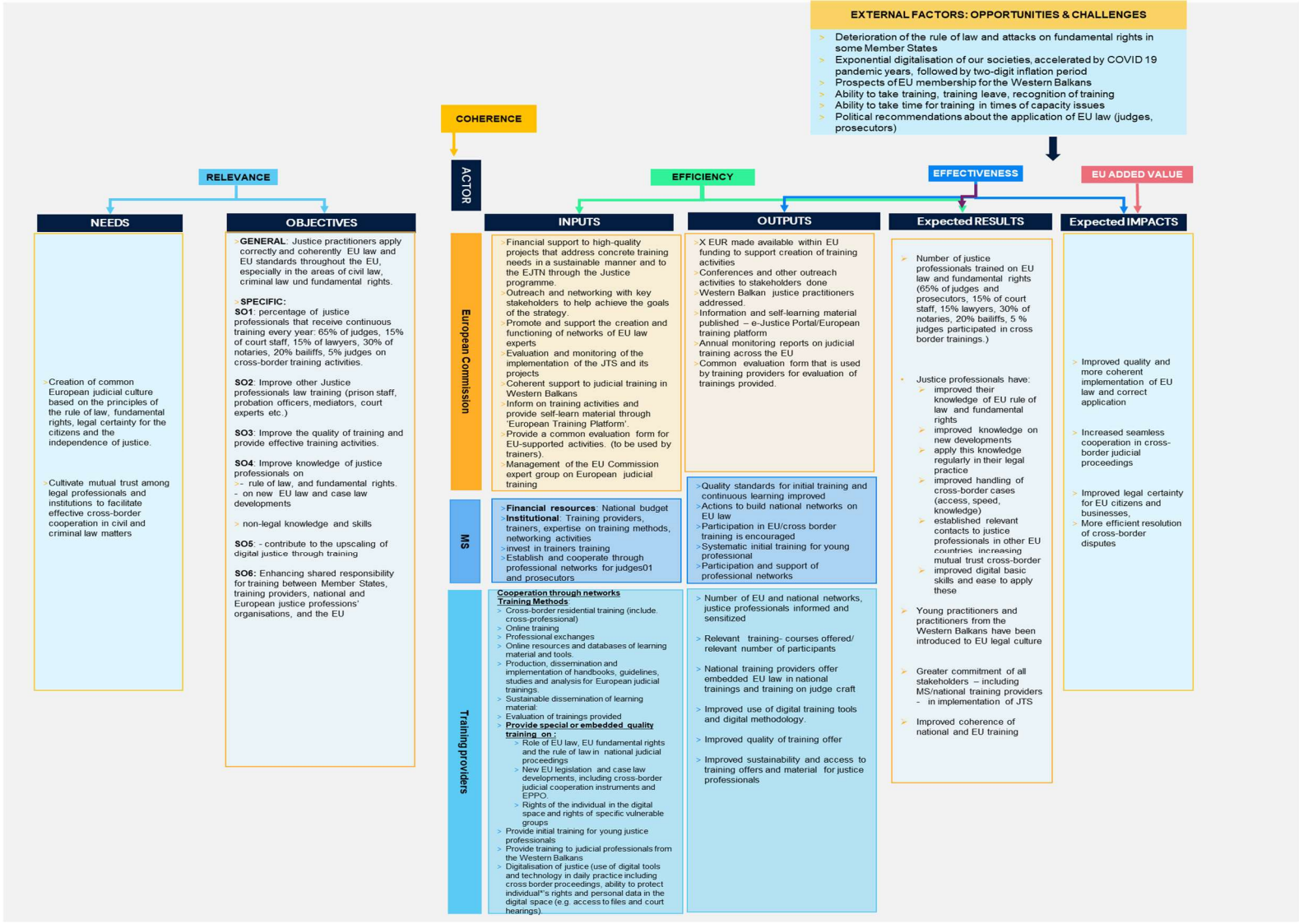
[1] Available at: https://commission.europa.eu/system/files/2023-09/BRT-2023-Chapter%206-How%20to%20carry%20out%20an%20evaluation%20and%20a%20fitness%20check_0.pdf

Expected results are the intermediate level results that correspond to the specific objectives. The JTS-defined expected results in that specific training targets for each group of justice professionals were set out for each year. The JTS also provided for specific learning achievements for justice professionals linked to the needs, such as improved knowledge of EU law and fundamental rights.

Expected impacts are the longer-term and more sustainable level results that correspond to the general objective. Four types of impacts can be expected from the JTS: (i) improved quality and more coherent implementation and correct application of EU law; (ii) increased seamless cooperation in cross-border judicial proceedings; (iii) improved legal certainty for EU citizens and businesses; (iv) more efficient resolution of cross-border disputes.

External factors: A number of external factors are at play in the period of evaluation which can affect the results of the JTS, including inter alia the deterioration of the rule of law and attacks on fundamental rights in some Member States; Covid-19, the war in Ukraine and EU sanctions towards Russia led to new training needs regarding crimes in armed conflicts and applications of the sanctions, the acceleration of the digitalisation of our societies; the ability of justice practitioners to take training time; and the prospects of EU membership for countries in the Western Balkans, as well as Ukraine and Moldova (in 2022) and Georgia (2023).

Figure 1. Intervention logic JTS



Annex 2 - Analytical framework

The following table provides an overview of the research questions used for this study and approach to collect evidence.

Table 1. Analytical framework stocktaking study JTS

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
Effectiveness (the extent to which the JTS has been successful in achieving its objectives)			
EQ1. How successful has the implementation of judicial training financed by the EU under the 2021-2024 JTS been in achieving (or progressing towards) the improvement of the knowledge about and the correct application and uniform interpretation of EU law?	The quantitative targets set in JTS on continuous training on EU law for specific justice professions were reached/are on track to be reached by 2024. The targets set by the JTS contributed to the achievement of its general and specific objectives. Judicial training financed by the EU under the 2021-2024 JTS has improved the correct application and uniform interpretation of EU law. There is evidence that EU law was systematically embedded in national training thanks to JTS. Training course content and material on EU law is relevant to any EU Member State (including as well EU candidate countries). Trained judicial practitioners played an important role in strengthening a rule of law culture and upholding the rule of law. The JTS has helped to increase the number of training activities and promoted new types of training activity, such as exchange programmes. Training for justice professionals was expanded into new topics.	<u>Quantitative indicators:</u> Overview of all training participants (EU and national) Contribution of EU financed training (distinguish between operational grant and action grants) number of participants trained in EU law by profession and by Member State/ Western Balkan countries: Share of judges and prosecutors who took part in continuous training on EU law (65%) Share of court and prosecution office staff who need EU law competence (15%) Share of lawyers who took part in continuous training on EU law (15%) Share of notaries who took part in continuous training on EU law target (30%) Share of bailiffs who took part in continuous training on EU law target (20%) Share of topics of training delivered broken down by EU law and non-EU law Share of participants in initial vs continuing training, and life-long learning activities (all training activities EU and national) <u>Average length of training</u>	Desk research Interviews Survey with national training institutes/ Ministries Focus group with trainers Baseline assessment Traffic light assessment

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
	Training for justice professionals on EU law was targeted to new professions. Training for justice professionals on EU law was targeted to new geographical areas – Western Balkans. Training for justice professionals on EU law addressed new challenges (e.g., protection of individuals' rights and personal data in the digital space, modi operandi of criminal groups, etc). JTS contributed to build capacity in application of EU law, such as by setting up national networks of EU law experts. Training for justice professionals was aligned with the developing EU law, incl. CJEU case law.	Number of cross-border training activities organised Number of visits of the European Training Portal Evidence that financed EU training has reached new target groups such as mediators, legal translators/ interpreters, train the trainers of judicial professionals. Qualitative indicators: evidence of progressing towards increased knowledge about and correction application and uniform interpretation of EU law <u>Opinion-based indicators:</u> Trainees' level of satisfaction and perceived level of acquisition of knowledge of EU law Evidence of relevance of training for target audience (survey results) Project managers/ trainers' views on recruitment was effective in ensuring that training was attended by those that would benefit most Trainees and trainers' views on factors explaining achievement/non-achievement of training targets Views from project managers/ trainees that programme was accessible to the target group (appropriate length to fit alongside participants abilities to take time for training; Trainee's views that trainers, content and materials for the training are of high quality;	

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
		Stakeholder views (training providers, trainers, training material, strategic level at MS) on the degree to training contributed to improvement of the knowledge about and the correct application and uniform interpretation of EU law; Trainees' views on their gained ability and confidence to handle cross-border cases; Stakeholder views on external/ country specific factors that contributed to achieving training targets for justice professionals.	
EQ 2 To what extent did EU financed training under the JTS had a real impact on improving the quality of knowledge on the correct application and uniform interpretation of EU law by judges', prosecutors' and judiciary staff?	Judgement criteria re linked to the four levels of the Kirkpatrick New World Model to show progress towards organisational impacts. These are: Level 1: Reaction Evidence of the training being relevant to the target groups Evidence of participants having the appropriate level of skills and experiences to get the most from the training Evidence of the training being delivered to a good quality Evidence of satisfaction for the training. Level 2: Learning	<u>Level 1: Reaction</u> Quantitative indicators: Number of attendees and drop-outs; Evidence where new geographical areas were targeted (e.g., Western Balkan, potential candidate countries Qualitative indicators: evaluation by Commission services on the original design of the project funded under the Justice programme of quality of training project – need assessment, learning content delineation, Opinion-based indicators: Participants' views on the training, including its relevance to their work and the quality of teaching, subjects knowledge of tutors, structure linked to course objectives, the degree to which the training received was interactive, practical and accessible <u>Level 2: Learning</u> Qualitative indicators: Evidence of improved understanding of EU law and how it can be applied in practice; Evidence of	Desk research Interviews with participants Interviews with project managers of training activities implemented under EU funds Experts EU courts Survey with national training institutes/ Ministries

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
	Evidence of increase knowledge in the core topics as a result of the programme Evidence of achievement of learning outcomes were met Evidence of knowledge change from peer learning and networking Evidence of the learning being disseminated by participants to their colleagues (understanding multipliers) Level 3: Behaviours Evidence of participants introducing changing their practice as a result of what they learnt from the programme, in relation to application of EU law, using digital tools and supporting a rule-of-law culture and protection of fundamental rights. Evidence of individuals introducing new processes or approaches an individual, team or organisational level as a result of what they learnt from the programme Evidence of their behaviour change influencing the behaviour of others Level 4: Results Identification of outcomes from any changes in practice on the role of their organisation, in relation to the objectives of the programme.	improved knowledge of typologies of new challenges that were addressed by EU law training; Evidence and examples that justice professionals are aware of new topics and challenges; Evidence of more consistent judgements at national level of EU law Qualitative indicator: evaluations implemented by training providers, evaluation of the progress by EU Commission services; quality of actual training content, quality of material, quality of trainers (background and qualifications) Opinion-based indicators: views on the extent to which they achieved the learning outcomes; topics that were most useful and why; topics that they already had a good understanding of prior to attending the programme. Views on improved understanding of EU law and how it can be applied in practice; on improved knowledge of typologies of new challenges that were addressed by EU law training; Evidence and examples that justice professionals are aware of new topics and challenges; <u>Level 3: Behaviours</u> Qualitative indicators: Identification of external factors that have positively or negatively affected the achievement of objectives (e.g., digitalisation, COVID-19, deterioration of the rule of law and attacks on fundamental rights in some Member States, etc); Opinion-based indicators: What changes participants have made to their work as a result of the programme, their	Focus groups trainers

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
	Identification of changes to the quality of work conducted Identification of changes in the efficiency of work Identification of changes to organisation practices	motivation, capacity and opportunity to implement change, changes they have made to organisational processes and procedures, how and to what extent they have disseminated what they learnt to colleagues. Views on external factors that have positively or negatively affected the achievement of objectives (e.g., digitalisation, COVID-19, deterioration of the rule of law and attacks on fundamental rights in some Member States, etc); <u>Level 4:Results</u> Qualitative indicators: Evidence on changes in national processes and guidance Opinion-based indicators: Participants views on organisational benefits arising from the training, as related to the programme priorities as well as improvements on their judgment, quality and efficiency: Stakeholder views on the degree of increased availability of new types of training formats (e.g., capsules, eLearning, etc) and how they contribute to inform about correct application of EU law in their daily practice;	
EQ 3. To what extent the coordination, support, monitoring and follow-up undertaken by the Commission	The Commission services provided effective coordination, support, monitoring and follow-up undertaken which contributed to the achievement of JTS objectives. During the period 2021-2024, JTS contributed to a greater commitment to the implementation of JTS from all concerned stakeholders.	<u>Quantitative indicators:</u> Amount of funding made available at EU level for training activities Number of meetings or events organised at EU level to support cooperation between stakeholders to help achieve the goals of the JTS	Desk research Interviews with project managers Survey with national training institutes/ Ministry

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
was helpful to achieve the objectives (general/ specific) of the JTS?	European Commission encouraged the participation of justice professionals from the Western Balkans and newly targeted groups of justice professionals such as prison and probation officers, mediators, judicial interpreters and translators, train-the trainers experts.. Information on availability of EUlevel training provision is proactively disseminated by the Commission	Number of stakeholders that participated in EU events/ support used provided by the Commission Number of activities in place for monitoring purposes Number of news items published on the e-justice platform about training activities; Number of activities targeted to justice professionals from Western Ballans and newly targeted groups such as prison and probation officers, mediators, judicial interpreters and translators, train-the-trainer experts; <u>Qualitative indicators:</u> Evidence and examples of the quality of reporting and monitoring of the training activities implemented under JTS by the Commission <u>Opinion-based indicators:</u> Stakeholder views on the extent to which Commission services provided effective coordination, support, monitoring and follow-up Stakeholder views on factors that are facilitating or hindering enhanced shared responsibility to achieve the goals of the JTS amongst all relevant stakeholders Stakeholders' views on additional support by the Commission	Focus group with trainers Traffic light assessment
EQ 4 Digitalisation: To what extent did the actions under the 2021-2024 JTS contribute to upscaling the digitalisation of justice?			

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
EQ4.1. To what extent have training activities delivered and financed by the EU supported the digitalisation process in justice, including facilitating cross-border exchanges online?	Digitalisation process in justice was supported across training activities delivered . Due to training delivered justice professionals use more digital tools in their daily practice to handle their work. Due to training delivered justice professionals gained more awareness about digital tools, their impact in society and potential cases, and obtained digital literacy skills. Justice practitioners are more ready to use digital tools and technologies properly in daily practice, including in cross-border proceedings. The delivered training promoted the efficient use of digitalised judicial procedures and registers.	<u>Quantitative indicators:</u> Estimation of the share of training delivered which covered upskilling of digital literacy competences for justice professionals Estimation of the share of training delivered covering topics which dealt with improving use of digital tools and AI (e.g. impact that digital tools and technologies have on handled cases) facilitating the work of justice professionals Quantitative evidence/ proxy estimation of the level of use digital tools and technologies of justice practitioners prior to and after training received Degree of exchanges/cooperation in a digitalised form between justice authorities who have been working better between professionals trained under the JTS Qualitative indicators: evidence on increased us of digital processes in cross-border justice cases, national digitalisation processes used in justice systems. <u>Opinion-based indicators:</u> Stakeholder views on whether the JTS sufficiently covered the digital dimension of specific training areas (Participant's views on whether the delivered training contributed to facilitate and improve the process of digitalisation of the national judiciaries, as well as cross-border exchanges	Desk research Interviews with Survey Panel with trainers Baseline assessment Traffic light assessment

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
		Stakeholder views on whether the digital dimension was sufficiently covered in practice (enabling trainees to use the tools) in the training delivered (being systematically included across all types of training) Stakeholders views on what could be improved or what was missing with regard to judicial training on digitalisation.	
EQ4.2. To what extent have training activities delivered and financed by EU funds raised awareness of artificial intelligence and new modus operandi of criminals?	Training on new legal instruments relating to new modus operandi and criminal digital acts was included in EU level training addressing the specific objectives of the JTS	<u>Quantitative indicators:</u> Estimation of the share of training delivered addressing the challenges due to digitalisation, and new legislation dealing with these, e.g. modus operandi of criminals online, <u>Qualitative indicators:</u> Examples of digital and artificial intelligence tools and technologies covered during training Examples of artificial intelligence tools used in justice systems <u>Opinion-based indicators:</u> Participants' feedback on their improved awareness of digital tools and AI use for their professional purposes Training participants feedback to what extent the training offer provided at national level and EU financed training is coherent/ complementary	Desk research Interviews Survey Panel with trainers Traffic light assessment
Relevance (the extent to which the JTS successfully addressed the needs and problems of the target groups)			

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
Q5. Needs and challenges of justice professionals: To what extent was the acquired knowledge in EU funded training practically relevant for judges and prosecutors?	Training financed by the EU and supported by JTS was relevant in addressing the needs and challenges of judges and prosecutors in their daily work. The JTS supported EU law training for justice practitioners in accordance with their needs.	Qualitative indicators: Identification of practical examples how training supported judges and prosecutors in applying EU law in their daily work Evidence that EU funded training reflects EU policy priorities and recently adopted EU law Opinion-based indicators: Participant's views on whether their needs are met by the training funded by the EU Participants' views to what extent the knowledge gained in EU financed training was relevant to their daily work Participants' views on factors hindering the application of the knowledge gained in their daily work	Desk research Interviews with participants Survey with national training institutes/ Ministries
Q 6 Digitalisation: Which learning needs emerged with regard to the digitalisation of justice? How can EU training support learning needs?	(not an evaluation question)	Indications of judges and prosecutors needs with regard to basic digital skills in the process of digitalisation of justice Indication where EU could provide most support (desk research) Stakeholders' views on the type of training that is currently missing and what type of training could be funded by the EU Stakeholders' views on how these new skills could be best acquired, what type of training/ format would be required	Interviews with participants and project managers/ professional organisations Focus groups trainers Survey with national training institutes/ Ministries

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
Coherence			
Q7. Internal coherence: To what extent are the various elements of the JTS (pay also attention to differences in the quality or target groups of training based on operating grants, training based on action grants, procurement, other Commission support) coherent with one another and complementary rather than overlapping?	The elements of the JTS worked well together and between themselves. The different objectives of the JTS worked well together in synergy. There was no evidence of contradictions between the various elements of the JTS. There was no evidence of overlaps between the various elements of the JTS	<u>Qualitative indicators:</u> Evidence that the different objectives of the JTS worked well together in synergy Indications of contradictions or overlaps between the different objectives of the JTS, internally and vis-à-vis each other Indications that one funding form (e.g. operating grants) worked better than the other (e.g. training funded by action grants) <u>Opinion-based indicators:</u> Stakeholder views on the existence of any overlaps, gaps or contradictions	Desk research Interviews Survey with national training institutes/ Ministries Interviews with participants (effectiveness)

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
Q8. External coherence: To what extent is training financed under EU programmes and nationally financed coherent and fits with EU strategic goals?	The training financed with EU support is coherent with the JTS . The training financed with EU support is coherent with the EU's strategic goals. The training financed with EU support under JTS is coherent with nationally financed programmes with similar objectives. There was no evidence of contradictions or overlaps between EU and nationally financed programmes with similar objectives.	Quantitative indicators Overview of training activities implemented via Justice programme vs other EU support programmes for training activities. Qualitative indicators: Indications of contradictions or overlaps of the training financed under other EU programmes (than Justice programme) with the JTS Opinion-based indicators: Stakeholder views on the degree to which JTS is coherent and complementary to other EU and nationally financed programmes with similar objectives	Evaluation of the Justice programme (if available within the timeline of this study) Desk research Interviews Survey with national training institutes/ Ministries
Efficiency			
Q9. To what extent are training activities sustainable once implemented in terms of achieving value for money beyond the financed EU	Behaviour change created through the training programme continues to be applied after participation. Learning from the programme on EU law remains relevant to country needs Training materials continue to be accessed and used after the end of the training .Online training continues to be available beyond the financed intervention	Qualitative indicators: Overview of activities undertaken to promote and widen accessibility to online materials and training Evidence and examples that show that training content and material on EU law and justice professional skills remains relevant Evidence of training materials being shared on the European Training Platform and used	Evaluation of the Justice programme (if available within the timeline of this study) Baseline assessment Desk research

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
intervention? Is there a difference between type of grant? To what extent does the latter influence the costs and benefits?	Professional networks and cross-border connections created through the programme continue to be used for professional purposes after the training Participants continue to seek out training to address knowledge gaps on EU law and digitalisation of justice after the programme	Evidence that changes that were made through the programme will continue after the funding period Evidence of activities undertaken to maintaining cross-border networks after the programme. Online training is uploaded to the European Judicial Training Platform Evidence of additional training undertaken by participants after they left the programme to build on gained knowledge and practice a learning culture. <u>Opinion-based indicators:</u> Participants views on how they used connections made after the training in their professional work/ daily work Training providers views to what extent they made use of newly developed training content and material financed by the Justice programme in their national training modules Participants views to what extent the knowledge on EU law through training is still applied in their daily work Trainers views to what extent their expertise from an EU financed training is recognised in follow-up/ or other EU training formats, national formats Training participant and participant views on the take-up and interest in programme materials and online learning after the programme	Interviews Survey

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
		Participant interest in undertaking further training on EU Law and digitalisation of justice	
Q10. How efficient is the governance and coordination structure of the JTS? Is there a potential for simplification and cost reduction?	The roles of different stakeholders and actors in the implementation and monitoring of the JTS are clearly delineated and complementary. Reporting and monitoring of JTS are time efficient and resource appropriate. Call for proposals (action grants) procedures are efficient and produce timely results. Timeframes and resources allocated for monitoring and reporting are clearly spelled out. There is no evidence of inefficiencies in the delivery of the objectives and targets of the JTS	Qualitative indicators: Overview of governance and coordination tasks and activities by stakeholder type Evidence of resources and timeframes allocated per stakeholder involved (Commission, Member States, training providers) Opinion-based indicators: Stakeholder views on room for improvement in the governance and coordination structure of the JTS	Evaluation of the Justice programme (if available within the timeline of this study) Baseline assessment Desk research Interviews Survey with national training institutes/ Ministries
EU added value			
Q11 What is the EU added value delivered by the JTS and its implementation, over and above what could reasonably have	The positive results could not have been achieved through national interventions alone without the JTS. JTS provides knowledge and expertise that could not be delivered through the same scale or quality at a national level There are clear benefits from EU level action through the JTS.	Qualitative indicators: Evidence that training is complementary to national training offer The JTS-training goals are also implemented by national training, sharing of competences and resources between EU and national level.	Baseline assessment Desk research Interviews Survey with national training

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
been expected from national interventions in the Member States alone?		Typology of benefits from EU level action through specific training formats, which training activity most beneficial at EU level <u>Opinion-based indicators:</u> Stakeholder views on whether Member States could have achieved the same results through national interventions only Stakeholder views about which training activity is best organised at EU level to understand correct application of EU law	institutes/ Ministries
Q12. What type of training activities provided for the best multiplier effect?	Wider reach of training activities due to the sharing of information by participants to other relevant individuals in national justice systems Evidence of training formats achieving the best value for training in multiplying its reach (participants that disseminate learning) Professional networks created through JTS extend their reach to include non-participants. Training content on EU law and digitalisation of justice incorporated in national training or other training not funded through JTS Learning from the programme disseminated to individuals working in the justice sector that did not participate in the programme	Qualitative indicators: Identification of the training formats that achieve the best multiplying effect – in terms of numbers of people within justice systems which have accessed training materials and resources Evidence that participants share their knowledge gained in training activities with their peers Examples and evidence that professional networks have grown Opinion-based indicators: Participants' views on the training activities that is of most interest to their country	Desk research Interviews Focus group trainers Survey with national training institutes/ Ministries

Questions/ Sub-Questions	Judgement criteria	Indicators	Data collection tools and methods
	Improved prioritisation of training on EU law and digitalisation of justice within national authorities Training activities increase capacity of developing training programmes at national level and among trainers	Participant views on whether they disseminated training content/ material to other professionals in their workplace Trainer views on the extent to which they have incorporated (better: reused?) elements of the training activities in other training programmes Participant/trainer views on the training activities that have been most widely accessed by individuals working in national justice systems Training institutes views about specific EU law information networks (at national level) and their reach to judges and prosecutors at national level Training institutes views about specific EU training content and material integrated into national training modules	

Annex 3 - Methodology

We present the methodological approach first, followed by remarks on data limitations.

3.1 General methodological approach

The main elements of the methodology are the inception phase including exploratory interviews with key EU level stakeholders, and an initial literature search and review. The fieldwork phase which consisted of conducting the qualitative interviews, implementation of the ICF survey to training providers for judges, prosecutors and court and prosecution staff (EJTN members in EU 27 Member States only), and detailed review and extraction of project data from the justice programme, desk review of other EU fund material, research about national level training providers and topics (however this was not a systematically implemented research and was done to cross-check some information from survey responses); as well as material from EU level training providers (including training material produced) and materials uploaded on the ETP, academic literature in link to EU law training. The final phase consisted of analysing all evidence collected and triangulating the information to develop answers to the research questions as set out in the analytical framework (Annex 2). The following provides a more detailed overview about the evidence collection.

Inception interviews

Table 2. Inception phase's interviews

Number of interviews	Objectives	Organisations
19	Evaluating stakeholder willingness to share detailed information on the effect of training activities and their collaboration in reaching out to training participants and trainers; providing substantial information about the context of the JTS and related training activities	JUST (several departments), EMPL, CoE,(CEPEJ and HELP), CEPOL, EIPA, EJTN, ERA, EPTA, CNUE, CCBE, ELF

Qualitative interviews

Table 3. Fieldwork interviews

Number of interviews	Type of professional	Description
4	Trainers	Interviews with trainers involved in EJTN and JTRA training activities
4	Project managers	Interviews with trainers involved in JTRA training activities
35	Judges and prosecutors	30'-1hour interviews with judges and prosecutors who participated to JTRA (n=29) and EJTN (n=6) activities
7	Court staff	30'-1hour interviews with court staffs who participated to JTRA activities (CSAB project)
3	Bailiffs	30'-1hour interviews with court staffs who participated to JTRA activities

10	National penitentiary training institutes' experts	Focus group
3	Researchers	30'-1 hour interviews with researchers who published on the theme and/or were involved in key research projects on judicial training

ICF Survey

Table 4. ICF survey

Number of responses	Number of questions	Respondents
20	39	Representatives of national training institutes for judges, prosecutors, and court staff

Analysis of project data

Qualitative analysis of projects

We consulted JTRA book of abstracts (including abstracts of non-funded projects), CERV 2021 and 2022 project data, JACC 2021 and 2022 project information (abstracts, proposal, funding), and reports of around 10 JTRA projects (mid-term or final report evaluations from the Commission). We also read in depth all JTRA project applications from 2018 until 2024 (although excluded the year 2024 as the process for finalisation of the contracts was still on-going) and all EJTN technical reports from 2018 until 2023 and Commission evaluations. We also provided supplementary questions to the Commission ESF+ central desk about the training activities implemented at national level. These were circulated to the Commission's country desk which inquired about these. However, only limited information was made available. We studied also the Erasmus+ operational grant applications from ERA and EIPA, as well as technical reports from ERA and EIPA for years 2021-2023. Additional information has been received from ERA about projects implemented via other EU funding such as the training on competition law under the SMA.

Quantitative analysis of projects

We manually coded Part C data for all JTRA funded projects from 2018 until 2023, as well as some project proposal data (topics, professions of participants, geographic scope of projects, beneficiaries) and some financial data from the project portal. We also manually coded EJTN technical report data from 2018 until 2023, as well as data from the EJTN calendar.

3.2 Limitations

Interviews and focus groups that could not be conducted

An important limitation was accessing participants of training activities funded by other EU instruments than the justice programme. Only ERA shared information on a project implemented under a FISMA tender (incl. anonymous evaluation forms of two courses) and organised access to some of these participants willing to be contacted.

Participants of EJTN training courses could also not be selected by the study team. A small sample of contacts was provided by the EJTN. Participants of exchanges were not included in the sample as the focus was on training courses provided by the EJTN. Overall, we could not interview a sufficiently large sample of participants in EJTN

activities. Interview replies were triangulated then with the first level feedback from participants in Commission technical reports (anonymised).

For JTRA training activities, the Commission gave the study team access to survey respondents who agreed to be contacted. However, responses from participants in JTRA-funded training were inconsistent. Consequently, the study team relied heavily on training providers to reach participants, which was only minimally effective.

It is in not possible to determine to what extent a selection bias occurred for participant interviews. Perhaps, none because those training providers sharing access to participants may have had also only contacts agreeing in evaluation forms to be kept in a database and contacted for evaluation purposes.

We have reached out to 10 of the project managers of JTRA beneficiaries whose projects closed in the first half of the year 2024. Some of the project managers did not reply at all and others had left already the beneficiary meaning that other colleagues could only provide limited information about the training activities, as often these were not yet employed by these beneficiaries.

The initial approach of this study foresaw to implement two focus groups with trainers. However, we did not achieve to get access to a sufficient number of trainers (JTRA grants or EJTN) for this activity. Hence, it was decided to interview those that shared the contact details with the study team. On the other hand, the training institutes for prison and probation officers (members of the EPTA/Europris) felt that responding to a survey would be too burdensome in terms of timing. It was decided to launch a call among directors to participate in a focus group. It was clear that this would not provide the study team with a sufficient detailed insight to training on EU law issues integrated in training at national level but it enabled the study team to get a bit more details on the training priorities and capacity to make use of EU funding instruments to provide cross-border training activities.

Finally, we reached out to additional EU level professional networks such as the UEHJ but did not receive replies. It was also not possible to get in touch with proposal managers from organisations that were not successful in their application to JTRA calls.

Projects that are still open and could not be analysed

A high share of projects (12 projects had an end date during the contract period of the study in 2024 out of 17 ending in 2024 from the JTRA batches or project 2021 and 2022 of the total 32 projects implemented in 2021-2023) were still in the implementation phase. For these, no report could be reviewed regarding the success of the implementation or possible information about the actual participants and their satisfaction. It also needs to be kept in mind that effectively the implementation of projects started only as of 2022 for projects selected in 2021 (JTRA). There is an overall delay of one year for JTRA activities compared to monitoring of information for EJTN activities. The planning of activities for EJTN starts usually one year ahead. Post project year, the EJTN has complete information after 2-3 months available. JTRA projects only report about full results more in detail in their final technical reports, typically after two years of implementation. The mid-term reports focus more on the actual implementation and progress of the project hence information not directly related to the achievements of the training activities. It was also noted that final technical reports do not provide always an analysis of characteristics of participants (profession, member state, seniority etc), as well as evaluation results of training activities.

For a high share of training activities implemented via other EU instruments (other than the justice programme) it was not possible to access proposal information or technical reports.

Annex 4 - Quantitative data

We present JTRA and EJTN data that were manually extracted and coded in the framework of this study.

4.1 JTRA

Data manually extracted from Part C and JTRA proposals.

All the data presented below concern data on project activities within the corresponding JTRA projects.

Project characteristics

Figure 2. Yearly evolution of (awarded) projects 2018-2023

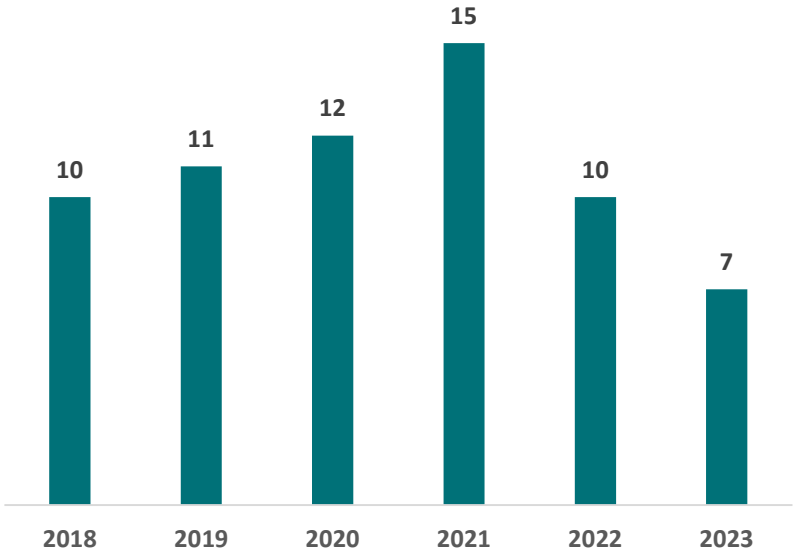


Figure 3. Project topics 2021-2023

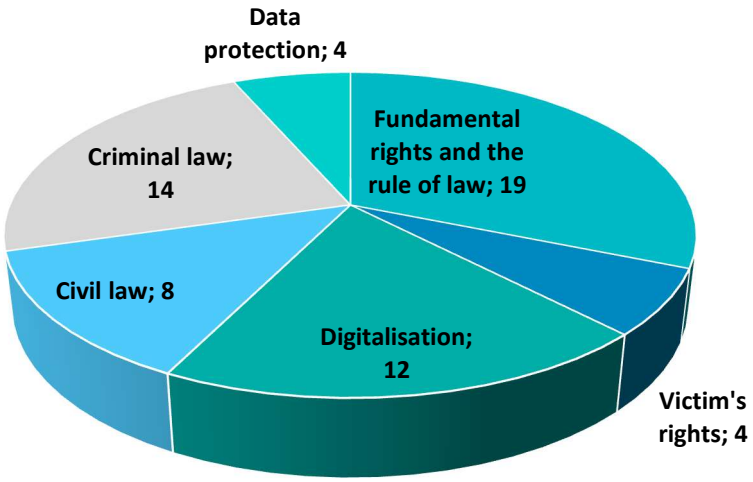
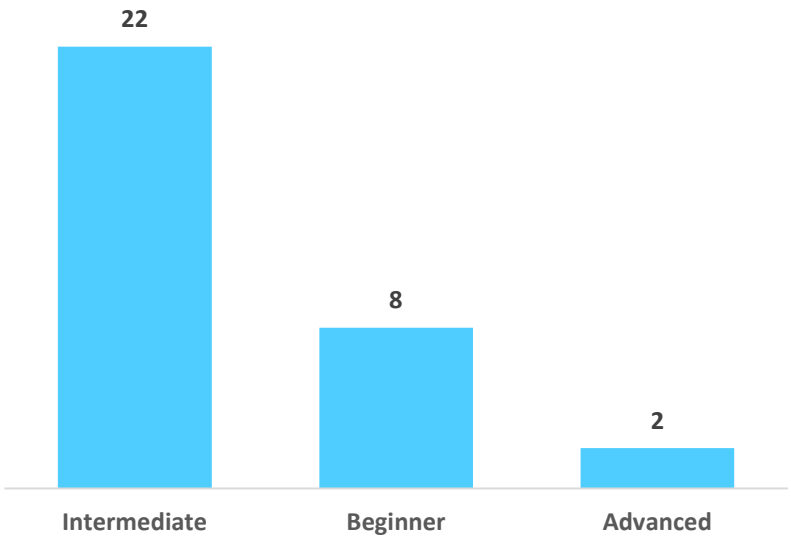


Figure 4. Project level 2021-2023



Funding information

Table 5. Funding information (2021-2023)

Funding information	Amount
Requested grants	EUR 14 858 695
EU contribution	EUR 14 586 302
% of EU contribution	98%

Average EY contribution per participant	EUR 1 457

Figure 5. Yearly evolution of Requested grants 2018-2023

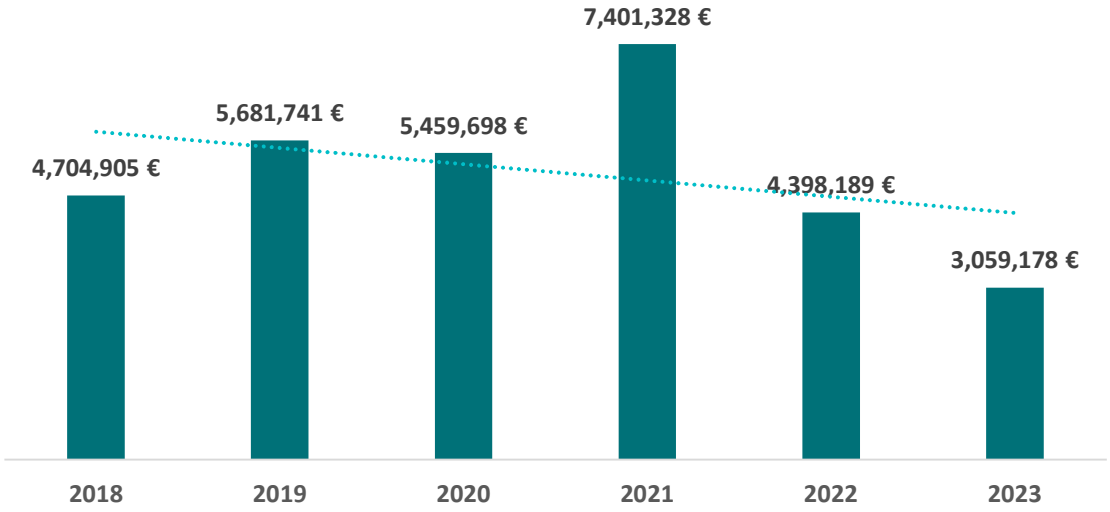


Figure 6. Yearly evolution of EU contribution 2018-2023

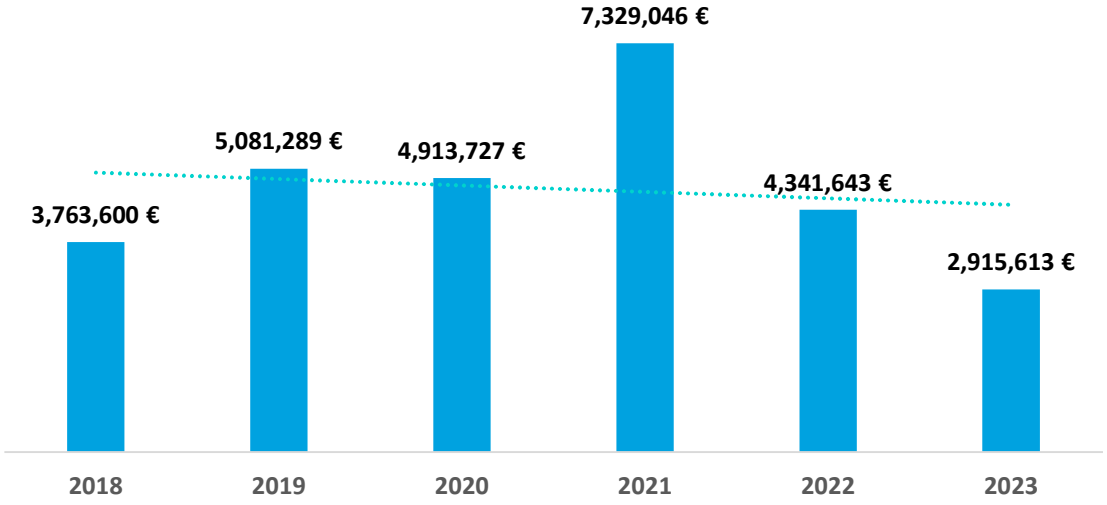
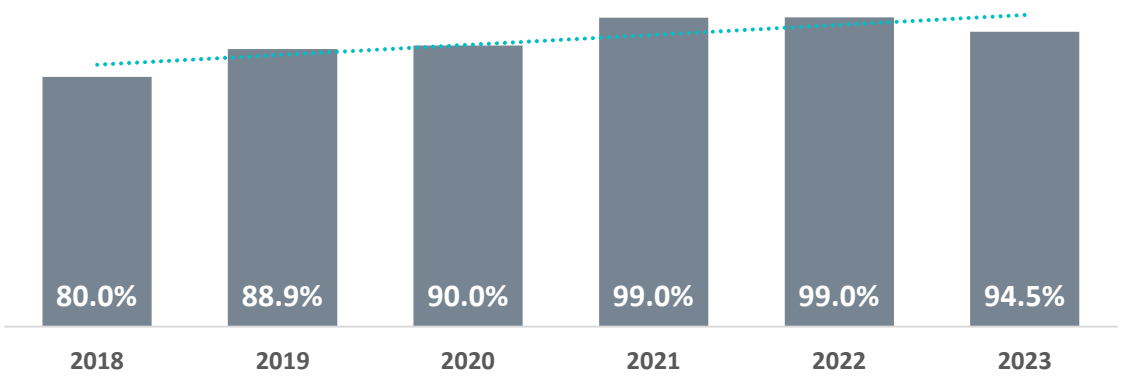


Figure 7. Yearly evolution of EU contribution (in %) 2018-2023



Coordinator and partners information

Figure 8. Coordinator's country (2021-2023)

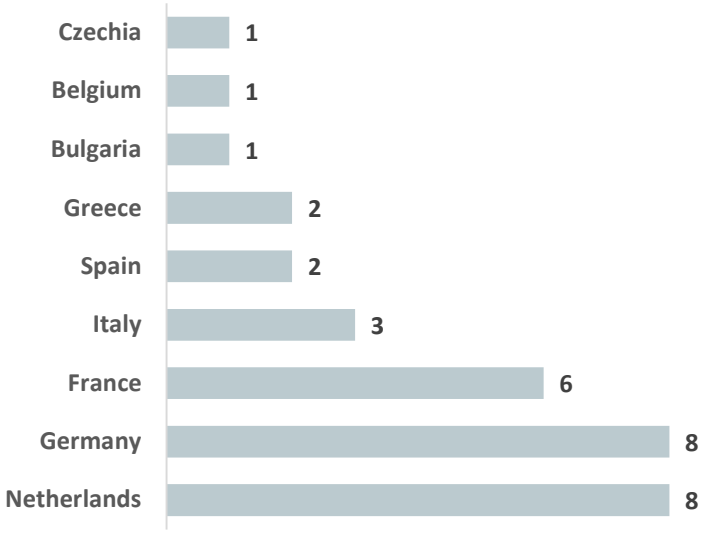


Figure 9. Type of coordinator (2021-2023)

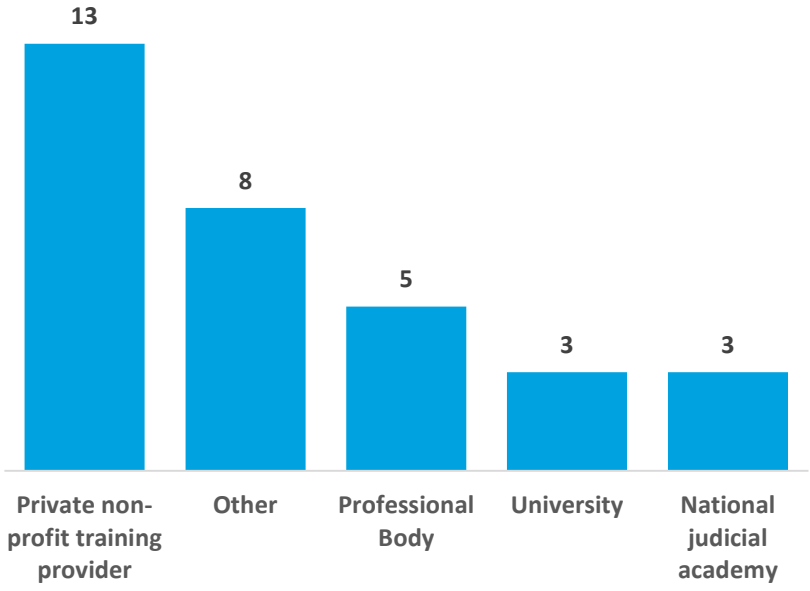
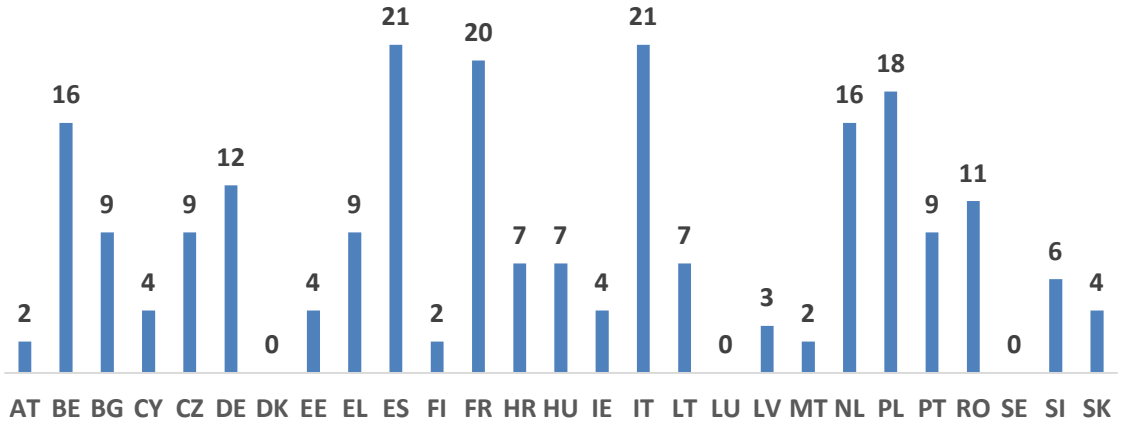


Figure 10. Coordinator and partners' countries (2021-2023)



Dates information

Figure 11. Number of projects per start date (2021-2023)

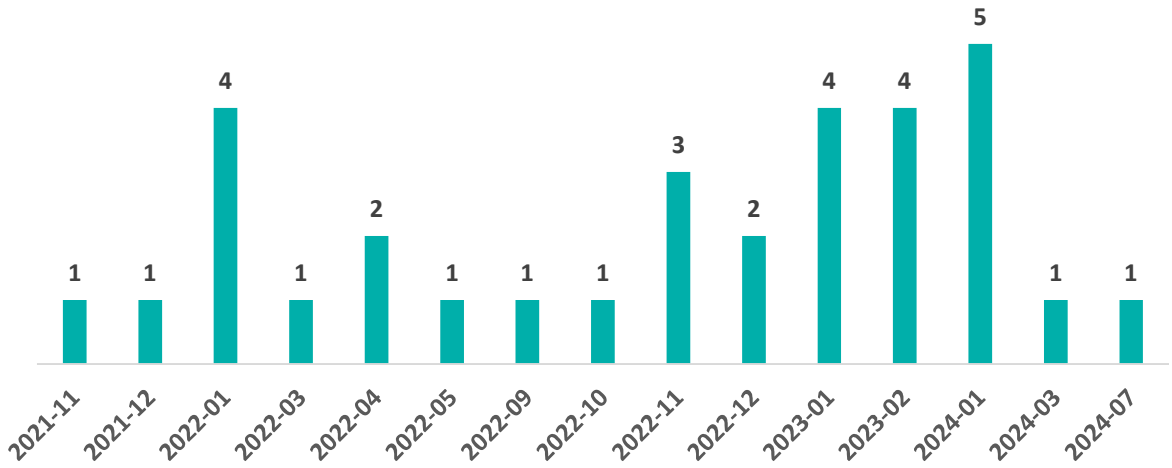
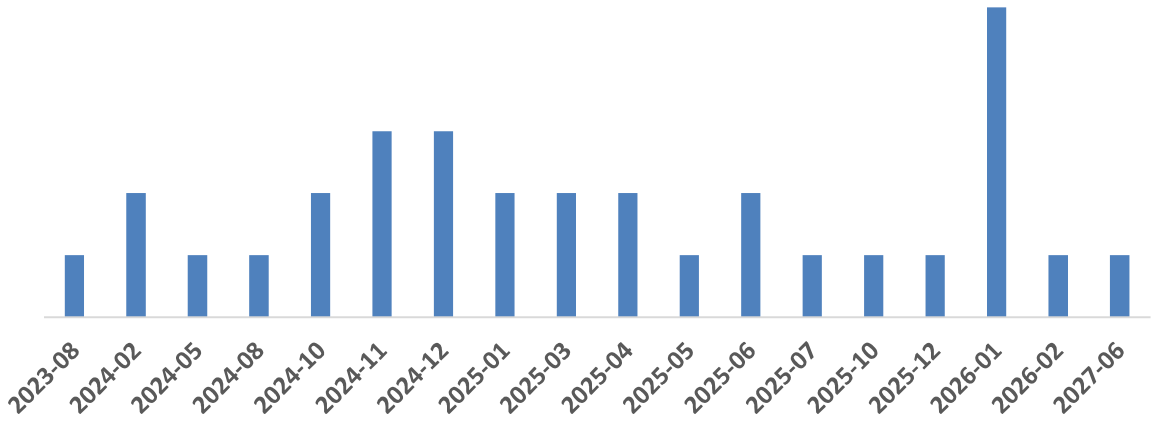


Figure 12. Number of project per end date (2021-2023)



Participation information

Average participants per projects (2021-2023): 956.

Figure 13. Participants per quantity of professional groups (2021-2023)

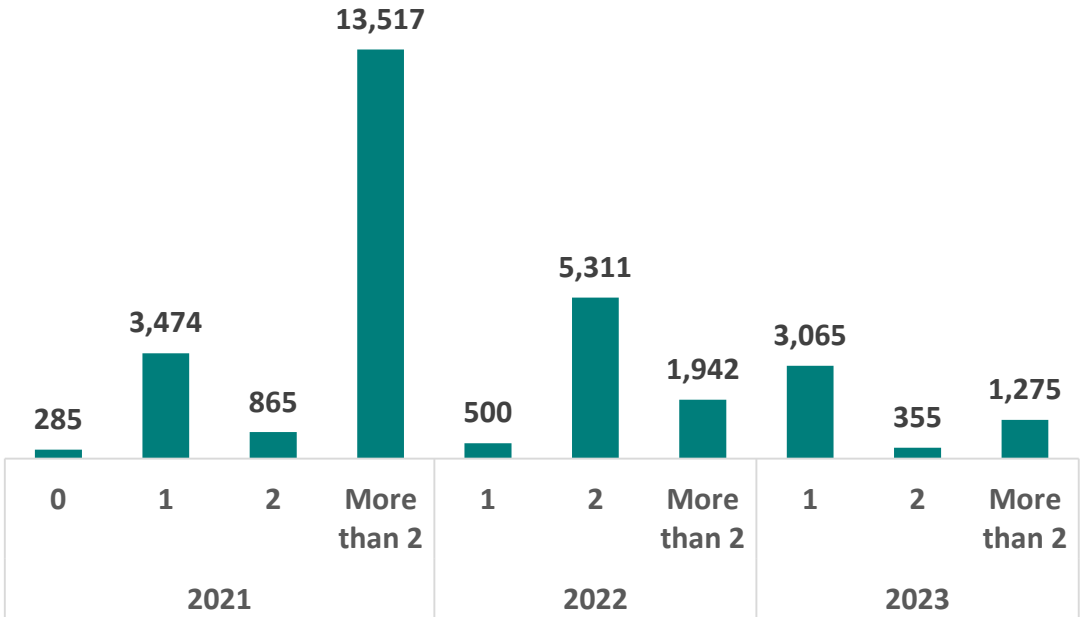


Figure 14. Evolution of participants 2018-2023

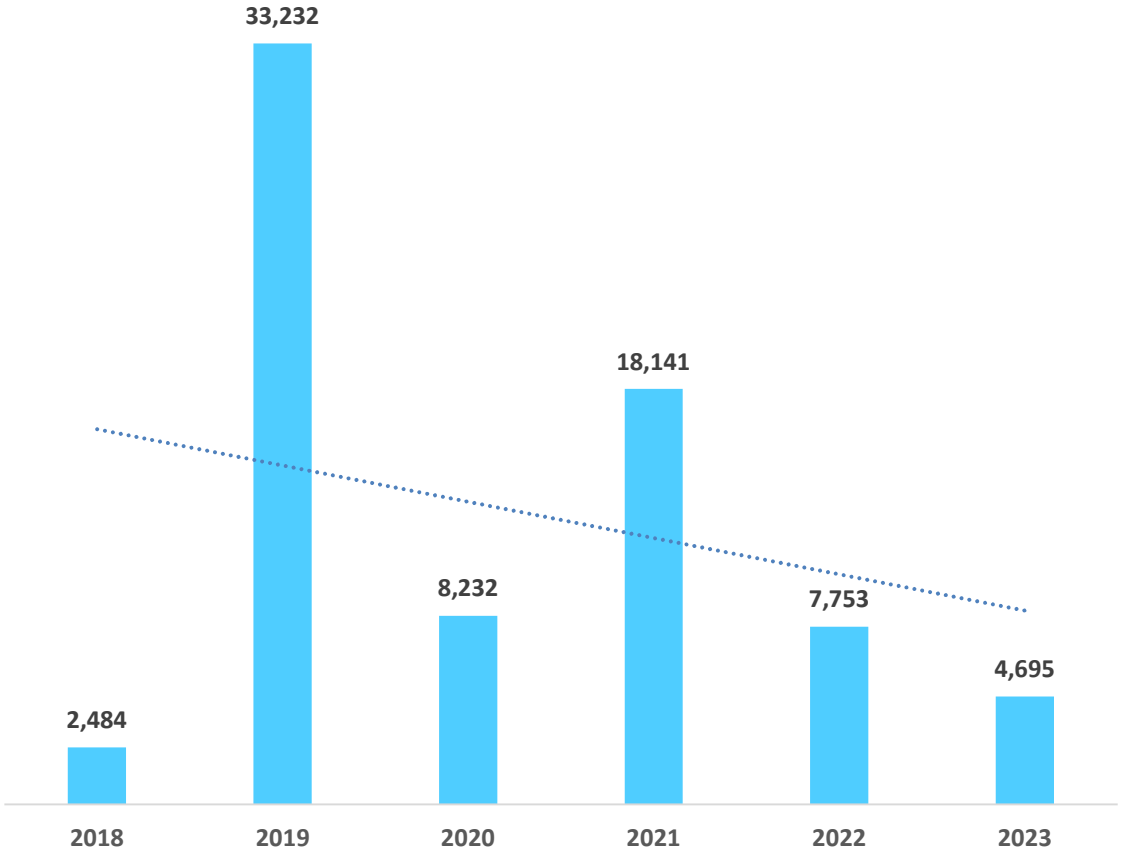


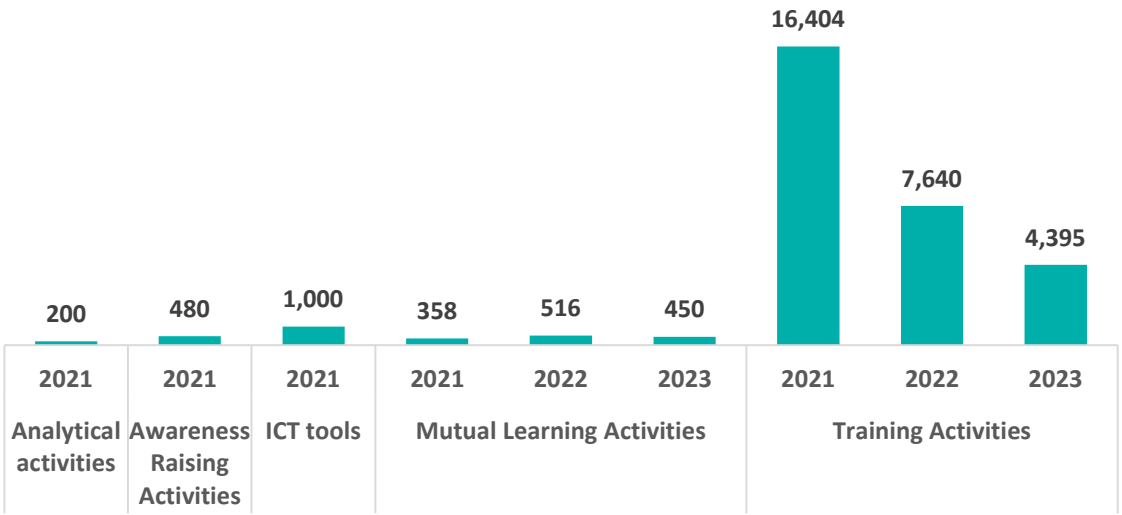
Table 6. Combination of types of participants 2021-2023

Professionals	Number of projects	Total participants	Participants/Project
Court Staffs, Bailiffs	*1*	*548*	*548*
Judges	*1*	*300*	*300*
Judges, Bailiffs, Other	*1*	*750*	*750*
Judges, Lawyers, Court Staffs, Trainers, Bailiffs	*1*	*565*	*565*
Judges, Lawyers, Prosecutors	*3*	*1110*	*365*
Judges, Lawyers, Prosecutors, Court Staffs	*1*	*200*	*200*
Judges, Lawyers, Prosecutors, Court Staffs, Bailiffs	*1*	*490*	*490*
Judges, Lawyers, Prosecutors, Court Staffs, Other	*1*	*260*	*260*
Judges, Lawyers, Prosecutors, Court Staffs, Trainers, Other	*1*	*230*	*230*
Judges, Lawyers, Prosecutors, Trainers	*3*	*12230*	*1596*
Judges, Lawyers, Trainers	*1*	*457*	*457*
Judges, Prosecutors	*2*	*530*	*265*
Judges, Trainers	*1*	*265*	*265*
Lawyers	*7*	*6359*	*1380*
Lawyers, Trainers	*3*	*5188*	*1987*
No categorised	*1*	*285*	*285*
Notaries	*1*	*300*	*300*
Other	*1*	*80*	*80*
Trainers, Bailiffs, Other	*1*	*442*	*442*

Figure 15. Regions of targeted participants 2021-2023



Participants per type of activity 2021-2023



List of projects (2021-2023)

Project	Activity Name	Participants
TRAVAR	Webinar on the EU Charter	250
TRAVAR	Webinar on Artificial Intelligence for lawyers	250
TRAVAR	Webinar on Intellectual Property (basic)	250
TRAVAR	Webinar on Intellectual Property (advance d)	250
TRAVAR	Webinar on Digitalisation	250
TRAVAR	Webinar on the Unified Patent Court	250
TRAVAR	Webinar on climate change for lawyers	250
TRAVAR	Webinar on preliminary reference procedures before the CJEU	250

TRAVAR	Seminar in 3 procedural rights Directives Budapest	30
TRAVAR	Seminar in 3 procedural rights Directives Nicosia	30
TRAVAR	Seminar in 3 procedural rights Directives Athens	29
TRAVAR	Seminar in 3 procedural rights Directives Paris	29
TRAVAR	Seminar in 3 procedural rights Directives Bucharest	29
TRAVAR	Seminar in 3 procedural rights Directives Warsaw	29
TRAVAR	Seminar in 3 procedural rights Directives Madrid	29
eFilit	elearning module 1-6	180
eFilit	Tutorial 1: English Legal Terminology on EU judicial cooperation in civil, commercial and family matters	35
eFilit	Tutorial 1: English Legal Terminology on EU judicial cooperation in civil, commercial and family matters	35
eFilit	Online training of trainers' seminar 1: EU judicial cooperation in civil matters and available EU level digital tools.	35
eFilit	Online training of trainers' seminar 2: EU judicial cooperation in commerc ial matters and available EU level digital tools	35
eFilit	Online training of trainers' seminar 3: EU judicial cooperation in family matters and available EU level digital tools	35
eFilit	Face-to- face inter-professional Conference 1: Jurisdicti on, recognition and enforcement of judgment s in civil and commercial matters in the European Union	35
eFilit	Face-to- face inter-professional Conference 2: Monetary claims and securing assets	35
eFilit	Face-to- face inter-professional Conference 2: Monetary claims and securing assets	35
eFilit	Face-to- face inter-professional Conference 4: Cross- border parental responsi bility cases	35
eFilit	Face-to- face Inter-professional Conference 5: Cross- border child abduction	35
eFilit	Face-to- face inter-professional Conference 6: Cross- border maintenance claims	35
Training for defence	Pan-European seminars “European criminal justice for defence lawyers”	300

Training for defence	Webinars “Key issues in European criminal justice for defence lawyers”	150
Training for defence	Conference “Protection of legal privilege in criminal proceedings in the EU” and Seminar “The role of the CJEU for defence lawyers”	110
Digitalisation AI	Seminars	480
EU-BALTIC	Seminars	165
EU-BALTIC	Study visit	40
EU-BALTIC	Webinars	150
ELAN II	2 Succesions seminar	100
ELAN II	3 AML Seminars	150
ELAN II	Cross-border enforcement seminar	50
JUST CHILD	Seminar 1	70
JUST CHILD	Seminar 2	70
JUST CHILD	Conference	90
VotC	Internationall Conference	75
VotC	Video & training manual	75
LITEL	Training materials on EU law	2,352
LITEL	Study visits	13
LITEL	Training materials on EU law	2,352
PACE	Transnational Train- the-Trainers workshops	52
PACE	Transnational synchronous training webinars	300
PACE	Asynchronous e-courses	60
PACE	Transnational roundtables	30
REUNION	Focus Groups for solutions mapping towards offender rehabilitation	48
REUNION	Cross-ambience working group seminars	85
REUNION	Final International Conference	70
REUNION	Train-the-trainer course for sustainability	80
REUNION	E- learning course on effective application of FD 909	120
EU COE RoL FRights	Cross-border seminars /study visits for multipliers (4 events of 1.5 days duration)	200
EU COE RoL FRights	Cross-border Training of Trainers (ToT) workshops (2 events of 1.5 days duration)	40
EU COE RoL FRights	Cross-border Training of Trainers (ToT) workshops (2 events of 1.5 days duration)	40

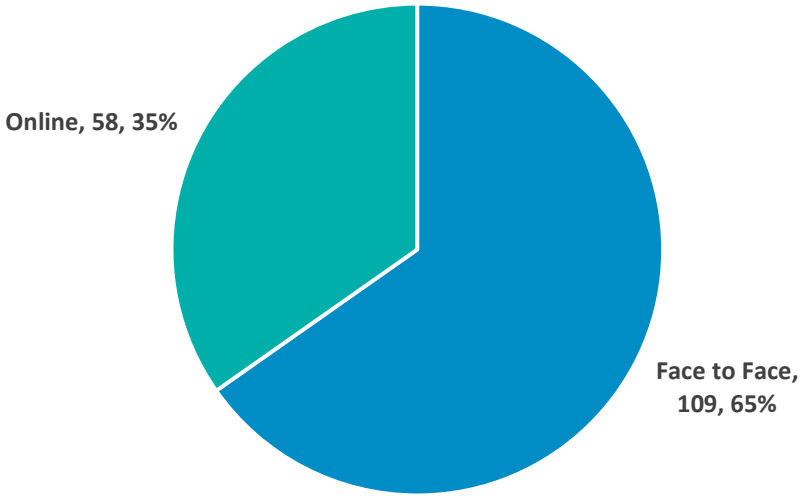
EU COE RoL FRights	Cross-professional implementation of existing HELP courses related to the Call topics (20 implementations of approx. 24 hrs of learning each)	500
Intl Jud Training	Trainings 1-10	300
CSAB Training	Seminars	516
CSAB Training	Seminars	32
TRIIAL 2	cross-border Training event	15
TRIIAL 2	cross-border Training event	25
TRIIAL 2	cross-border Training event	15
TRIIAL 2	cross-border Training event	25
TRIIAL 2	cross-border Training event	40
TRIIAL 2	cross-border Training event	40
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TRIIAL 2	cross-border Training event	15
TRIIAL 2	cross-border Training event	25
TRIIAL 2	cross-border Training event	40
TRIIAL 2	cross-border Training event	15
TRIIAL 2	cross-border Training event	25
TRIIAL 2	Final Conference	10
TRIIAL 2	Final Conference	30
UpJudCoop	Face to face advanced training event I - European Arrest Warrant	25
UpJudCoop	Face to face advanced training event II - European Investigation Order	25
UpJudCoop	Face to face advanced training event III - EU procedural guarantees instruments	25

UpJudCoop	Face to face advanced training event IV - EU substantive criminal law – PIF crimes	25
UpJudCoop	Face to face advanced training event V - EU Service of documents and taking of evidence	25
UpJudCoop	Face to face advanced training event VI - EU Brussels I bis Regulation	25
UpJudCoop	Face to face advanced training event VII - EU Insolvency Regulation	25
UpJudCoop	Face to face advanced training event VIII - EU Succession Regulation	25
YLA	Courses	120
ARISA Child	Experience exchange visit to Italy	15
ARISA Child	Experience exchange visit to Portugal	15
ARISA Child	Online training course	50
BREULAW	Organisation of two study visits to EU Institution s in Brussels	46
CHILD front	Transnational Train the Trainers workshop	8
CHILD front	Study visits	8
CHILD front	Synchronous hybrid training activities	135
CHILD front	e-learning course	100
CHILD front	Organisation of final transnational conference	50
VICTI	Seminar 1	70
VICTI	Seminar 2	35
VICTI	Seminar 3	70
PATFox	Launch	30
PATFox	Brussels event	30
PATFox	Curriculum	200
PATFox	SLAPP Curriculum Online Hub web presence of materials as provided by partners	1,000
PATFox	Local curriculum	30
PATFox	Conduct training	200
PATFox	Share training materials	1,000
DataProtFundRights	2 Introductory digital learning modules • Introduction to EU protection of fundamental rights • Introduction to EU data protection and privacy law	200

DataProtFundRights	Development of Advanced training programmes 1-6 and delivery of Advanced presential training 1-6	150
EU-CIP2	Conference	130
EU-CIP2	Seminar 1	65
EU-CIP2	Seminar 2	65
EU CoE HELP EU III	Adaptation and launch of HELP courses for EU legal/justice professionals (face to face cross-border/ cross-professioal launch seminars followed by online tutored training)	850
EU CoE HELP EU III	HELP Training of Trainers	80
EU CoE HELP EU III	Self learning courses (duration 6 to 16 hours learning time, free access and self-paced) courses	10,000
PostCovid challenges	Seminars	280
CCE2	Seminars	265
LighT	Introductory transnational training	300
LighT	Transnational Train the-Trainers	30
LighT	Advanced transnational training and empowerment	45
LighT	EU conference	50
YLC	Contest	144
TRALIM 3	TRALIM Naples	36
TRALIM 3	TRALIM Messina	36
TRALIM 3	TRALIM Madrid	30
TRALIM 3	TRALIM Canary	30
TRALIM 3	TRALIM Athens	61
TRALIM 3	TRALIM Paris	36
TRALIM 3	TRALIM Dublin	66
TRALIM 3	TRALIM Nicosia	50
TRALIM 3	TRALVU Turin	36
TRALIM 3	TRALVU Rome	36
TRALIM 3	TRALVU Madrid	30
TRALIM 3	TRALVU Piraeus	51
TRALIM 3	TRALVU Paris	36
TRALIM 3	TRALVU Dublin	65
TRALIM 3	TRALIM Limassol	50

TRALIM 3	Short Visits Greece	11
TRALIM 3	Short Visits Spain	11
TRALIM 3	Short Visits France	11
TRALIM 3	Short Visits Poland	12
TRALIM 3	Short Visits Cyprus	11
TRALIM 3	Short Visits Italy	11
LAWYEREX 2	Exchange of lawyers	124
JuLIA	TTE	192
JuLIA	Online JL	140
JuLIA	Online E- Learning Testing Event	15
JuLIA	E-learning modules	80
JuLIA	Final Conference	30
VR-DigiJust	Comm unities of Practice	45
VR-DigiJust	Training of Trainer s	45
VR-DigiJust	Casca de Peer Trainin g	300
VR-DigiJust	Symposium in Venice	100
RINSE	Design and implementation of the online course (7 modules 1 hour each)	225
RINSE	Organization of 15 1-day National training events (3 in each country)	225
RINSE	International training workshop	60
RINSE	Organization of dissemination events (5 national Info Days)	75
RINSE	Organization of dissemination events (final conference)	45
RINSE	Organization of dissemination events (4 LinkedIn onlineedIn events- 1 hour each)	120
DIGICRIM	Introductory digital learning e- modules 1-6, and uploadi ng to EIPA's learning management system (Moodle)	150
DIGICRIM	Advanced digital learning e- modules 1-3 and uploading to EIPA's learning management system (Moodle)	75
DIGICRIM	High level Group Discussion programmes 1-4, and delivery of synchronous high-level training	60

Format of activities 2021-2023



4.2 EJTN

Data were extracted manually from EJTN technical reports. Lists of activity topics were extracted from EJTN catalogue.

General information on participants

Table 7. General participation data (2021-2023)

Actual budget per participant	1 150
Participants per outcome	8.1
Participants per work package	505.9

Figure 16. Participants targeted and achieved 2021-2023

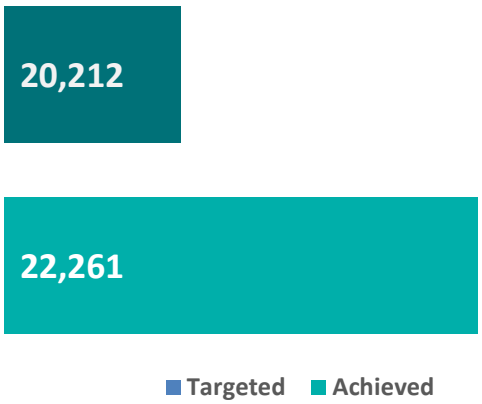
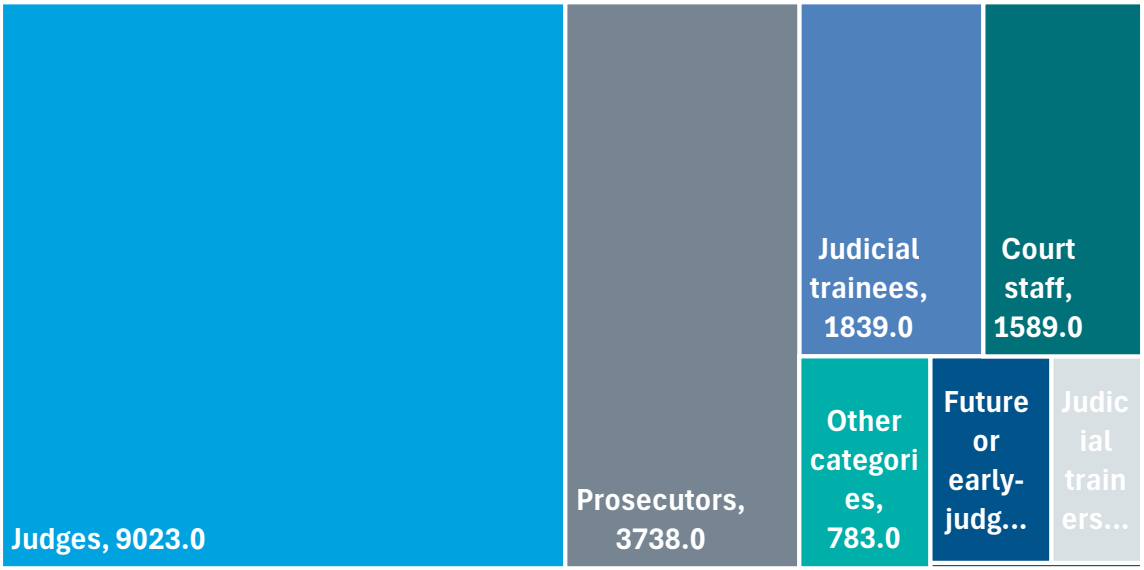
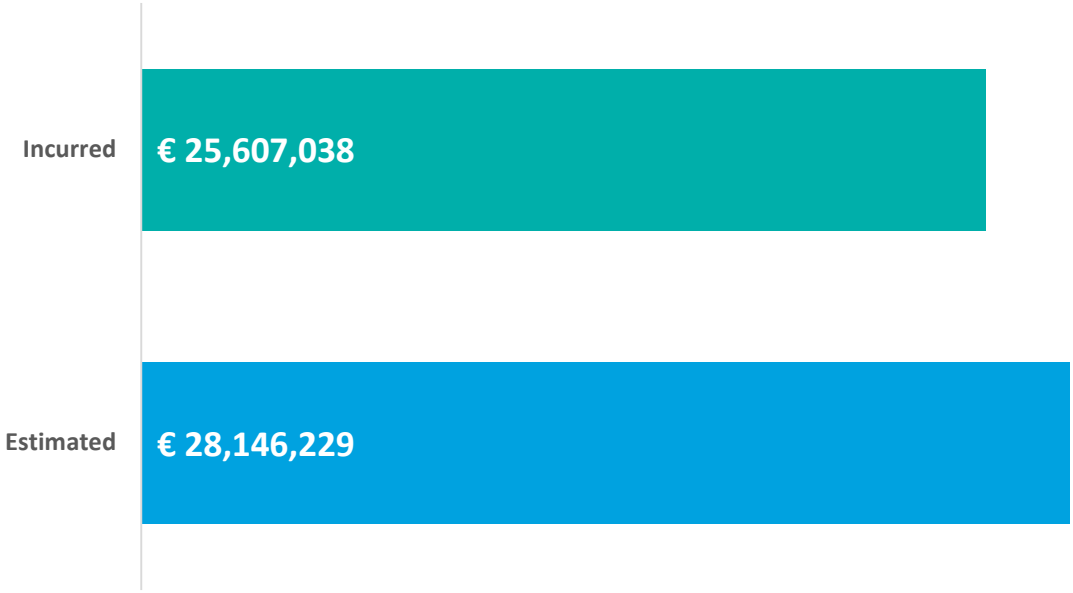


Figure 17. Participation per profession 2021-2023



Funding

Figure 18. Budget 2021-2023



List of work packages and number of activities per work package

Table 8. List of work packages 2021-2023

Work Package	Number of outcomes
CEPOL-EJTN Joint Cooperation	*9*
Digital Transition and eTools	*3*
Digitalisation	*7*

EJTN-CEPOL Joint Cooperation	*10*
Judicial Training Methods	*11*
Meeting on Training needs assessment and cooperation between judicial stakeholders concerned by European judicial training, including former Lot 4 Partners	*1*
LOT 4 Project follow up annual meeting	*1*
Management and Coordination 2021	*0*
Themis 2021	*5*
Exchange Programme 2021	*540*
Administrative Seminars 2021	*13*
Civil Justice Project 2021	*14*
Criminal Justice Projects and Work Package 8: CEPOL Seminars 2021	*30*
Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms 2021	*10*
Linguistic Project and Summer Schools 2021	*28*
eTools 2021	*43*
Upgrade of Catalogue Activities 2021	*25*
Scholarship Funds 2021	*135*
Meeting “How to apply for EU funding ? Exchanges of experiences among EJTN Members” 2021	*1*
Management and Coordination 2022	*0*
Themis 2022	*5*
Exchange Programme 2022	*697*
Administrative Law 2022	*18*
Judicial Training Methods (JTM) 2022	*16*
Civil Law 2022	*14*
Criminal Justice 2022	*29*
Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms 2022	*16*
Linguistics 2022	*48*
Catalogue Plus 2022	*30*
Scholarship Fund on Catalogue of Members Activities 2022	*146*
Meeting LOT 4 Follow-up 2022	*1*
Meeting ‘How to Apply for EU funding? Exchange of experience among EJTN Members’ 2022	*1*
Management and Coordination 2023	*0*

Exchange Programme 2023	*637*
THEMIS 2023	*5*
Administrative Law 2023	*17*
Civil Law 2023	*16*
Criminal Justice 2023	*25*
Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms 2023	*17*
Catalogue Plus 2023	*29*
Scholarship Fund on Catalogue of Members Activities 2023	*22*
Meeting 'How to Apply for EU funding? Exchange of experience among EJTN Members' 2023	*1*
Judicial Training Methods (JTM) 2023	*15*
Linguistics 2023	*48*

Yearly evolution

Figure 19. Budgeted and incurred budget (2018-2023)

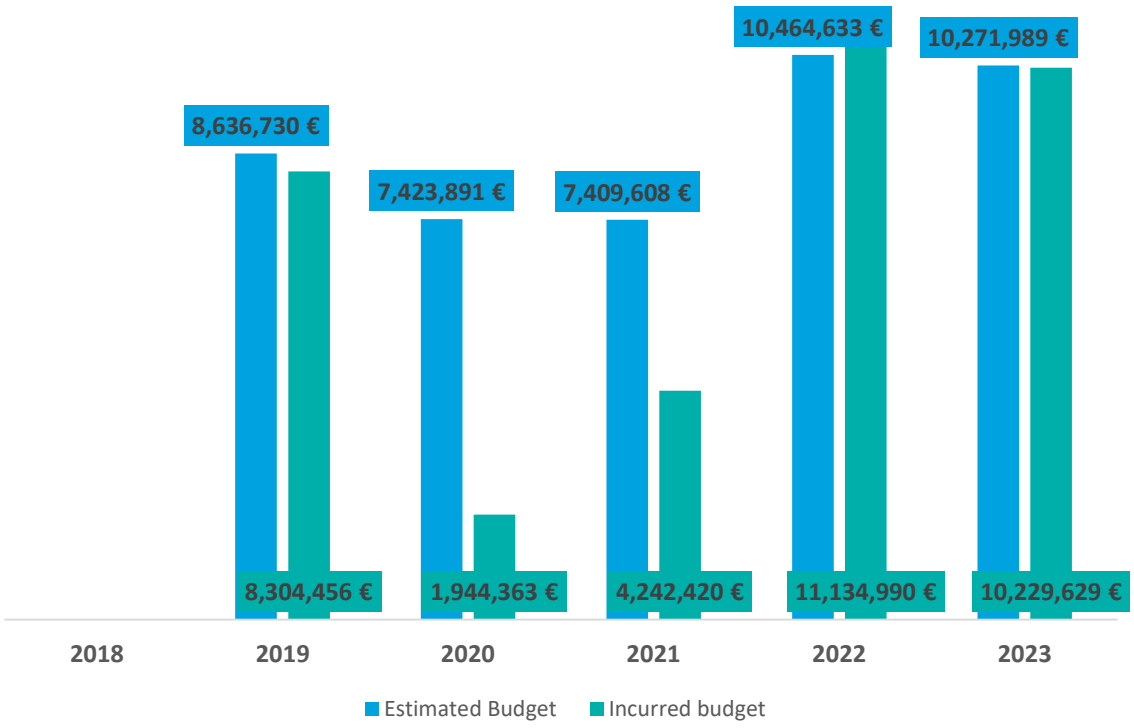


Figure 20. Work packages 2018-2023

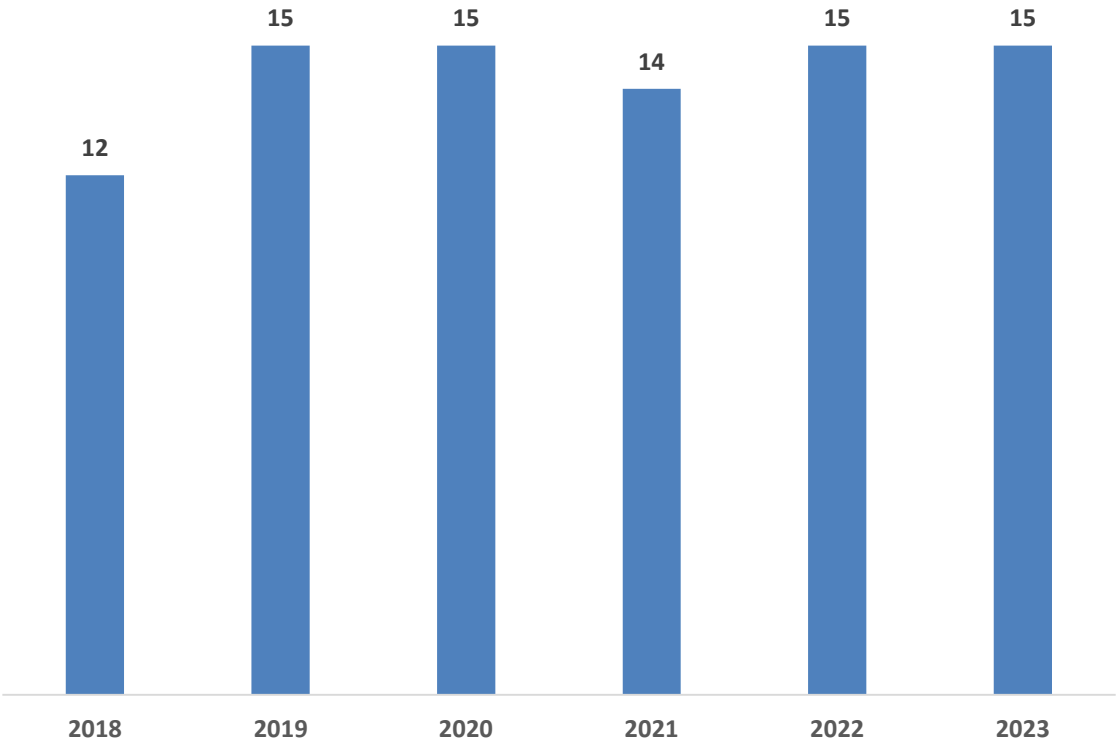
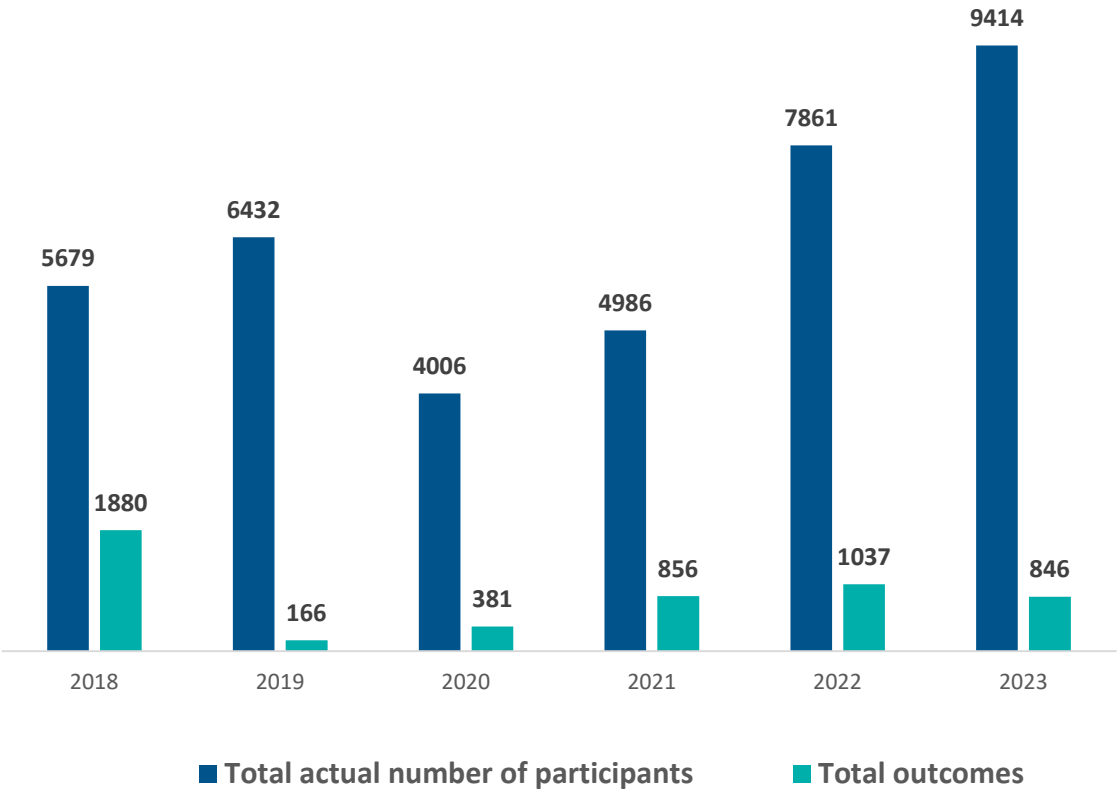
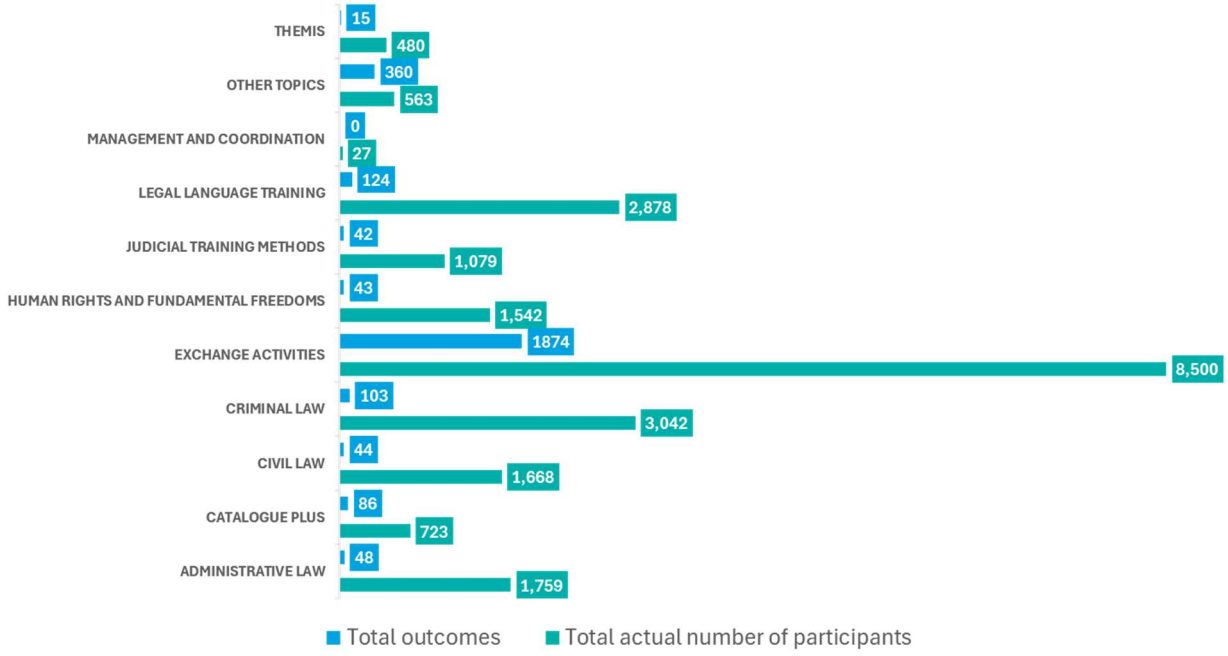


Figure 21. Participants and outcomes



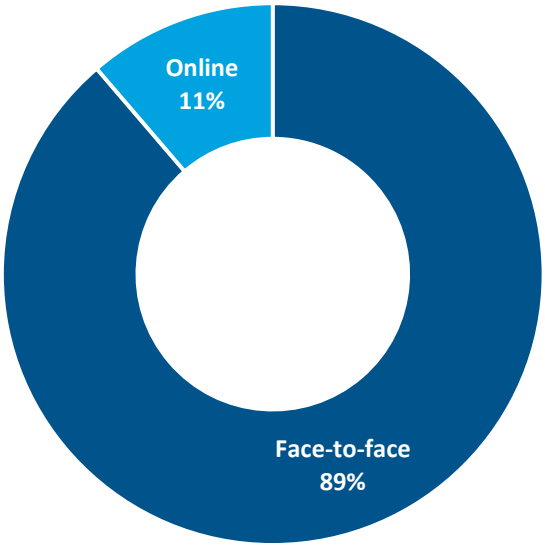
Subjects

Figure 22. Participants per subject (2021-2023)



Outcomes

Figure 23. Type of outcome (2021-2023)



Averages per work package

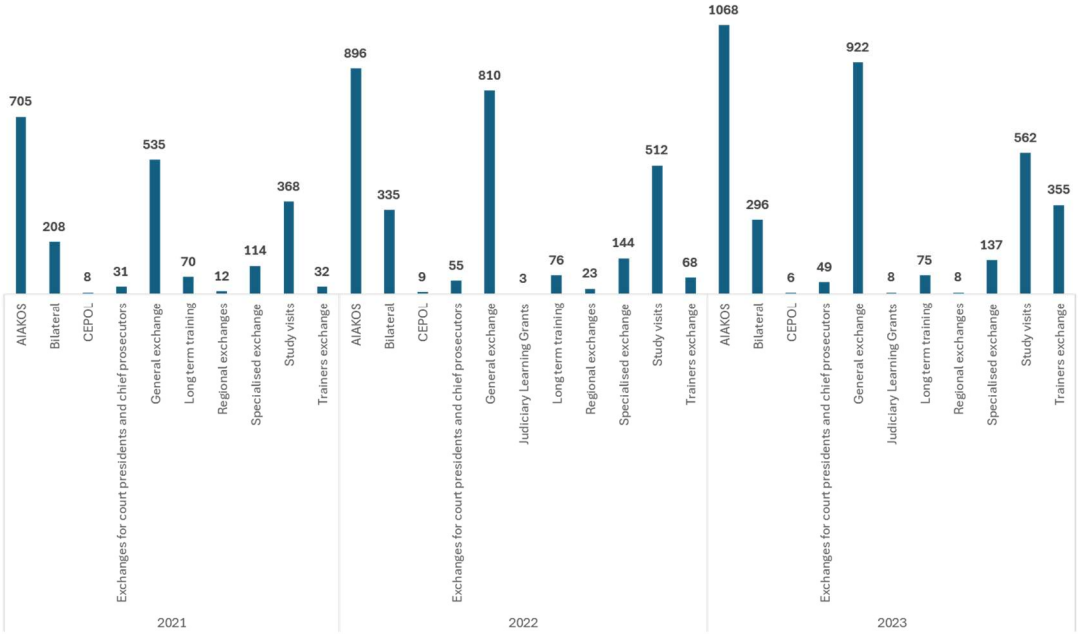
Figure 24. Work package data (2021-2023)

Dimension	Amount
Activities per WP	10.2

Budget per WP	EUR 581 978
Member States per WP	15.9
Outcomes per WP	62.3

Exchange information

Figure 25. Actual participants per type of exchange (2021-2023)



List of activity topics

Table 9. Topics (2021-2023)

List of topics
Ac Training seminar
Administrative Law and Procedure
Alternative Dispute Resolution/Mediation
Antisemitism and Hate Crimes
Applicability and effect of the EU charter on fundamental rights in national proceedings
Artificial Intelligence
Artificial intelligence and jurisdiction in practice: office organization and decision-making function
Asylum and Immigration Law Seminar
Autonomous Prosecution Services and their essential role for the Rule of Law

Brussels I regulation-Jurisdiction and the Recognition and Enforcement of Judgements in civil matters
CEPOL-EJTN Training on Joint Investigations Teams: Leadership
Challenges on distance learning. How to deal with training methods, tools and design
Civil Liability of Public Authorities under European Law -TBC
Communication on vulnerability
Conference – The future of Leadership training
Conference with ILO
Conflict of Laws in Contractual and non-Contractual matters
Conflicts of Norms/ Multi-level protection in the Application of Fundamental Rights
Corruption: detection, prevention, repression
Court Management
CP/2021/38
CP/2021/39
CP/2021/40
Crisis management
Cross-border civil cases
Cross-border Labour Law
Cultural Diversity in the Courtroom: Judges facing new challenges
Current challenges to fundamental principles of European criminal law — ne bis in idem, proportionality, necessity and publicity. National and European case
Cybercrime and E-Evidence (Advanced)
Cybercrime and E-evidence (Basic)
Economic crimes: Asset Recovery and Confiscation in the EU in practice (specialized)
EJTN - GNS joint training on the impact of refugees in Europe on the investigation and prosecution of core international crimes
EJTN-CEPOL Training on Extremism and Radicalisation in Contemporary Europe: including Terrorism Prevention
EJTN-CEPOL Training on Financial Investigations
EJTN-CEPOL Training on International Asset Recovery
EJTN-CEPOL Training on Investigating and preventing corruption
EJTN-CEPOL Training on Investigations related to facilitation of illegal immigration cases
EJTN-CEPOL Training on Joint Investigations Teams: Implementation
EJTN-CEPOL Training on Terrorism and CT
EJTN-CEPOL- Training on Trafficking in Human Beings - Sexual Exploitation

EJTN-CEPOL Training: Cross-bor- der exchange of e-evidence
Electronic Communication Law
Environmental crimes
Ethics, Bias and evidence
EU Asylum Law
EU Competition law
EU Data Protection and Privacy Rights
EU Environmental Law
EU Migration Law-TBC
EU Public Procurements
EU Taxation law
European Account Preservation Order
European Civil Procedure
European Civil Procedure in Family Law matters (advanced level)
European Civil Procedure in Family Law matters (basic level)
European criminal cooperation and recent case law
Evaluation of innovative training methodology, past present and future
Freedom of expression and Hate speech
Freedom of Speech in the Digital Era
Gather and share best practices on training needs assessment
Gender and Domestic Violence; Female Genital Mutilation
Grand Final: Access to Justice
Hate and discrimination crimes
How to start distance learning: training methods, tools and design
Human Rights and Access to Justice in the EU
Independence and Accountability of the Judiciary and Effective Judicial Protection for Presidents of Courts and Chiefs of Prosecution Offices
Innovative training curricula and change management
Intellectual Property Law-Trademarks &Designs
International and European tax law and jurisprudence
International cooperation in family law matters
Investigation and prosecution of THB cases in the EU
Joint Investigation Teams - cross-border fight against crime with new possibilities an opportunity

Judicial Cooperation in Criminal Matters: Practical Case- Based Simulation on Money Laundering and THB
Judicial Cooperation in Criminal Matters: Practical Case-Based simulation in the fight against drug trafficking
Judicial Cooperation in Criminal Matters: Practical Case-Based Simulation on cross-border Environmental crimes
Judicial Ethics
Jurisdiction, recognition, enforcement of judgments and determination of the applicable law under Regulation 1215/2012. The new Insolvency Regula- tion 848/2015
Jurisprudence updates: most important decisions of the European Court of Justice relevant for administrative judges
Legal English. Civil matters
Legal English. Criminal matters
Legal language training in cooperation in asylum & refugees
Legal language training in cooperation in civil matters
Legal language training in cooperation in criminal matters
Legal language training in cooperation in cross-border organised crime
Legal language training in cooperation in cybercrime
Legal language training in cooperation in environmen- tal law
Legal language training in cooperation in family law
Legal language training in cooperation in human rights' EU law
Mentoring and tutoring in courts
Multi-layered treatment of particularly vulnerable children
On the Independence of the Judiciary – A European Comparison
Organised crime from an historical, economic and social point of view
Penitentiary Law and Jurisprudence of the ECtHR on the enforcement of penalties
Preliminary Ruling Procedure
Procedural Safeguards in Criminal proceedings in the EU in practice: enhancing knowledge on the Children's Directive
Procedural Safeguards in Criminal Proceedings in the EU in practice: improving the existing aquis Directives
Professional Practice
Protection of Consumers in the light of the EU Law
Regulation (EU) 2018/1805 of the Eu- ropean Parliament and of the Council of 14 November 2018 on the mutual recognition of freezing orders and confiscation orders
Rule of Law Training for Judges: Independent Judges as a Cornerstone of the Rule of Law

Seizure and Confiscation
Semi-Final A: EU and European Criminal Law
Semi-final B: EU and European Family Law
Semi-final C: EU and European Civil Procedure
Semi-final D: Judicial Ethics and Professional Conduct
Seminar on Personal Development
Service of documents & taking of evidence abroad
Summer School in linguistics Civil Matters
Summer School in linguistics Criminal Matters
Summer School in linguistics Family Law
Summer School in linguistics Human Rights
The EPPO: investigations and prosecutions to fight crimes against the financial interests of the EU
The European Investigation Order in Practice (Advanced)
The European Investigation Order in Practice (Basic)
The interaction with the minors during the judiciary proceedings. Specificities
The role of the Administrative Judge in the State
The Rule of Law from the Perspective of CJEU
The social dimensions of the EU
Train the trainers
Training on Human Rights
Victim’s Rights in the EU in practice: violence against women and children
Victim’s rights of Terrorist Attacks
Webinar on Impact of Brexit on Judicial Cooperation in Criminal Matters
Webinar: EU State Aid Litigation
Webinar: Human rights in times of emergency-focus on COVID-19
Webinar: Recent Case Law of the European Court of Human Rights in Taxation Matters
Mediation and Conciliation
Data Protection and Privacy Right
Leadership in Communication
Change Management
Personal Leadership
Summer school: Legal language training in cooperation in Civil Matters
Summer school: Legal language training in cooperation in Criminal Matters

Summer school: Legal language training in cooperation in human rights
Summer school: Legal language training in cooperation in family law
Environmental Law
Ethics and prevention of corruption
EU Preliminary Ruling Procedure
Communication and vulnerability
Legal language training in cooperation in environmental law
Basic notions on Antitrust Law
EU Tax Law

Annex 5 - Consultations

This section summarises the results of the consultation with stakeholders and training participants.

5.1 Inception interviews

The following table provides an overview of organisations interviewed.

Organisation	Status
JUST A1 JTS	Completed
JUST A1 digitalisation	Completed
JUST H3 justice programme	Completed
JUST A1 training report	Completed
EMPL G1 ESF	Completed
CEPEJ	Completed
CoE HELP	Completed
FRA	Completed
CEPOL	Completed
EIPA	Completed
EJTN	Completed
ERA	Completed
EPTA	Completed
CNUE	Completed
CCBE	Completed
UEHJ	No reply
ENCJ	No reply
ELF	Completed

The interviews highlighted several key themes across the various training activities and projects:

- Training Formats: There is a mix of in-person, online, and hybrid training formats. While face-to-face interactions are highly valued for networking and discussing

sensitive issues, online training has increased participation rates, especially during the pandemic.

- Focus Areas: Training topics include fundamental rights, EU law application, digital skills, cybercrime, financial services, judicial independence, and rule of law. Specific areas like asylum, immigration, and cyber skills are in high demand.
- Challenges: Language barriers, especially for older judges, and the need for more multilingual training options. Ensuring high-quality and engaging training content is crucial, alongside addressing the challenge of low response rates for feedback surveys.
- Participant Diversity: Participants come from diverse backgrounds, including judges, prosecutors, lawyers, prison staff, and public administration officials. There is a high demand for training from Eastern and Mediterranean countries.
- Training Needs and Evaluation: Continuous assessment of training needs and gaps is essential. Common gaps include training on financial services, AI, and digital threats. Evaluation methods include feedback forms, entry and exit questionnaires, and regular reporting.
- Coordination and Partnerships: Effective coordination with national training institutes, EU bodies, and other stakeholders is vital. Partnerships with organizations like EJTN, EuroPris, EIPA, and CEPOL enhance training effectiveness and reach.
- Innovation and Digitalization: There is a strong focus on developing innovative training methods and integrating digital tools. Digital resources and e-learning platforms are being expanded to enhance accessibility and engagement.

Overall, the interviews underscore the importance of adapting training programs to meet evolving needs, fostering collaboration among stakeholders, and leveraging digital tools to enhance learning experiences. Continuous evaluation and feedback are essential to ensure the effectiveness and relevance of training initiatives.

5.2 Interviews with trainers

Trainer A has been involved with the European Judicial Training Network (EJTN) since 2019, participating in the Hellenic working group and the criminal sub-group. He regularly chairs, speaks, and delivers training at 5-6 events per year while also serving as a full-time judge. He provides a general overview of EU law and its functions through workshops, which he believes are essential for allowing judges to discuss and learn from each other. National training focuses on national law, incorporating EU law elements but not specifically focusing on them. EJTN training, on the other hand, focuses on how EU law can support judges in their daily work. Participants attend to learn about EU law and to network with other judges, often staying in contact through WhatsApp groups.

During the pandemic, all training was moved online, resulting in higher participation. However, since then, EJTN has returned to face-to-face training, valuing the importance of discussion and networking, while also adding some webinars. Digital events, such as one on AU and digital, have seen high demand. The programme engages a mix of participants with varying levels of experience, though some countries like France, Scandinavia, and the UK (when it was in the EU) rarely send participants. Most attendees come from Eastern and Mediterranean countries. There is high demand for EJTN courses in Greece, with around 120 applicants for 2 places. The training is conducted in English, which can be a barrier for older judges. Stelios suggests offering courses in German, French, and possibly Greek.

Trainer B has delivered several training sessions in Thessalonica and Malta on grey zones and the rule of law. These sessions are fully booked, reflecting high interest. She emphasises the importance of training judges to operate apolitically and make unbiased decisions, especially in the face of political pressures. Training on the EU Charter and fundamental human rights is more important than ever. Her training is primarily face-to-face, as building trust and discussing sensitive issues is crucial. She suggests that follow-up sessions after 3 or 6 months could improve the training. The training focuses on principles, management, accountability, and impartiality, helping judges build self-confidence, independence, and judicial courage.

In Ireland, trainers C, D and E deliver training on asylum, immigration, and the interplay between ECH and EU fundamental human rights for lawyers. Demand for training is high, with 30 courses run last year and 29 this year. They also send national lawyers to other countries to learn different practices. Feedback has been positive, with high attendance for asylum training and valuable networking opportunities. Cybercrime and electronic evidence training are also popular. National training provides a broad range of topics and their specific application at the national level, while EU training offers comparative information and networking opportunities.

During the COVID-19 pandemic, all courses went online, resulting in better attendance. Now, they aim for a 50-50 split between online and face-to-face training. Online resources have increased, and all materials are now available on the hub. EU training has filtered down to national training, integrating EU law into existing training. Some participants stay in touch, gaining ongoing benefits from the training. Gaps in the Judicial Training Strategy (JTS) include highly regulated areas like financial services, IT, and AI, which are important for people to understand and will likely have high attendance due to FOMO (fear of missing out).

5.3 Interviews with project managers

Project manager A is responsible for the organisational aspects of various training activities, including eFilit, data protection rights, Digicrim, and UpJudCoop. Her role involves coordinating with project partners, the steering committee, and managing participant registrations, ensuring that the project remains on track. She is not responsible for the content of the courses.

The delivery partner identifies and recruits training partners through its long-standing network. The implementation structure is developed by reviewing the existing course catalogue, identifying potential needs, and contacting partner organisations. Training needs are identified by looking into the main themes of the call for proposals, reviewing provided courses, and checking with partners and national training providers for interest. The selection of participants is done by the project partners, with EIPA having no control over this process. Training courses are designed based on general standards used in previous training courses, ensuring they are not too long to maintain participant engagement.

Trainers are usually employed by the delivery partner, but external trainers are selected for specific projects, such as the data protection project. Training is designed in English and translated into the languages of partner countries to ensure broader participation. Participants are recruited by partner organisations, and the steering committee discusses specific training needs and participant profiles.

Pre-training information provided to participants includes the description of learning objectives and links to related rules and regulations. Key learning objectives focus on an interdisciplinary approach, exchanges between lawyers and magistrates, and a mixed learning format combining online and face-to-face elements. The aim is to exchange ideas

and understand national implementation of tools, with specific training outcomes tailored to the needs of the participating countries.

Project Manager A believes that while the training could be done at the national level, the cross-border element provided at the EU level is invaluable. Participants are particularly interested in learning from colleagues in other countries, especially when frequent collaboration occurs. The training provides an overview of EU rules, but specific examples are needed to demonstrate correct application and interpretation of EU law. It is not always clear how the training has impacted participants further.

Lessons learned during the implementation of the programme include the need for engaging content in online courses to ensure completion. While the training content could be implemented at the national level, it is not developed with this approach. Online PPTs have specific teacher notes that could be translated. She suggests that unit costs should be better adapted to the costs faced by providers.

Regarding future needs for digitalisation, she notes that Digicrim is already responding to some needs. Trainers for online training require specific training to engage participants effectively. This includes knowledge of how to keep participants focused and ensure they are following the content, as the trainer cannot see the participants. No specific key learning outcomes were mentioned.

Project Manager A did not identify specific areas or Member States where justice professionals lack necessary digital skills or knowledge. However, she noted that administrative law seems less frequently mentioned in EU calls for proposals, but there is a clear request for more training in this area.

Project manager B coordinates a project in the prison and probation sector. The project is limited to five Member States, hence targeting only justice professionals from these countries. The project partners were identified as the delivery partner has already previously delivered EU training activities and via other works implemented for EU Commission and EU Agencies.

Project manager B believes that is required to understand how EU funding works and requires some relationships in the field to be able to make a funding application to JTRA calls.

The project also included an important component that was actually linked to research to better understand specific training gaps in the in the penitentiary area as little was known about this sector so far. There is limited availability of research on EU level. This is also an added value of the JTRA projects. In a second step, best practices are identified that will be used to study more extensively and build the backbone for the actual training activity. This is necessary to be able to develop a training module that is also more practice oriented. The training should be about promoting practical solutions that worked well. This means indeed that EU law as such is not the primary learning but the EU policy is embedded within the training. In a third phase the actual training – e-learning videos are developed. Project B develops a communication training for penitentiary staff working with vulnerable people. It is intended that the module is to last about 8 hours, intention is to have it as interactive as possible using simulations. The learning should contribute to raise awareness about the situation of vulnerable inmates, guide towards a rehabilitation approach, improve their daily work by referring them to interesting technologies that could be trailed by the learner. Developing online learning is challenging according to Project manager B as it needs to be engaging and really interactive otherwise learners do not complete it. To develop engaging training material it is pivotal to conduct experience exchanges with professionals. Testing the actual learning also contributes to later success of the learning ensuring interest and completion of training.

The project B is still in the phase to conclude on the best practices and to gather all material to develop the actual learning modules. According to the project manager a lot of flexibility was needed at the start of the project as the topics for learning were not fully clear, also with regard to what would be most relevant for the targeted professionals. The JTRA grant framework was giving this flexibility to the project team and the advise from DG JUST was much appreciated.

Project manager B finds that the results are sustainable as the material could be translated in other languages that are not currently envisaged by the project. It is also possible to share the training more widely once the project finalised. Within the project the learning modules are shared with the project delivery partners and their respective networks.

Project manager C works at a major EU training provider. She is the project coordinator of a training project funded under JTRA targeting young lawyers in private practice/ private sector. The project is about a moot court/ law competition. She has been working herself before in a private law firm and knows the context well. The training provider has already trialled this training programme in a previously EU funded training project. This is the second time that the project is implemented as it has shown a lot of interest among the target group. To recruit participants the training providers collaborates with EU associations for lawyers and national bar associations. They play an important role in the recruitment of participants and are also project partners to this project. They ensure also communication about the project results and provide direct feedback to the participants, contribute to select the jury members etc. Also law schools are interested in this training project. This time of training requires a considerable time investment to prepare the papers with the team of selected participants from across Member States. This cross-border aspect of moot court competitions does not exist in the national context or in law schools. The topics selected for the papers are in link to EU priorities as project manager C believes. Examples also include sometimes case law from other Member States, CJEU etc. It is legally challenging exercises. The teams are then evaluated for the oral and the written part. These evaluations can give a lot of important feedback to the participants as the evaluators are well known experts on the topic/ legal fields. They also look into the taking of evidence etc. According to the project managers this is a good practical learning and the participants at the end of the competition all receive certificates. Participants, especially those that won the competition do receive recognition by their law firms employing them and sometimes it can be linked to promotion. So far they did not conduct a long-term evaluation but the feedback the project manager C receives is positive and the programme shows clear added value for the young lawyers. The project manager also believes that it would be wishful thinking that national bar associations would pick up this idea and use it and organise it by themselves. This has not happened at this stage. Rather it requires a lot of coordination and the EU training partners are very much appreciated for their specific knowledge and knowhow.

The project manager finds clearly that in the future this project can be renewed again with a focus on digitalisation, focussing on the DSA act or the AI act, cybersecurity etc. This is indeed a topic that is interesting many young lawyers in private practice. It is expected that more cases will deal with these EU provisions. In this sense, the project could also contribute in the future to practical training.

Project manager D highlighted that it was not easy to set up a suitable consortium as some partners were already involved in other training projects. The consortium comprised 11 partners, and her training institute coordinated the implementation, communication, awareness raising, and curriculum development. Key tasks included research, creating a central and local curriculum, and conducting training sessions.

The needs assessment showed that the topic under focus was largely unknown among legal professionals, journalists, and civil society organizations. The training focused on

lawyers to address gaps in knowledge about SLAPP, EU law, and human rights case law. Despite initial difficulties, the training received positive responses, highlighting the need for such education. The project aimed to train lawyers, but also included law students and young professionals. The selection criteria involved human rights lawyers, environmental lawyers, and legal professionals from various sectors. Despite some limitations, the project successfully engaged a diverse group of participants.

Different strategies were used to recruit participants selecting the most adapted one depending on the country, including reaching out to Bar Associations, using law journals, online media, universities, and NGOs. The collaboration with Bar Associations proved particularly effective in reaching potential participants. The general rule was open participation, but in some countries like Germany and Poland, a vetting mechanism was implemented to ensure a safe space for participants. The selection process aimed to include a diverse group while avoiding potential conflicts. The key to success was understanding the target audience's needs, providing practical exercises, and including real-life cases. This approach engaged participants and made the training relevant and useful, leading to a high level of interest and participation.

According the project manager D the challenges of project implementation linked to maintaining privacy, particularly when the Commission requested attendee lists. Some participants preferred anonymity, which affected the count of participants. The project also faced difficulties in getting participants to complete surveys for evaluation purposes.

From the perspective of the project manager, the project could not have been achieved at a national level due to varying interest and awareness on the topic across countries. The EU funding and support were crucial in initiating the project and raising awareness. The project manager D confirms that the training materials are still being used, and there is ongoing interest in the topic. The project has had a lasting impact, with continued requests for training and lectures. However, there is room for improvement in networking and sustainability.

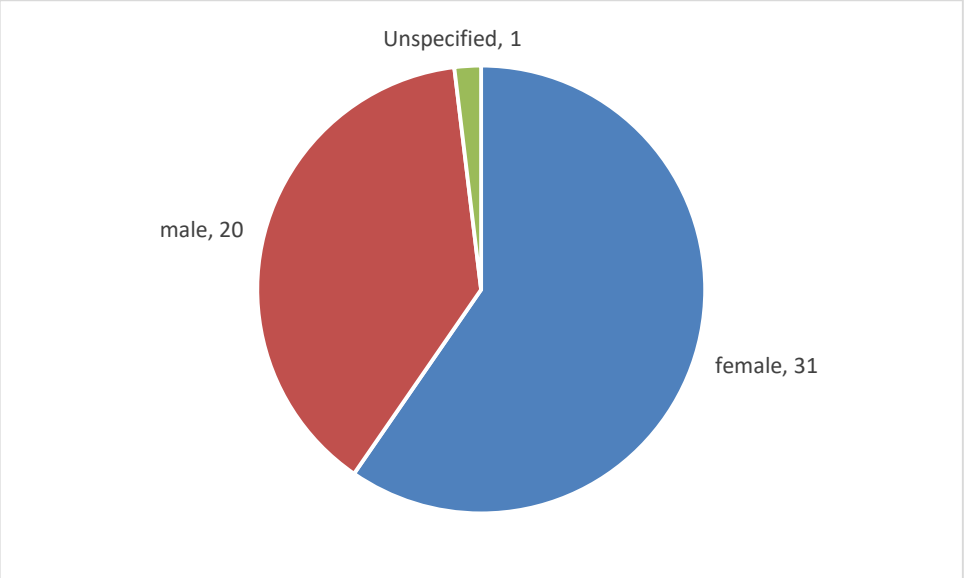
Regarding suggestions for future collaboration within the JTRA projects the project manager D found that there is a need for better communication, support, and networking opportunities from the EC. More structured and direct interaction with project coordinators could improve project management and impact. The EC should balance transparency with providing practical support to NGOs.

5.4 Interviews with training participants

Table 10. Overview of the interview write ups analysed

	Judges and prosecutors	Lawyers	Court staff	Bailiffs
Total interviews	36	19	7	3
Total write-ups	35	17	7	3
Funding instrument	JTRA and EJTN (OG)	JTRA	JTRA	JTRA

Figure 26. Gender Distribution of All Interviewees

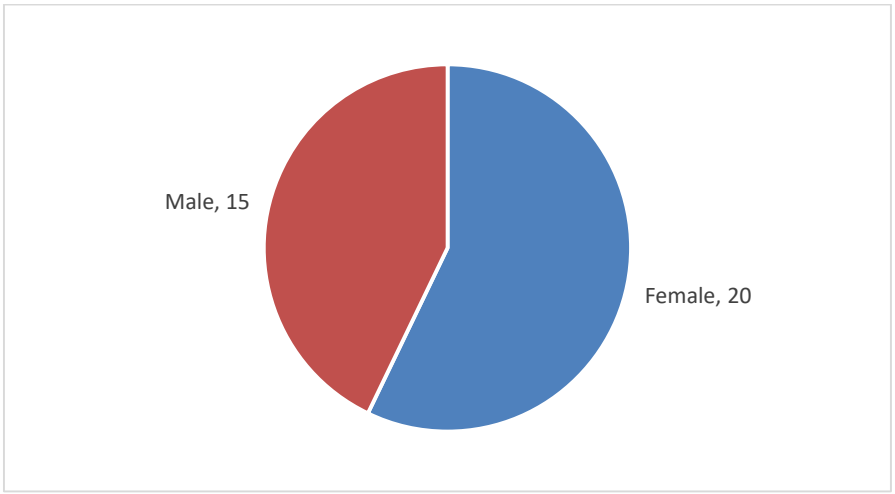


Of the 52 individuals interviewed, the majority were female, accounting for 31 participants, while the remaining 21 belonged to other gender groups.

According to CEPEJ[2], the proportion of professional female to male judges have seen a steady increase from 48% to 52% in 2010 to 56% to 44% in 2020. It mirrors the gender distribution in our interviewees.

Judges and prosecutors

Figure 27. Gender Distribution of Interviewees who participated in EJTN and JTRA Training activities



The pie chart illustrates that we interviewed 20 female judges and prosecutors, alongside 15 male counterparts, all of whom had previously participated in EJTN and JTRA training activities.

[2] Council of Europe, European Commission for the Efficiency of Justice. (2022). *European judicial systems: CEPEJ Evaluation Report 2022 Evaluation cycle (2020 data)*. https://www.coe.int/en/web/cepej/special-file-report-european-judicial-systems-cepej-evaluation-report-2022-evaluation-cycle-2020-data-

Judges and prosecutors participating to EJTN grant funded activities

Background of Participants

The four judges (b24, b25, b26, b28) and two prosecutors (b13, b33) interviewed for this report who participated to training activities delivered by EJTN outlined the following:

Motivation to Enrol in EJTN Training

The judges reported different reasons for enrolling. Judge (b24) wanted to stay informed about European judicial cooperation, especially regarding cross-border issues. Judge (b25), as a criminal judge at the Court of Appeal and a trainer themselves, was interested in any knowledge provided by the training activities. Judge (b26) aimed to expand knowledge of civil and commercial law, and Judge (b28) focused on virtual and hybrid hearings for improving court efficiency.

Travel and Accessibility

Judges (b24, b25) travelled for in-person training, with Judge (b24) noting, "It pushes us to travel. We're not that many judges, and at the same time we don't know the European judicial space that well." Hybrid sessions were also appreciated, though online formats were seen as less cooperative.

Training Topics and Complexity

The judges attended activities which covered a range of topics, from European judicial cooperation to digitalisation. For instance, several judges emphasised the challenges in criminal law during the pandemic, with (b1, b5) explaining how the rise of internet-based crimes required new methods of investigation and prosecution. They noted how these sessions helped them understand evolving criminal modus operandi and the legal tools necessary to combat them.

At the same time, digitalisation in justice was a major focus, with participants like (b2, b3, b25) discussing the growing importance of online hearings, digital files, and the need for better tools to handle cases more efficiently. They believe that understanding these advancements is crucial for modernising the judicial process and improving their daily work.

Quantitative Analysis and Overview

Three judges (b24, b25, b28) had positive views of the training's overall quality. Three (b24, b26, b28) confirmed that it facilitated valuable networking. Only one judge (b26) reported directly applying the training in their work, while others found it shaped broader legal perspectives. Overall, the responses reflect a generally positive experience, though with varying degrees of impact across different aspects of the training activity.

Overall Learnings and Quality of Training

The general consensus among the judges regarding the quality of EJTN training was positive. Three (b24, b25, b28) of the four judges expressed satisfaction with the programs, highlighting their value in deepening knowledge and skills in the European judicial space. One judge (b24) emphasised that "These EU judicial trainings are a very good idea. It should be developed," reflecting a strong belief in the potential of these programs to enhance cross-border judicial cooperation. Another judge (b25) shared a more detailed account of their experience, stating "I found (the seminars) very concrete and specific compared to the more general training available in Italy… I found these experiences very valuable and noticed that all participants were very grateful." The emphasis suggested that the hands-on and collaborative nature of the training contributed significantly to its perceived quality. Despite one judge (b26) not offering feedback on

learning quality, the overall sentiment strongly supports the notion that EJTN training is well-organised and beneficial.

Effectiveness of Networking

Networking was a key benefit mentioned by three judges (b24, b26, b28). Judge (b24) noted, "We end up with a directory that allows us to make phone calls. It's a small community, everyone knows each other." This illustrates the importance of having informal channels for communication, which can help resolve legal issues that would otherwise need to go through more formal, time-consuming processes.

Judge (b26) elaborated on the value of networking, stating, "I believe that meeting judges from other countries, comparing and discussing our problems, enriches my professional background. It's intriguing to see what's similar and what's different in our challenges." However, Judge (b26) mentioned "…during the course of the week [seminars], you develop a closer bond with some of the participants… it used to be better when, at the end of each seminar, we received the email contact addresses for each participant. They no longer do that because of data protection, but I think this should change."

Practical Application of Training

Only Judge (b5) (regional court, criminal section) provided a clear example of applying the training to their work, stating, "I managed to find a way (after learning from the training) to avoid the personal attendance at a court session of people who had great difficulty to be present before the judge." Judge (b26) reflected on the broader impact of training, saying, "I believe it's crucial for a judge to be very aware of fundamental rights, especially in the European context. These seminars have given me a greater sensitivity to these matters." This suggests that while the training may not always lead to immediate, practical applications in the workplace, it nonetheless plays an important role in shaping the broader legal perspectives of the participants.

Digitalisation and Future Training Needs

Judge (b25) pointed out that "For judges, the digitalisation process has started but is still in its early stages." They stressed the need for better digital tools like electronic signatures. Similarly, Judge (b28) stated that "Any kind of networking exchange of experiences is just really important. Without that, you cannot make judges passionate about digitalisation." This judge stressed that "we really need to modernise" the justice system to keep pace with the digital world, as "people will not take justice seriously" if courts lag behind modern services like Netflix and Amazon.

Judges and prosecutors participating to JTRA funded activities

Background of Participants

A total of 22 judges from 11 member states were interviewed, with the largest groups from Portugal (5) and Romania (3). These judges attended training from seven different projects (CCE2 (3), EU-CIP2 (2), JuLIA (7), PostCovid (2), TRIIAL 2 (5), UpJudCoop (2), and VICTI (1)). Most participated in face-to-face training (9), followed by online (6) and hybrid formats (1). The roles represented included administrative court judges (3), criminal court judges (3), a civil court judge, a judicial court judge, and an investigative judge.

We interviewed six prosecutors from five different member states. Two were from Romania, while the others represented Bulgaria, Ireland, Italy, and Poland. These prosecutors had taken part in training across three distinct projects: PostCovid (3), JuLIA (2), and UpJudCoop (1). The majority attended in-person sessions (4), with the remaining two participating online.

Figure 28. Job Types of Judges and Prosecutor Interviewees

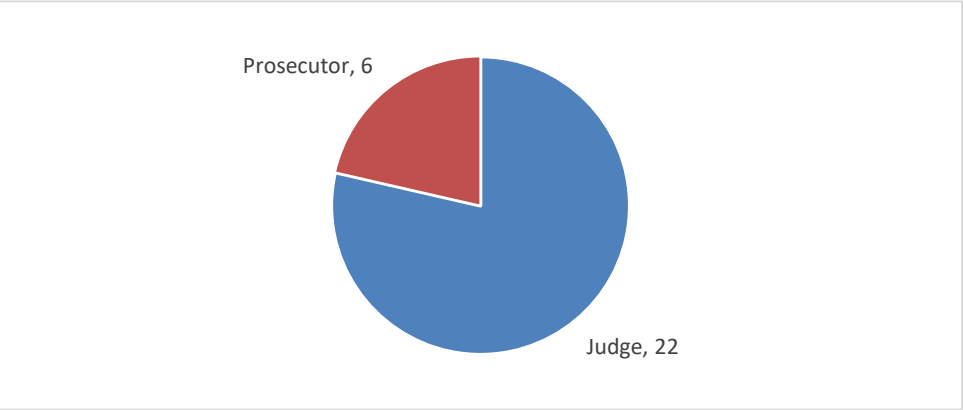
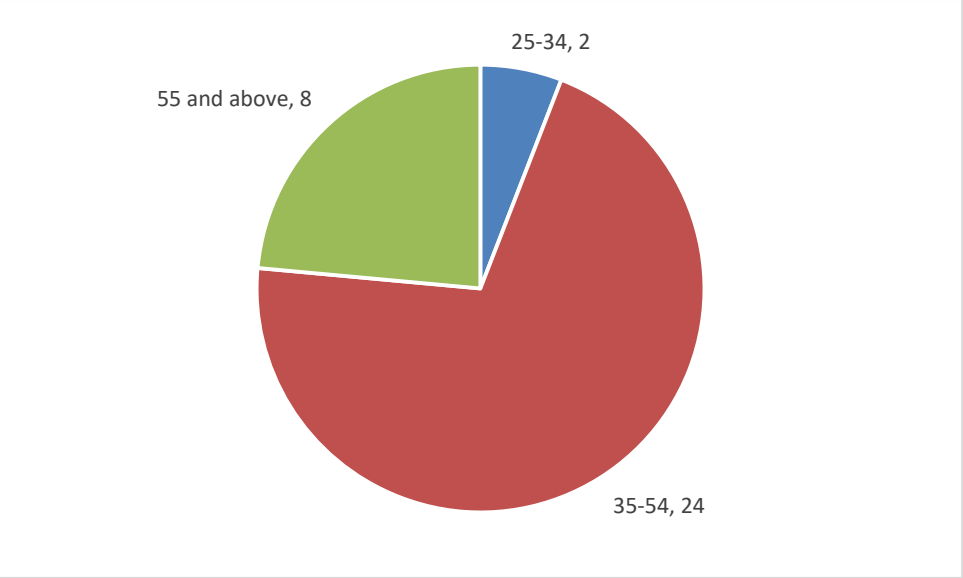


Figure 29. Age Group Distribution of Judges and Prosecutor Interviewees



Motivation to Enrol in JTRA Training

Judges were primarily motivated by three key factors.

First, interest in AI and its application in judicial processes was the top reason (n=8), with several judges curious about both its potential and risks (B3, B7, B11, B12, B16). As one judge (B16) put it, "AI in decision-making processes, for instance in healthcare, is very interesting". This motivation also reflects the topic of the seminar they attended.

The second most common motivation was professional development in specialised areas (n=6), including EU regulations, financial interests, and insolvency law (B5, B18, B35). One judge (B18) highlighted the practical impact, saying, "The training helped me to decide in these cases... It improves my knowledge and skills".

Third, five judges were drawn to the opportunity for cross-border learning and collaboration, especially in the context of judicial independence and European legal standards (B8, B19). "It was an opportunity to gain insights into how my colleagues in other East and Central European countries work" (B8).

Travel and Accessibility

None of the judges mentioned any difficulties related to travel for the training.

Training Topics and Complexity

Judges generally found the training topics well-suited to their practical challenges, with the complexity appropriately balanced. The topics helped deepen their understanding of key legal areas. One judge noted, "The course has mainly allowed me to deepen my understanding of European legislation and its application" (B35).

Quantitative Overview

Out of 22 judges, 12 commented on whether the training met their expectations, with 10 providing positive feedback (B1, B2, B6, B11, B19, B20, B21, B32, B35). For example, one judge (B2) said, "It was a very pleasant experience... I had the opportunity to get updates regarding EU law and the practice of other judge coordinators in different EU Member States". Two judges offered mixed feedback, noting a desire for deeper exploration of some topics. "The course only increased my curiosity and expectations" (B17). "I wanted to go deeper and see more of the procedure" (B4). These responses show that while most judges found the training highly relevant, a few felt that certain topics required further depth.

Overall Learnings and Quality of Training

Key areas of learning included EU law (B2, B15, B35), cross-border legal processes (B32, B5), and insolvency law (B32). Some judges also highlighted learning about victims' rights and social media's role in the judiciary (B9, B21). One judge remarked, "The most interesting part of the training was the one on the preliminary question, giving some hints on how to make a question in such a way that it is not refused" (B15), emphasising the importance of practical, applicable knowledge. Another added, "I learned more about the Charter of Fundamental Rights of the EU and victims' rights" (B21).

Effectiveness of Networking

Out of the 22 interviewees, 15 judges responded to questions about networking opportunities, with 13 offering positive feedback. Judges appreciated the ability to exchange contacts with colleagues from other member states. "Other judges gave us their emails and phone numbers... so next time I need some information, I can activate those contacts" (B4). However, a few judges expressed concerns about the difficulty of networking in online settings (B3), and one noted that the diverse knowledge levels of participants sometimes hindered collaboration (B17).

Practical Application of Training

Of the 8 judges who discussed whether they applied their training in practice, 4 reported positive impacts (B4, B5, B22, B35), while 4 said they had not yet applied it (B12, B17, B21, B32). One judge (B5) described using the training to implement video conferences in court, noting, "I managed to find a way to avoid personal attendance at a court session... by video conference". Conversely, some judges found the training insightful but not immediately applicable. "For now it (application of training) has not been necessary" (B17).

Digitalisation and Future Training Needs

Digitalisation was identified as a key area needing further training, with judges citing the need for more advanced tools, particularly in AI and secure communication (B3, B5). "There is a need for more training on the secure means of communication with other judicial authorities" (B5). However, several challenges remain, including the difficulty of managing multiple digital platforms and the vast amount of European jurisprudence that is hard to process. They (B17) said, "Consulting European jurisprudence is becoming increasingly difficult due to the amount of information and the scarcity of means of

systematizing it". There were also barriers in applying digital tools consistently across parties, as some litigants are not required to communicate electronically (B14).

Future training areas suggested by judges include cross-border legal procedures, EU law, human trafficking, and language skills (B5, B15, B14). One judge (B5) stated, "There is a need to deepen the prevention and combating of human trafficking and illegal migration", highlighting the importance of addressing emerging criminal justice challenges within the EU framework. Additionally, broader EU law training for all legal professionals was recommended, with one judge (B21) noting, "In my country, there is a need for training in all topics about EU Law".

Level of Satisfaction of JTRA 2021-2022

The overall level of satisfaction with the training activities for JTRA 2021 and 2022 combined remained consistently high at 4.8 out of 5. In terms of the benefit of increased awareness and knowledge, most respondents provided exceptionally high ratings. While the benefits related to increased skills and cooperation were also rated positively, they were slightly lower in comparison to the ratings for awareness and knowledge enhancement.

Figure 30. Satisfaction to JTRA training

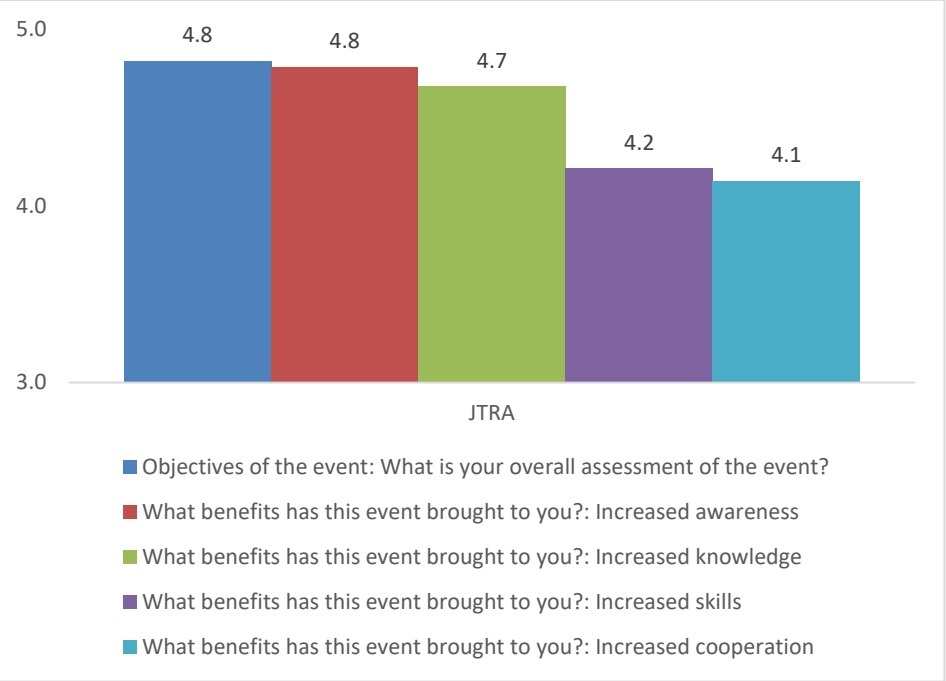
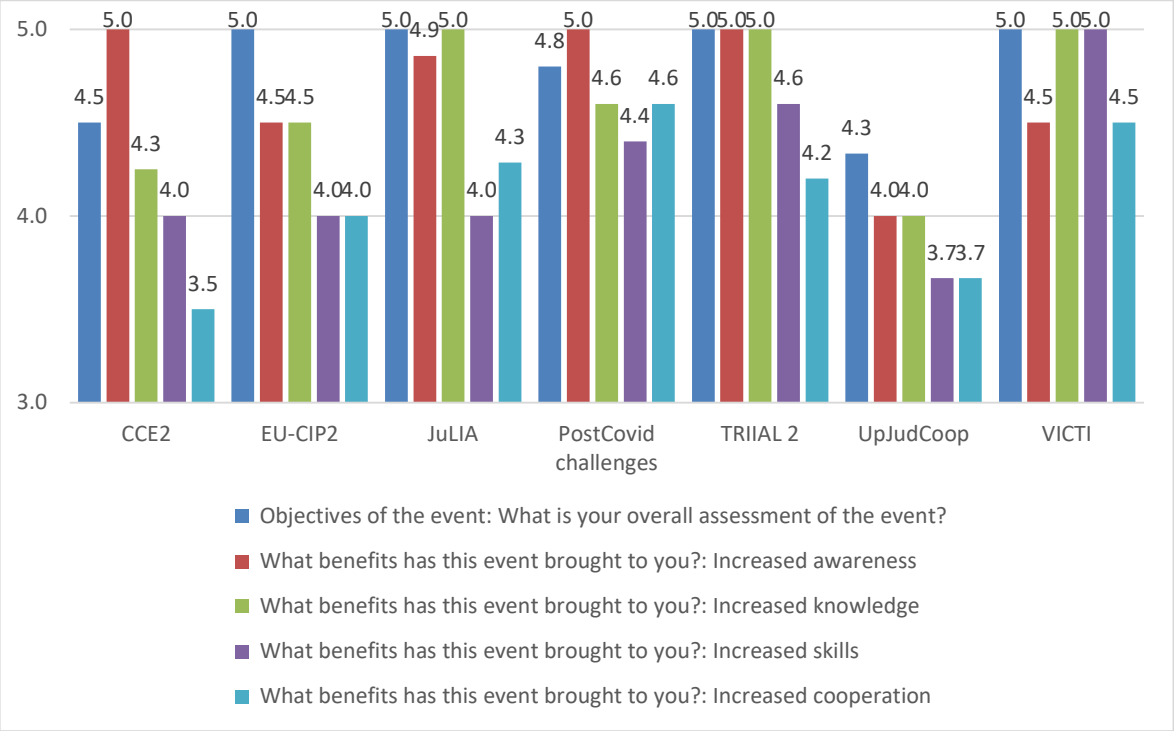


Figure 31. Breakdown of the Level of Satisfaction by Project



Following the overview of satisfaction levels, the table below provides a breakdown of the same parameters for each individual training project. While most training activities received high ratings, with several achieving a perfect score of 5 out of 5, the UpJudCoop project received a relatively lower overall rating of 4.3, with an even lower score in the category of skills and cooperation benefits. Similarly, the CCE2 training received an overall rating of 4.5, but registered a mediocre rating of 3.5 for the benefit of cooperation.

Detailed Analysis of Interviewees who attended JuLIA

Project Information

The JuLIA project is targeted primarily at members of the judiciary, judicial staff, and lawyers across Europe. The training aims to enhance their understanding of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Automated Decision Making (ADM) systems, with a focus on their implications for fundamental rights. The audience is targeted as such to ensure those involved in legal decision-making are equipped to navigate the emerging challenges posed by AI in areas such as judicial, administrative, and medical decision-making, as well as business-related contexts like consumer protection.

The project employs a hybrid training approach, combining face-to-face workshops, e-learning modules, and practical sessions such as justice laboratories. Six transnational training events form the core of the training, which includes case-based workshops and interdisciplinary collaboration between legal and technical experts. The training content focuses on practical issues like biases in AI systems, ensuring non-discrimination, and the transparency of decision-making processes in both judicial and non-judicial contexts.

The expected learning outcomes for participants include improved competence in handling AI-related legal issues, enhanced ability to interpret new AI legislation in line with EU principles, and a deeper understanding of the technical workings of ADM systems. Trainees will be better prepared to assess the implications of AI tools in judicial settings and will contribute to a coherent application of EU law in this rapidly evolving area.

Knowledge and Skills Learned

Participants in the JuLIA training program found it highly beneficial for expanding their understanding of AI in the context of EU law. Judge b7 highlighted the practical nature of the course, saying, "As judges, we were required to revise decisions taken by AI and see if the decision taken by AI is compatible with the one of the judge." Similarly, Judge b3, a tax judge, valued learning about AI in predictive justice, despite not using it directly in her work, noting that the training "will make a difference in my way of working."

Several participants indicated that the training provided them with insights into specific areas of EU law. Judge b17 emphasised that their knowledge of the Directive on Artificial Intelligence had improved, particularly in relation to justice matters. Judge b16, who serves on Lithuania's judicial council, found the focus on AI in healthcare decision-making and related liability issues particularly relevant. The shared knowledge between international colleagues was also highlighted, with Judge b14 stating, "It's amazing to see that although we're coming from different legal systems, we arrive at similar outcomes."

Practical Changes Based on the Training

Some participants noted practical changes following the training. For example, Judge b14 shared the knowledge gained with colleagues handling healthcare cases, emphasising that "I shared all the new knowledge I got with my colleagues at my court." In contrast, Judge b3 and b17 were not yet able to directly apply what they had learned, with Judge b3 stating, "I did not have time to apply the tools presented in the training, but I plan to explore them later."

The introduction of AI in judicial work was a key topic, with several participants seeing potential for AI tools to assist in legal research and decision-making. Judge b3 suggested, "AI can become important to search for decisions, find arguments, and help us reason on decisions." Judge b7 shared a similar sentiment, noting that Spain's Ministry of Justice was implementing AI tools to help synthesise legal files and jurisprudence. Judge b12, however, expressed that while AI had potential, there had been no direct application in their work so far.

Suggestions to Improve JuLIA in the Future

Judge b7 pointed out that online training, though accessible, could be considered boring by some judges, suggesting that more practical examples and applications would help. Judge b11 emphasised the importance of offering translation services, particularly for older judges who might find language barriers a significant obstacle: "For older judges, it's harder to come to these seminars. Sometimes, for them, it's just the problem of booking a flight or English."

Networking opportunities were seen as vital by several participants. Judge b14 valued the ability to share experiences with colleagues from different countries, while Judge b3 wished there had been more opportunities to engage directly with other participants, stating, "I would have liked to speak to [the German judge], but I couldn't."

Finally, Judge b16 suggested that future training should consider court levels, noting that "the problems are not the same depending on the level of the court." This would allow more tailored training that addresses the specific needs of judges working at different judicial levels.

Detailed Analysis of Interviewees who attended TRIIAL 2

Project Information

The TRIIAL 2 project aimed at training key justice professionals across the European Union, including judges, prosecutors, and lawyers. These professionals are central to upholding the EU's rule of law, ensuring judicial independence, impartiality, and accountability, as well as safeguarding fundamental rights. The project specifically

targeted those in positions to influence and reinforce legal standards within their jurisdictions, especially in light of recent challenges to the rule of law across several EU Member States.

The training was delivered through a combination of online, hybrid, and in-person events, ensuring flexibility and accessibility for participants. The project included 12 cross-border training events, each focusing on a different aspect of rule of law and judicial standards, supported by interactive materials and case studies. These sessions were designed to promote peer exchange and practical application of the principles being taught. An e-repository of training materials was available to participants for ongoing reference.

The expected outcomes of the TRIIAL 2 project included enhanced understanding of the EU's evolving legal framework related to judicial independence, mutual trust, and freedom of expression. By participating, legal professionals would improve their ability to apply European legal standards in their daily work, fostering cross-border collaboration and a more robust European judicial network. This training aimed to ensure participants can effectively address rule of law issues and contribute to the long-term preservation of EU legal principles.

Knowledge and Skills Learned

Judge b8 reflected on the value of the seminar, particularly in understanding the different challenges faced by judges in Central and Eastern European countries, acknowledging that “We have less history of democracy, less knowledge of EU law than in other parts of Europe maybe.” Similarly, Judge b9 emphasised the importance of learning about judicial communication and freedom of expression: “The appropriate content of communication in the public space (social networks) in terms of independence, impartiality and trust in the judiciary will remain relevant in the future.”

Judge b19 appreciated the broader European perspective offered during the TRIIAL 2 training, specifically on how criminal law rulings can serve societal purposes beyond individual cases, which they found fascinating. “Unlike in Hungary, where such rulings are typically seen as a means to conclude individual cases, I learned that in countries like Poland, Romania, and Portugal, they are used to address broader societal issues,” they remarked.

Practical Changes Based on the Training

Several judges reflected on how the training might influence their practical work. Judge b9 mentioned how relevant it was to improve their understanding of the use of social media by judges, stating that “Communication through the media is an important element, both to build confidence in the judiciary and to defend against unlawful interference.” This training encouraged them to consider how to better use these platforms to promote judicial independence.

Participants did not see direct change in their work due to this training. Judge b22 shared that her practical changes stemmed from an EJTN exchange programme rather than TRIIAL 2, where she adjusted her courtroom practices based on observations from Germany, focusing on fostering better dialogue between lawyers.

Suggestions to Improve TRIIAL 2 in the Future

Participants had constructive suggestions for improving the TRIIAL 2 programme. Judge b08 highlighted the importance of including more international trainers, noting that “When a local trainer affirms the same thing, it has less weight, and it’s harder for the other judges to accept that opinion.” They suggested that foreign experts might help change judicial practices in Croatia.

Judge b09 suggested that a specific training activity on the emerging role of press judges across Europe would be beneficial. They said, “Lithuania is currently introducing a press

judge institute… training at EU level on this institute would be really useful for the development of common standards."

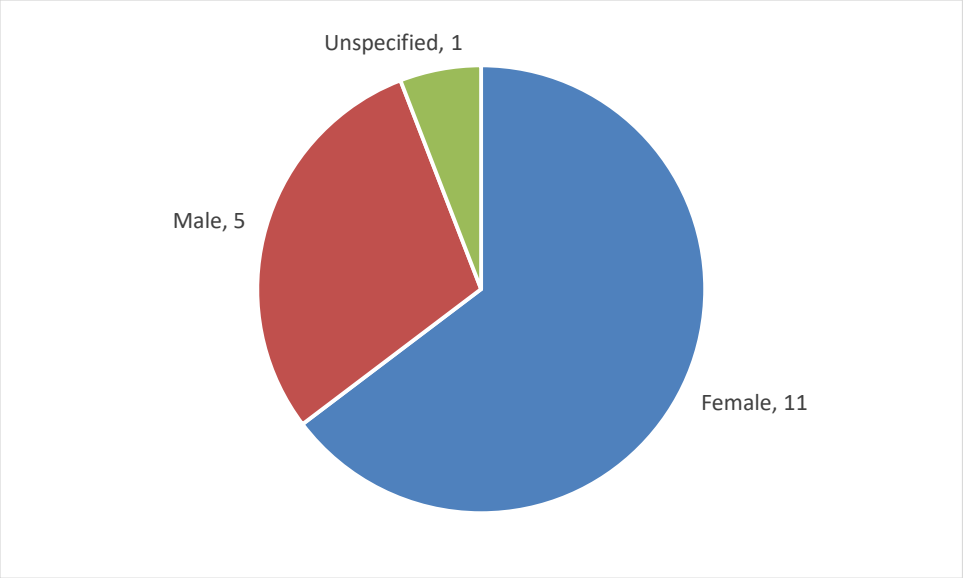
Finally, Judge b20 noted that hybrid formats pose challenges for interaction, stating that "When it's hybrid, the interaction does not work so good, compared to an in-person training." They emphasised the need for improvements in fostering more active engagement between participants in such formats.

Interviews with lawyers

Background of Participants

Seventeen lawyers participated in the interviews, representing a diverse range of nationalities. The participants come from the following countries: Ireland (3), Czechia (3), Romania (2), Bulgaria (1), Belgium (1), Cyprus (1), Slovakia (1), Slovenia (1), France (1), Italy (1), Netherlands (1), and one from an unspecified EU candidate country. Most participated in face-to-face (15), one online and one hybrid training activities.

Figure 32. Gender Distribution of Lawyers Interviewees



Among the 17 respondents to our interview, female participants accounted for the majority, with 11 respondents, compared to 6 from other gender groups.

Motivation to Enrol in JTRA Training

The motivations for enrolling in the JTRA training were diverse. Many participants sought to deepen their understanding of EU law and its application to their specific legal fields. L1 explained that they joined the LawyerEX programme to gain insights into how a Polish law firm operates, stating, "For me, it was very interesting to get into the day-to-day practice of a Polish law firm."

For others, the application of the training with their professional focus was key. L2, who specialises in European Arrest Warrant cases, shared, "The best thing about this type of trainings. You get another perspective when you see how certain provisions are applied in other countries and get ideas what could be changed in your own country." Similarly, L3, was keen to learn about SLAPP cases, remarking, "The course was excellent and fully met my expectations."

Some participants pursued the training to address specific national challenges. L7, a criminal lawyer, sought to understand "whether Romania's national legal provisions are in line with EU regulations" and to assess the situation of freedom of expression for judges and prosecutors in Romania.

Travel and Accessibility

The accessibility of the training varied among participants, with some attending in person and others online. While most found the travel manageable, a few participants highlighted challenges. L11 remarked, "The first day posed some challenges due to fatigue from travel as my group arrived at the hotel late the night before," which made it difficult to fully engage with the initial lectures. In contrast, L6 appreciated the convenience of online participation, stating, "Webinars allow me to take part and still be at work so it has its own added value."

Training Topics and Complexity

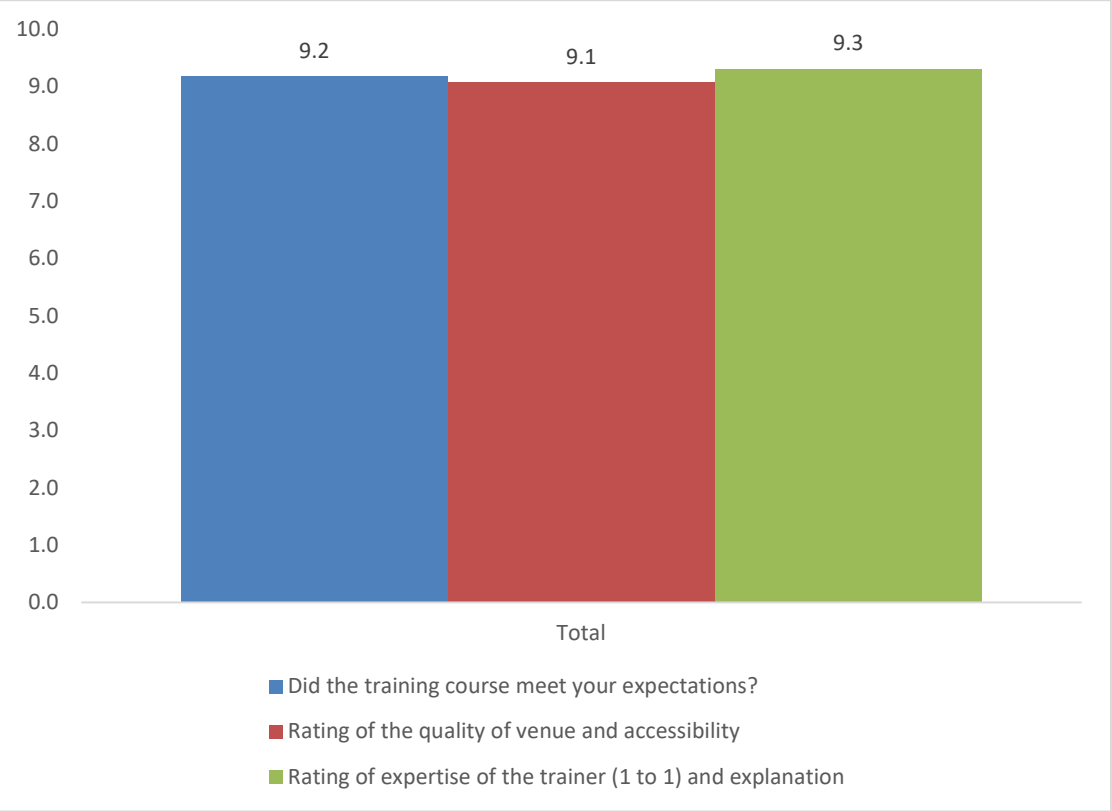
The participants generally found the training topics to be relevant and informative. L10 noted that the content exceeded their expectations, particularly appreciating the session with a Member of the European Parliament. They remarked, "The training he attended in Brighton proved beneficial as it featured a Member of the European Parliament who provided perspectives on the inconsistencies in legal applications across member states."

However, some felt the training could have gone deeper into certain areas. L5 commented, "The quality of content was excellent that's why I felt they needed more time to elaborate on it properly." L6, meanwhile, highlighted the limitations of applying what was learned in their local practice, explaining, "I had a clear idea of what was presented but I can't actually apply it in practice as most of my cases concern Albanian intellectual property law."

Quantitative Overview

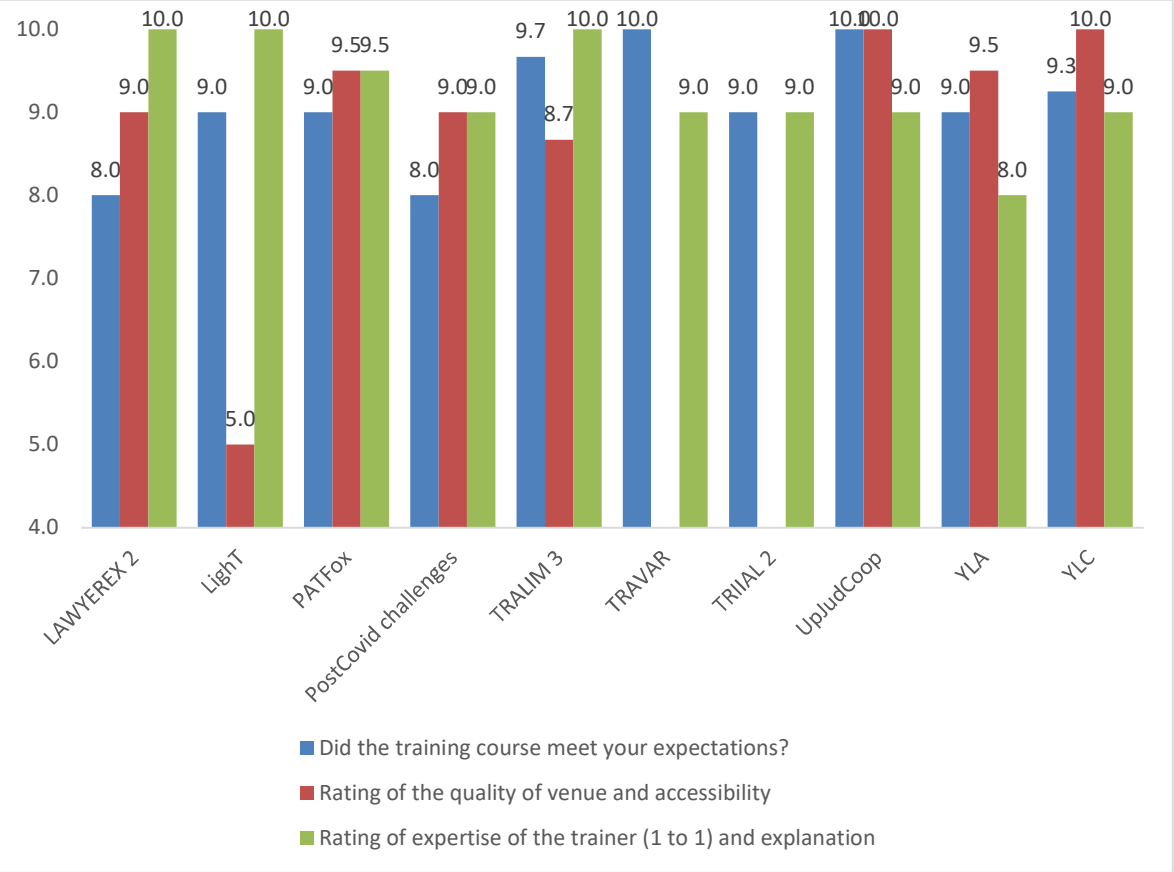
When asked whether the training met their expectations, respondents provided positive feedback, with an average rating of 9.2. The quality of the venue and its accessibility also received favourable reviews, with an average rating of 9.1. Respondents expressed equal satisfaction with the trainer's expertise and the clarity of their explanations, awarding a rating of 9.3. Overall, the training received overwhelmingly positive reviews.

Figure 33. Ratings on Meeting Expectations, Venue and Expertise of the Trainers



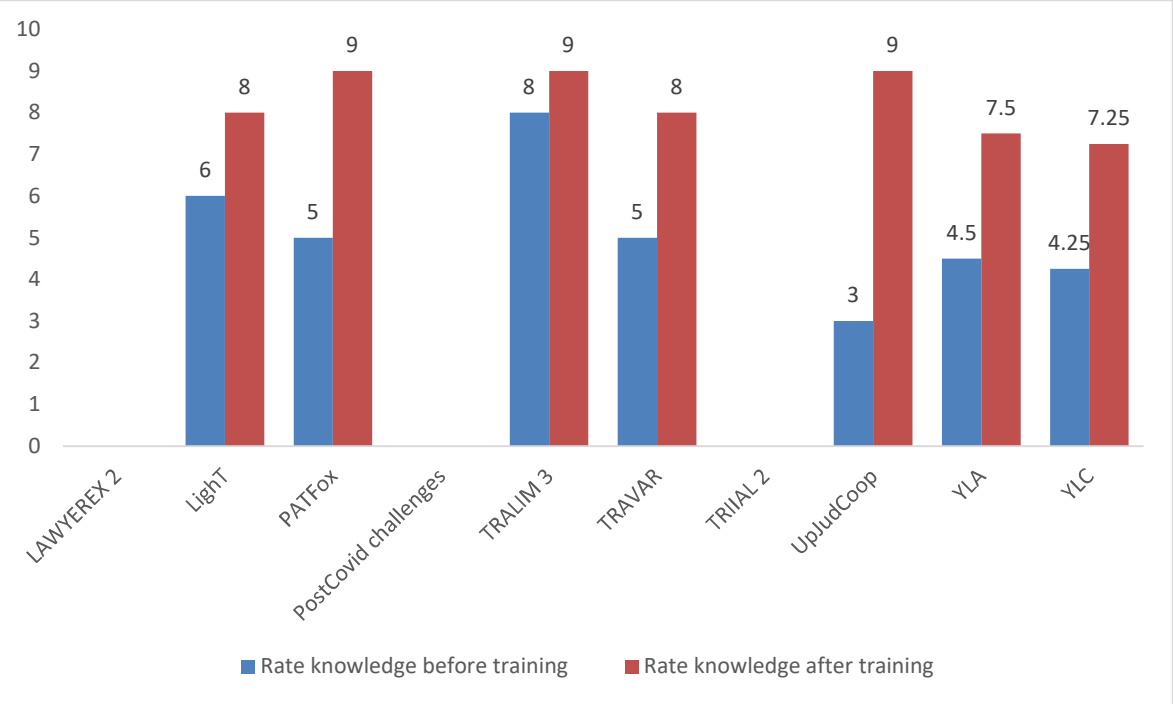
Upon closer examination of each individual training session, despite each session having only one to four respondents, the feedback was generally positive. One exception was a respondent who gave a neutral rating of 5 for the quality of the venue and accessibility. However, all other areas were rated above 8 across the board. It is worth noting that some respondents did not provide feedback regarding the venue or accessibility for the TRAVAR and TRIIAL 2 training activities.

Figure 34. Ratings on Meeting Expectations, Venue and Expertise of the Trainers by Individual Project



When asked to rate their knowledge level before and after the training, the data shows that all sessions effectively enhanced participants' knowledge, where responses were provided. In one instance, it increased from an already high knowledge level of 8 to a 9 after the TRALIM 3 training. The most notable improvement was observed in the UpJudCoop training, where one respondent reported a substantial increase in knowledge, rising from 3 to 9, highlighting the strong impact of the training.

Figure 35. Rating of the Lawyer Interviewees' Knowledge before and after the Training



The participants' ratings of the training ranged from 8 to 10. L1 rated their experience as an 8, sharing that "My expectations are met 80% but I expected a little bit more preparation on the part of the law firm." L3, meanwhile, gave the training a 10, stating, "The course was excellent and fully met my expectations." L15, who rated the training 8, noted that they had not expected the depth of coverage on digital legal developments, remarking that "Although the focus was initially presented as being on post-COVID challenges, I found that the depth of knowledge and coverage of the latest developments in the legal area exceeded her expectations by the end of the course."

Overall Learnings and Quality of Training

Overall, the participants expressed satisfaction with the quality of the training. The materials and presentations were widely regarded as clear and engaging. L9 commented, "By the end of the training I had a general understanding of the topic which had some practical value." Similarly, L2 praised the interactive nature of the sessions, stating, "The structure was great almost all lectures were very interactive both the rule of law and the SLAPP lectures were very useful to her."

Effectiveness of Networking

Networking opportunities were appreciated by most participants, although some felt there could have been more structured opportunities. L4 remarked on the benefits of networking during the events, explaining, "I used the contacts I created during the events. For example, last year I had a client who had an issue with Cypriot immigration law. I emailed one of the presenters from there who was able to provide me with the advice that my client needed." On the other hand, L5 felt that the time allocated for networking was too limited, stating, "There was insufficient opportunity to network during the training as interactions were mostly limited to coffee breaks and lunch."

Practical Application of Training

Several participants highlighted the practical impact of the training on their work. L3, for example, felt better prepared to handle potential SLAPP cases in the future, sharing, "I now knows what SLAPPs are and will be able to identify them." L10 mentioned that their understanding of European law had improved, which was reflected in changes to their work practices: "Some of the decisions and cases now reflect the insights presented during the training indicating that updates have been incorporated into their decision-making processes."

Digitalisation and Future Training Needs

Digitalisation was touched upon in some training sessions, although participants noted that it was not always a central focus. L6, who attended a training on intellectual property law, remarked, "I understood about some aspects of IP law that were actually enforced through customs and how the system of customs have been recently digitalised and more proficiently used nowadays."

However, many participants expressed a desire for more focused training on digitalisation. L7 observed that "the course did not specifically focus on digitalisation" despite the growing relevance of digital tools in legal practice. Looking ahead, participants like L11 expressed interest in future training on EU law updates, particularly in areas such as worker movement laws, stating, "There is widespread confusion about its implications as many individuals across various settings seem to lack clarity on the subject."

Interviews with court staff

Background of Participants

Seven interviews were conducted in total, with court staff from Belgium, the Czech Republic, North Macedonia, Romania and Spain. All seven respondents attended in-person training as part of project no. 101089604 - Training court staff and bailiffs in European cross-border civil and criminal law procedures. Their experience as court staff ranged from 3 to 28 years.

Project Title: Training court staff and bailiffs in European cross-border civil and criminal law procedures

The CSAB Training project (Project ID: 101089604) is currently open and runs from 01 January 2023 to 31 March 2025, with an overall budget of 577 782 EUR and an EU contribution of 520 004 EUR. It is coordinated by ERA and is funded under the Justice Programme (JUST).

Objective

The CSAB Training project addresses the insufficient training in EU law for court staff and bailiffs. It aims to enhance their knowledge and skills through a modern and practical approach to EU judicial training.

Key Activities

- Beneficiaries: 500 court staff and 50 bailiffs
- Training Events: 10 language training events and 11 pan-European legal seminars
- Focus Areas: EU civil and criminal law, digitalisation, and legal English
- Training Levels: Basic and advanced
- Formats: Face-to-face, hybrid, and online seminars
- Locations: 17 face-to-face seminars in 9 different EU countries

The training approach includes practical training based on updated standardised template programmes and training packages, such as case studies and linguistic manuals, and the development of an interactive e-tool for legal English in criminal matters, usable for blended learning or as a stand-alone self-learning tool. The goals are to raise awareness of the need for EU law training for court staff and bailiffs, provide coherent and innovative training packages for future use, and contribute to the effective application of EU law by all justice professions.

Motivation to Enrol in Training

The reasons given by the respondents for applying to the training generally centred around wanting to improve their legal English, needing to learn about cross-border judicial cooperation (particularly around the European Arrest Warrant or regulations relating to seizure and confiscation), and wanting to share and compare experiences with colleagues from other EU countries. They generally heard about the training through their local judicial training institutions, and very few of them engaged in pre-training beyond reading materials provided in advance as part of the course.

Travel and Accessibility

There were no comments about the accessibility of the venue.

Training Topics and Complexity

Participants' knowledge before the training was generally limited, and they all reported significant improvements after taking the training. Legal English, the use of the European Investigation Order and freezing orders, collecting and handling evidence, and interpretation of case law were all named as areas the course had helped them understand better. While many participants said they were more motivated to take additional training as a result of the course, and several named electronic evidence, cyber-crime or civil procedure as areas they'd be interested in, there was limited evidence of follow-up learning at the time of the interviews.

Financial investigations in the EU, the European Payment Order, cyber-crime, collection of electronic evidence, and insolvency procedures in various member states were all cited as topics respondents felt were missing from the training offer. There was a general consensus that the legal profession would benefit from more training, although respondents differed in their thoughts on who needed its most – more training for court staff, particularly cross-border investigation training for bailiffs, was cited, but so was language training for judges.

Quantitative Overview

All participants found the training highly beneficial, with ratings ranging from 8/10 to 10/10. For instance, CS1 and CS2 from Romania rated the training 10/10, appreciating the latest developments and practical information provided. Similarly, CS3 from North Macedonia and CS4 from Belgium also rated the training 10/10, highlighting the practical examples and group work. CS5 from Belgium rated the training 8/10, valuing the opportunity to study internet sites related to European cooperation in criminal matters.

The course structure, involving case studies, group exercises and PowerPoint presentations containing relevant information, was well-appreciated by respondents, with nobody rating the course lower than 8 out of 10.

Overall Learnings and Quality of Training

The course was considered high quality - all participants rated the expertise of their trainer at least 8 out of 10, and all were complimentary of the quality of the training materials provided, although the answers to the exercises not being provided after the fact was raised as an issue by one respondent.

All of the participants said the training had improved their ability to use EU law, although as court staff, it did not have much of an impact on their daily work beyond making them more efficient on those occasions when they did have to use EU legal instruments. Several continue to refer to their training materials or notes to assist them in their work.

Participants across the board gained significant insights into EU tools and procedures. CS1 and CS2 learned about the European Investigation Order and freezing orders, while CS3 improved their understanding of the European Arrest Warrant (EAW) and the Council of Europe's convention on international cooperation in criminal matters. CS4 and CS5 emphasised the importance of learning about collecting evidence and the application of regulation 2018/1805. CS7 from Czechia found the training on handling evidence and serving documents particularly useful.

Effectiveness of Networking

They appreciated the networking opportunities provided, and several of them still maintained contact with other participants they had met during the course, although mostly in a personal capacity.

Practical Application of Training

Most participants shared their new knowledge with colleagues and found the training materials useful in their daily work. CS1 and CS2 from Romania felt more confident in applying the learned concepts, while CS3 from North Macedonia noted that their knowledge of using the EJN database significantly sped up their work. CS4 from Belgium compared the training material to what is used in Belgium and found it useful, although no significant changes to work practices were reported. CS7 from Czechia circulated her training notes throughout her workplace, making her more efficient.

Respondents were generally not able to alter work practices or organisational processes as a result of what they had learned due to a lack of autonomy or authority to make such decisions, nor were they in a position to affect digitalisation of justice in their workplace. Several circulated training materials to their colleagues after the fact.

Digitalisation and Future Training Needs

Respondents did not have much to say about digitalisation of justice – digital case management systems were named as particularly helpful, as were the European Justice Portal and Judicial Atlas.

Suggestions for Further Training

Participants suggested various areas for further training. CS1 and CS2 highlighted the importance of digital tools and better communication channels with competent authorities. CS3 suggested more courses on financial investigations, cybercrime, and the collection of electronic evidence. CS4 recommended more training on the European Payment Order and noted that lawyers and bailiffs could benefit from additional training. CS5 emphasised that every new topic related to cooperation in criminal matters in the EU could be the subject of a training. CS6 from Spain suggested training on insolvency procedures in other member states, and CS7 recommended that more court staff should take similar courses.

Other Comments

Participants noted the importance of continuous learning and staying updated on digital tools. CS1 and CS2 from Romania mentioned the challenge of adapting to new digital tools but stressed the cumulative productivity benefits. CS3 from North Macedonia highlighted the benefits of the digital case management system in their office. CS4 from Belgium frequently uses and gives training on the European Justice Portal. CS5 from Belgium emphasised the importance of cooperation with colleagues to stay updated on

digital tools. CS6 from Spain and CS7 from Czechia both emphasised the importance of continuous learning and the need for more training for court staff.

Interviews with bailiffs

Overall Comments on the Training

All bailiffs found their training beneficial, though their ratings varied. Ba1 from France and Ba2 from the Netherlands rated their training highly (10/10 and 8/10, respectively), appreciating the interactive format and networking opportunities. Ba3 from Germany had a mixed experience, rating the training 6/10 due to organisational issues and lack of support.

Key Learnings from the Training

All participants highlighted the importance of the training for enhancing their knowledge and maintaining English proficiency. Ba1 and Ba2 valued learning about the daily work of colleagues from different countries and understanding various judicial systems. Ba3 appreciated learning about the Portuguese judicial system, particularly the centralised data recording at the Amtsgericht.

Application of the Training in Work

The bailiffs applied their learnings in different ways. Ba1 trained their staff on EU regulations and suggested practical examples for future training. Ba2 discussed the training with colleagues and used the knowledge to handle cross-border cases more effectively. Ba3 shared their learnings about the electronic assignment of judge responsibilities in Portugal with colleagues.

Systematic Changes or Other Learnings

The training motivated all participants to pursue further learning and maintain their professional networks. Ba1 and Ba2 noted that the training helped in resolving cross-border issues more efficiently. Ba3 emphasised the need for better pre-arrival information and language support for future training programs.

Focus groups with prison training academies

The online meeting included representatives from Finland, France, the Netherlands, Bulgaria, Ireland, Poland, Slovakia, Estonia, and Germany (Berlin). Romania was unable to attend but provided written input via email, which has been integrated into the discussion.

The focus group was structured into three key topics for exchange, with poll questions and participant elaborations.

National framework for training and how EU law or EU policy topics are embedded within national training activities

The aim was to understand how EU law matters are incorporated within national training activities.

Poll question 1: Do you have a national training strategy in place for prison and probation officers for 2021-2024?

Most Member States, including Bulgaria, Germany, Estonia, France, Ireland, the Netherlands, and Poland, confirmed having a national training strategy in place. Estonia highlighted having both a national training strategy and framework.

Poll question 2: Do you provide training on EU law or EU policy topics?

Responses varied, with some Member States like Bulgaria and Poland integrating EU law into their national training framework, while others like Germany and Ireland did not have specific courses on EU law. Estonia mentioned that EU law is taught in an embedded way, focusing on fundamental rights and principles rather than specific classes on EU law.

Participants noted that EU law was integrated into their training content, particularly with a focus on fundamental rights and situating national law within the EU law framework. Most Member States did not have specific courses solely on EU law, but if training explicitly referenced EU law, it was often related to human/fundamental rights, such as the EU Charter of Fundamental Rights.

Impact of the JTS

The aim was to understand participants' awareness of the Judicial Training Strategy (JTS) and its relevance to prison and probation officers.

Poll question 1: Are you aware of the Judicial Training Strategy?

Most participants were not aware of the JTS or did not find it relevant to prison and probation staff training. This question was not further debated as it seemed political.

Poll question 2: Do you provide training on any of the following?

Member States usually covered topics such as developments in EU case law, rule of law and fundamental rights, addressing and preventing radicalisation in prisons, factors promoting the success of rehabilitation programmes, cross-border training or exchanges, skills for dealing with difficult inmates, and cross-border transfers of prisoners. The angle of training varied depending on national context and legal requirements. Estonia highlighted the difficulty in designing rehabilitation programmes for crimes against common morals and values. Poland mentioned collaboration with the Norwegian training academy for training didactics.

Quality measures were discussed, with Germany systematically evaluating training courses using questionnaires and considering external training quality standards. Bulgaria had monthly exchanges to discuss feedback, while France adapted training courses based on evaluation cycles. Ireland used accredited external trainers and found that experienced staff impacted the training of newly recruited staff.

Future training needs

The aim was to understand the provision of e-learning platforms and current training on digitalisation of the justice system, as well as future training needs and EU support.

Poll question 1: Do you provide an e-learning platform for training courses for prisons and probation officers?

Most Member States, including Germany, Estonia, France, and Ireland, provided e-learning platforms or were developing them. Slovakia did not have an e-learning platform but delivered training on cyber security via online presentations.

Poll question 2: Do you provide training on any of the following?

Training on digital tools, restorative justice, data protection issues, electronic tagging, and cyber security varied among Member States. Estonia was advanced in digitalisation, with all inmates having tablets and training on digital hygiene. Slovakia noted a need for training on cyber security and critical thinking skills to avoid disinformation. Poland used digital tools during training but did not focus on them as training subjects.

Future training needs included e-learning courses tailored to the needs of prison officers, violence prevention, sex discrimination, corruption, handling organised crime, and training on the safe and secure imprisonment of transgender inmates. Estonia prioritised restorative justice, while Bulgaria and Germany (Berlin) focused on radicalisation of inmates. Pre-trial detention was also highlighted as an area requiring more attention.

Participants discussed the need for EU support with training, highlighting the high administrative burden of multi-country and multi-annual projects. They suggested more bilateral projects and shorter training projects to reduce the burden. The EPTA was noted as providing support and being the network for academies.

5.5 Interviews with researchers

The following provides a short summary of points highlighted in three interviews with researchers on judicial training. The researchers were, Marco Velicogna, Simone Benvenuti and Tobias Nowak.

- Digital Transformation in the Judiciary: Researchers emphasized the challenges and opportunities of integrating digital tools and systems into judicial processes.
- Training and Development: Ensuring that judges and judicial staff receive adequate training on new digital platforms and procedures was highlighted as crucial. This includes EU-funded projects like TREIO and initiatives by national judicial training institutes.
- Cross-Border Cooperation: The importance of harmonizing judicial procedures across member states to facilitate smoother cross-border legal processes was discussed. Tools like eCodex were mentioned as crucial for this purpose.
- Networking and Knowledge Exchange: The value of building networks among judges and judicial staff was emphasized. This helps in sharing best practices and improving the application of EU law.
- Sustainability and Funding: Concerns were raised about the sustainability of training programs, with a call for more long-term funding and support to maintain networks and training initiatives.
- Role of National and EU-Level Organizations: The role of organizations like the EJTN and national judicial training institutes in coordinating and delivering training was highlighted. The potential for EU professional organizations to support training through exchanges and networked learning was also noted. The latter could provide also for a multiplier effect and provide learning opportunities that are less costly.

Annex 6 - National judicial training institutes – responses to the survey from ICF

In this section, we detail the survey responses across several dimensions.[3]

6.1 National Training Framework and Objectives

Austria focuses on continuous professional development for judges and prosecutors, covering both legal and non-legal skills. There is no mandatory minimum training requirement, but participation in training is emphasised as part of their responsibilities.

Belgium manages its national training framework through the Judicial Training Institute, which ensures initial and continuous training for magistrates and court staff. Judges and prosecutors are encouraged to participate in EU training programmes, subject to hierarchical approval.

Bulgaria provides continuous training as a right and obligation through the National Institute of Justice, emphasising EU law, ethics, and non-legal skills such as communication and leadership. Training is designed to address specific needs and professional roles, with no mandatory number of days allocated.

Cyprus offers 2–3 days of training annually through the Cyprus Judicial Training School, focusing on judicial skills, EU law, and national legislation updates. Judges are not legally required to complete annual training but are encouraged to attend.

Czech Republic does not make continuous training compulsory but highly recommends it through court and prosecutor management. Training objectives include staying updated on legal developments and improving judicial skills and case management.

Estonia emphasises the professional development of judges but does not require compulsory training hours. Judges are expected to enhance their knowledge regularly and complete initial skills programmes as needed.

Finland mandates that judges maintain and develop their legal knowledge and professional skills, though no specific training hours are required. Training is supported by the National Court Administration.

France requires judges and prosecutors to complete five days of training annually, focusing on updating professional skills and integrating EU law. Training programmes are managed by the École Nationale de la Magistrature (ENM) and include innovative formats to enhance learning.

Greece organises continuous training through the National School of Judiciary to help judicial officers adapt to evolving legal and social conditions. Judges must participate in at least one seminar annually (12 hours per year), and while no specific days are allocated, they receive reimbursement for travel and accommodation during training.

Hungary provides separate training frameworks for judges and prosecutors, focusing on continuous training to equip prosecutors with practical knowledge and prepare trainees for the bar exam. Prosecutors must accumulate 50 credit points over a five-year training cycle, with courses scheduled annually and fully paid during participation.

Italy exclusively manages judicial training through the Higher School of the Judiciary (SSM), including initial internships and professional updates for judges and prosecutors. Judges are required to attend at least one training session annually for the first four years

[3] We present each respondent's views as 'France says that...' rather than 'the respondent from France expressed the view that...' for the sake of facilitating reading.

and one every four years thereafter, though no specific days are allocated, and training is considered part of their service.

Latvia organises annual training programmes through its Judicial Training Centre for judges and court staff, based on consultations with judicial councils and other stakeholders. While training is not mandatory, it is a right and duty of judges, and participation is supported by flexible schedules and salary retention during sessions.

Lithuania aims to ensure an impartial, competent, and efficient judiciary through its judicial training framework, focusing on skill improvement and knowledge enhancement. However, no specific responses were provided on mandatory training or allocated days.

Malta mandates 36 hours of training annually for judges and magistrates, coordinated by the Judicial Studies Committee. Specific days are allocated for training, and participants receive their normal salaries during attendance.

Portugal focuses its continuous training for magistrates on updating legal and professional skills, with an annual requirement of 32 hours for career advancement. Judges and prosecutors attend training on designated days, but participation in cross-border exchanges can be hindered by authorisation processes and participant limitations.

Romania aims to improve training quality and promote EU legal concepts through the National Institute of Magistracy (NIM). Judges and prosecutors must attend at least one training session every three years, and while specific days are not allocated, training is considered part of their duties with salary retention.

Slovenia provides non-mandatory training through its Judicial Training Centre for judges and prosecutors, except for newly appointed court and prosecutor office leaders who must complete 24 hours of training in their first year. Training is part of their job requirements, and participants are fully paid.

Sweden includes 8 weeks of initial compulsory training for prosecutors over two years and continuous training for 3–5 days annually. While no specific days are allocated, training is fully paid, including per diem and travel allowances.

6.2 Training Content and Delivery

Austria says that courses on legal issues systematically embed relevant EU law, with an estimated 20% average share in training content. EU law integration varies by topic, with higher inclusion in areas like competition law.

Belgium incorporates CoE HELP platform content into its digital library but currently lacks direct links to the European Training Platform. EU law is systematically embedded in relevant training topics.

Bulgaria systematically embeds EU law in training content due to its importance in judicial cooperation and the Europeanisation of national law. Links to both CoE HELP and the European Training Platform are included in relevant programmes.

Cyprus promotes existing e-learning platforms, such as HELP, and integrates EU law into substantive legal training when applicable. Specific training sessions on EU law topics, including environmental law and competition law, are also conducted.

Czech Republic estimates that EU law content is systematically embedded in approximately 30–50% of courses, with variations based on training needs. Links to CoE HELP and the European Training Platform are maintained.

Denmark does not link directly to external platforms like the European Training Platform but incorporates EU law into national courses wherever relevant.

Estonia has no links to the European Training Platform but includes CoE HELP resources in its training. EU law content varies depending on the topic and is not systematically included in all training.

Finland integrates European law into other areas of law during training where relevant. The National Court Administration manages Finland's e-learning platform.

France incorporates EU law into its training through innovative teaching formats and a mix of e-learning, group work, and discussions. Links to the CoE HELP platform are included in ENM's training resources.

Greece embeds EU law in approximately half of its training seminars, with topics clearly specified in agendas. However, there is no mention of links to the European Training Platform or CoE HELP platform.

Hungary systematically integrates EU law into at least 30–35% of its training, with some courses focused entirely on new EU regulations. The country provides access to both the European Training Platform and CoE HELP platform.

Italy incorporates EU law content systematically in all courses organised by the Higher School of the Judiciary (SSM). While courses can also be accessed online, Italy maintains links to relevant international training platforms.

Latvia ensures EU law is integrated into at least 30% of its training, either through specific case law discussions or focused sessions. The country actively collaborates with the CoE HELP platform and markets its programmes to judicial staff.

Lithuania reports that individual lecturers determine the extent of EU law integration, with no fixed standard. The country does not provide specific links to European Training Platforms.

Malta delivers training content with equal emphasis on EU law and domestic law, ensuring a balanced approach. However, no links to European platforms are explicitly mentioned.

Portugal estimates that no less than 30% of its training focuses on EU law content, with some sessions specifically dedicated to it. The Centre for Judicial Studies incorporates HELP CoE courses and relevant European content into its programmes.

Romania integrates EU law into approximately 30–35% of its training content, reflecting the European legal context in specific sessions. While links to platforms like HELP are not explicitly mentioned, Romania hosts EU-focused training seminars regularly.

Slovenia leaves the integration of EU law to the discretion of individual trainers and course topics, without a systematic approach. No direct links to European Training Platforms are noted.

Sweden systematically includes EU law in its initial and continuous training programmes, particularly in areas such as the European Arrest Warrant and European Investigation Orders. Links to CoE HELP and other platforms are included through the intranet for accessibility.

6.3 Trainer Profiles and Training for Trainers

Austria does not set specific requirements for trainers but typically uses experienced judges, prosecutors, court presidents, or academics. They offer training to trainers and provides courses on new methodologies, although convincing trainers to adopt these methods can be challenging.

Belgium has no formal requirements for trainers but uses judges, academics, and legal professionals. They offer its trainers opportunities to participate in EU-level courses and training on digitalisation and new methodologies.

Bulgaria requires trainers to have professional expertise, methodological skills, and familiarity with judicial ethics. Trainers participate in EU-level exchanges and are trained on innovative methodologies, including self-learning resources.

Cyprus selects trainers based on their pedagogical skills and legal expertise, providing train-the-trainer courses on judgecraft and judicial ethics. However, participation in EU-level exchanges or new training methodologies is not widely implemented.

Czech Republic requires trainers to have advanced legal education and at least 5–10 years of professional experience, typically as judges or prosecutors. Trainers receive opportunities for train-the-trainer events and are encouraged to use e-learning tools.

Denmark assesses trainers individually based on experience and their approach to education, with no fixed requirements. They train their trainers on EU-level topics but does not widely use new training methodologies.

Estonia typically uses judges or professionals from ministries or universities as trainers, without specific requirements. There is no mention of EU-level exchanges, participation in EU courses, or training in new methodologies for trainers.

Finland selects experienced judges as trainers, without mandatory requirements for EU-level or methodological training. Participation in advanced or cross-border training appears limited.

France requires trainers to have at least five years of experience, with additional pedagogical and professional qualifications for permanent trainers. They provide train-the-trainer courses on innovative methodologies and digitalisation to enhance teaching quality.

Greece requires trainers to demonstrate expertise, including academic qualifications, publications, and professional experience. Many trainers have attended EU-level seminars on e-learning and digital methods, and Greece uses a Kirkpatrick-based evaluation model to improve training.

Hungary uses respected university professors and prosecutors with a strong academic background and international experience as trainers. They provide access to EU-level exchanges and new methodologies through EJTN and HELP programmes.

Italy appoints highly qualified trainers, including judges, academics, and legal professionals, who are selected for their broad cultural and scientific expertise. They provide EU-level training and support for trainers, with regular updates on new methodologies.

Latvia uses trainers respected within the judiciary and supports them with regular workshops on new training methodologies. Their trainers participate in EU-level exchanges, and their sessions are regularly evaluated to identify areas for improvement.

Lithuania requires trainers to be highly qualified professionals, including judges from top courts, academics, and experts in related fields. However, there is no evidence of EU-level exchanges or specific training in innovative methodologies.

Malta relies on legal professionals, notaries, and judges with relevant specialisation as trainers but does not impose specific experience requirements. They train its trainers on e-learning tools and HELP platform usage.

Portugal selects trainers with extensive judicial or academic experience, including merit evaluations. They offer train-the-trainer courses annually, covering EU law, new methodologies, and e-learning tools.

Romania uses judges, prosecutors, and experts as trainers, with a minimum of six years of experience in their field. They provide digital training seminars for trainers and plans to expand e-learning tools for broader application.

Slovenia does not impose specific qualifications for trainers but ensures they have in-depth knowledge of their respective fields. There is little evidence of systematic training for trainers or participation in EU-level exchanges.

Sweden selects trainers with 3–5 years of experience and proven educational skills, prioritising senior prosecutors and legal professionals. They evaluate its trainers through participant feedback and focuses on developing their teaching methodologies.

6.4 Evaluation and Support Measures

Austria evaluates training through standardised IT tools and post-training questionnaires, with results used to adjust courses and identify new needs. However, Austria does not provide pre-course materials, post-training tests, individual follow-ups, or specific pedagogical standards.

Belgium uses Kirkpatrick levels 1 and 2 to evaluate training via participant questionnaires and provides feedback to trainers. Pre-course materials and post-training tests are not offered, and individual follow-ups are unavailable.

Bulgaria applies Kirkpatrick's model to evaluate training at levels 1–3 and has guidelines for level 4 impact assessment. Despite robust evaluation, Bulgaria lacks pre-course materials, post-training tests, and management feedback for trainers.

Cyprus evaluates training based on Kirkpatrick levels 1 and 2, with results used to refine course content and methods. Pre-course materials are provided, and standards are monitored, though there are no post-training tests.

Czech Republic uses various evaluation tools, including online questionnaires and participant discussions, to inform needs analyses. There are no post-training tests or individual follow-ups, but pre-course materials and monitoring are in place.

Denmark applies Kirkpatrick levels 1–3 to assess training through online surveys, using results for trainer feedback and course adjustments. Denmark does not offer participant profiling, post-training tests, individual follow-ups, or pedagogical standards.

Estonia evaluates training through feedback questionnaires and monitors annual participation targets. However, Estonia lacks post-training tests, individual follow-ups, and training standards, with limited feedback to trainers.

Finland conducts evaluations through the National Court Administration, reporting to the Judicial Training Board. However, it does not provide post-training tests, individual follow-ups, or consistent feedback to trainers, and its support measures are incomplete.

France uses pre- and post-session questionnaires for evaluations and provides feedback to trainers, integrating Kirkpatrick's approach. France does not conduct post-training tests or offer individual follow-ups.

Greece applies Kirkpatrick's model to training evaluations, focusing on participant feedback for refining future courses. It does not provide pre-course materials, post-training tests, or individual follow-ups.

Hungary evaluates training through Kirkpatrick levels, with results used to reorganise trainee prosecutor courses. There are no post-training tests, and follow-ups are not universally available.

Italy evaluates training through magistrate assessments every four years, linking results to career progression. Pre-course materials and follow-ups are missing in one set of responses, while another mentions comprehensive measures, including feedback for trainers.

Latvia evaluates training online using Likert scales, with results shared with trainers and participants. Pre-course materials and individual follow-ups are not available, though training standards and monitoring are implemented.

Lithuania collects participant feedback via questionnaires, but lacks post-training tests, follow-ups, and some support measures such as pre-course materials.

Malta evaluates training via the Judicial Studies Committee, though pre-course materials, post-training tests, and follow-ups are unavailable. Feedback to trainers and training standards are in place.

Portugal applies Kirkpatrick evaluations and participant surveys, using results for annual planning. Post-training tests and individual follow-ups are not provided, though pedagogical standards and monitoring are maintained.

Romania conducts evaluations through participant and trainer feedback, integrating results into annual programmes. Most support measures are implemented, except for post-training tests and follow-ups in some cases.

Slovenia evaluates training through participant feedback and shares results with trainers and the Expert Council. Slovenia lacks participant profiling, post-training tests, and individual follow-ups.

Sweden evaluates training through participant surveys, sharing results with course leaders for development. Sweden provides follow-ups and training standards but does not conduct post-training tests.

6.5 Feedback and Recommendations for EU-Financed Training Support

Austria believes EU-funded training significantly enhances participation, particularly through EJTN and ERA, and recommends simplifying funding processes for smaller nations. It states no additional trainer support is needed.

Belgium highlights that EU-funded training fosters international collaboration and knowledge exchange among magistrates, recommending reduced administrative burdens, improved funding visibility, and access to expert databases and didactical tools.

Bulgaria emphasises that EU funding is crucial for judicial training, supplementing limited budgets for continuous training, and suggests targeted funding for cross-border and EU law topics, with financial support being essential for offering more opportunities.

Cyprus notes that EU funding extensively supports participation and recommends specialised "Train-the-Trainer" (ToT) programs alongside the development of manuals and guidelines on EU law.

Czech Republic asserts that EU funding enables broader participation in international exchanges and suggests support for digitalisation, innovative methods, legal language courses, and training in case law analysis and digital skills.

Denmark states that EU-funded training is not applicable due to opt-outs and mentions no additional support is required as EU law is already integrated into relevant national training.

Estonia reports increased participation due to more varied curricula, highlighting the importance of funding domestic, language-specific training while identifying no specific additional needs.

France states that EU funding facilitates exchanges and recommends continuing cross-border training activities while offering more online courses and ToT initiatives.

Greece believes EU funding benefits around 90% of participants and recommends cross-border exchanges to share best practices and organise more EU law-oriented events.

Hungary notes that EU-funded training expands topics and participation and suggests simplifying application processes, making funding more flexible, and reducing trainers' workloads.

Italy acknowledges that EU funding promotes a "European legal conscience," considers current support sufficient, and does not suggest additional recommendations for trainers.

Latvia highlights that participation through EJTN is highly valued, recommending broadened exchanges and reduced workloads for trainer-judges to allow better preparation.

Lithuania believes EU funding enables growth in participation and suggests simplifying application processes and reducing trainers' workloads to enhance training delivery.

Malta states that EU funding supports around 50% of participation and recommends increasing the EJTN budget while reducing workloads for trainers and judges.

Portugal believes EU funding significantly enhances participation and suggests increasing the EJTN budget along with "Train-the-Trainer" programs led by EU experts.

Romania emphasises that EU funding eliminates cost barriers, enabling broader participation, and recommends funding for training materials, regular workshops, and blended learning, with additional support for digital tools.

Slovenia highlights that EU funding is essential for participation and recommends ToT programs, modern technologies, and supra-national activities that cannot be replaced by national training.

Sweden notes that EU funding facilitates exchanges and specific training and recommends more short, recorded online courses for continuous training while supporting cross-border topics like cybercrime and AI.

6.6 Digitalisation and Training Support

Austria anticipates hiring more specialised IT staff and emphasises training needs, including applications such as electronic file systems, speech-to-text, and AI applications. Cybersecurity, cybercrime knowledge, and digital communication skills are also essential. Austria suggests EU support through EJTN, particularly for online digital skills training.

Belgium plans to hire specialised staff, but budget constraints and higher private sector salaries pose challenges. Identified training needs include the use of databases for cross-border cases, online digitalisation modules, and AI applications. Belgium highlights the importance of accessible, user-friendly education for justice professionals and society to enhance digital skills.

Bulgaria sees the likely future engagement of specialised IT staff, depending on resource allocation. Training priorities include upskilling trainers with the latest technological advances, virtual reality applications, and handling algorithmic bias in AI. Bulgaria urges the EU to fund national judicial institutions and support mixed-audience training events involving legal tech professionals and NGOs.

Cyprus does not currently plan to hire IT specialists, instead focusing on training judges and court staff on digital tools and AI applications. Key needs include training on e-filing, cross-border platforms like E-Codex, and AI awareness. Cyprus requests EU funding and expert trainers for these initiatives.

Czech Republic is likely to hire specialised staff, considering digitalisation a critical area for judicial practice. They propose financial and methodological support from the EU. Ongoing training on digitalisation’s societal impact and regular needs assessments are prioritised.

Denmark anticipates increased IT staffing within courts as digital transformation progresses. Practical, hands-on training in digital tools and programs is preferred. Denmark highlights the importance of localised training tailored to judges' daily environments.

Estonia does not require more IT staff but seeks advanced IT technologies for case management. They identify AI training as a major need, requesting EU support for AI-specific training courses.

Finland does not plan to hire more IT staff. Training needs revolve around cross-border hearings, identity theft, and data breach responses. Finland calls for EU-organised practical training sessions sharing best practices among member states.

France highlights ongoing efforts to enhance practical digital skills among judges. Training focuses include digital proof management and new organisational approaches in courts. EU financial support is requested to bolster training on AI and digital tools.

Greece recognises a lack of IT personnel and proposes training in digital document management and court platform usage. They emphasise the need for EU-funded events on technological impacts on justice delivery.

Hungary does not plan to hire IT staff but identifies technological skills training as crucial, especially for communication between AI and humans. Hungary requests free, easily accessible training and equipment for legal professionals.

Italy sees the desirability of hiring more IT personnel and emphasises specialised technical training. Training should reconcile digital transformation benefits with fundamental rights. Italy requests additional human and financial resources to enhance training programmes.

Latvia's judicial training transition to a public institution by 2025 raises uncertainty over IT staffing. Identified needs include digital competency development and AI conceptual training. EU-level digital competency standards are proposed to address these needs.

Lithuania does not plan to hire IT staff but stresses the importance of addressing disinformation and online scams. They propose EU-funded digital materials that can be accessed at users' convenience.

Malta lacks authority over IT staffing but emphasises basic training in hardware and software use. They request EU funding to support these initiatives.

Portugal's respondents express hope for increased IT hiring. Training priorities include digitalisation, AI matters, and human rights. Portugal suggests boosting budgets for EJTN and HELP CoE courses to address these training needs.

Romania acknowledges the necessity of IT personnel due to the judiciary's digital transformation. Training focuses on case management, data protection, and virtual tools. EU funding for tailored training programmes and resources is requested to address these gaps.

Slovenia sees IT staffing as a future need but does not expect developments soon. Training on digital tools and better workplace equipment is necessary. Slovenia highlights EU funding as vital for training initiatives.

Sweden has a well-structured IT department but emphasises efficient tool usage training over hiring more staff. Key needs include practical AI and data protection training. Sweden suggests targeted EU funding to assist less-developed countries in training and digitalisation efforts.

6.7 Broader and Continuous Training Needs

Austria highlights the need for training on new directives and regulations, cross-border cooperation, fundamental rights, diversity, judgecraft, rule of law, and language skills. They suggest that the broad training offers provided by EJTN and ERA cover most topics effectively and should be maintained.

Belgium identifies soft skills, language training, cross-border cooperation, and more exchanges between practitioners as essential training needs. They recommend embedding judgecraft and non-legal knowledge into national programmes and ensuring newly appointed judges and prosecutors participate in cross-border exchanges. Additionally, they emphasise the importance of tailored e-learning and further EU support for EJTN.

Bulgaria underscores the importance of judicial training promoting a common rule of law culture, application of the EU Charter of Fundamental Rights, and adaptation to the needs of vulnerable groups such as children and people with disabilities. They suggest maintaining cross-border training projects and workshops for sharing experiences.

Cyprus calls for training in case and time management, legal psychology, and teaching methods alongside soft skills. They emphasise the importance of training on cross-border cooperation, EU law, AI, and digitalisation.

Czech Republic states that training needs evolve yearly and require a thorough needs assessment with stakeholders. They value the training activities organised with EJTN, ERA, and EU-funded projects.

Denmark points to training across various areas of law, including family, criminal, and civil law, as essential continuous training needs.

Estonia focuses on training related to AI and prioritises asylum and environmental law for continuous EU training support.

Finland sees the need for AI training and education on the Charter of Fundamental Rights of the European Union. They advocate for 24/7 access to monitored and maintained online courses integrated into existing national offerings.

France identifies gender equality, online hate, and AI as emerging training needs. However, they do not specify preferences for continuous EU activities.

Greece highlights the importance of non-legal skills training and prioritises cross-border exchanges, child-friendly justice, and anti-discrimination events.

Hungary emphasises communication skills, public speaking, and legal language training, along with courses on cybercrime, trafficking in human beings (THB), digital skills, judicial cooperation, and environmental law.

Italy suggests training on reconciling digital transformation with fundamental rights and targeted education on AI. They recommend enhancing existing programmes to include in-depth studies of new technologies.

Latvia mentions judgecraft as a key area for improvement and highlights geopolitics training for a broader understanding among the judiciary.

Lithuania finds it challenging to identify specific needs but emphasises that maintaining all current training activities is essential.

Malta stresses reducing the judiciary's workload to focus on training and values EJTN face-to-face programmes.

Portugal calls for training on cross-border criminal investigations, cooperation in civil matters, and a greater focus on European legislation's impact on national law. They also highlight soft skills, including resilience and stress management, as critical areas.

Romania prioritises public speaking, communication, and human rights training, alongside cross-border cooperation and non-legal skills. They see the current EU-supported training activities as essential for fostering a unified European judicial culture and mutual trust while emphasising digital skills training.

Slovenia advocates for innovative training methods beyond digital approaches and values exchanges, study visits, and the sharing of best practices.

Sweden reiterates their focus on AI and highlights the importance of maintaining all EJTN training offers for prosecutors.

Annex 7 – Interview questions and survey stakeholders

Interview questionnaires

The following drafted questions were provided as guide to interviewers regarding the type of information is to be gathered. The questions had to be still adapted and targeted more depending on the type of training that was offered or the organisation or professional interviewed. Researchers from the study team implementing interviews had a detailed training for this to ensure that meaningful exchanges were conducted.

Interview questions for project managers of training projects

Background information:

Your occupation/job title:

Describe your function:

Training activities you are responsible for:

Understanding project design and participant recruitments

How did you identify and recruit the training partners?

How was the implementation structure developed – lead/ collaboration partners

How did you identify training needs to inform the design of the programme?

What issues does the training address? And how does the training address this, can you provide an example?

How did you identify the specific target group for the training (e.g. the specific learner profile)? How is this target group expected to subsequently contribute to drive correct application of EU law in Member States?

What were the key drivers in deciding about the length/structure/mode of training?

How did you recruit trainers? What profiles were you looking for?

In what language was the training designed?

Did you anticipate cultural bias/ language specific issues if training was only in English? (if applicable)

How are/ were participants recruited for the training?

How did you select participants?

What type of pre-training information did participants receive?

What did you identify as key learning objectives/ and outcome?

Impact of the training

In your opinion, if this training was not available at EU level, to what extent would it have been developed at national level?

In your opinion, how did the training contribute to improve the correct application and interpretation of EU law in Member States? Can you provide examples demonstrating this in your evaluations at the end of the training (if applicable)?

In your view, what factors contribute to achieve training participation targets of justice professionals in Member States (ask for specific examples)?

Support from EU Commission/ frameworks of EU funds

To what extent do you believe the Justice programme provides sufficient flexibility to design training that is in demand within Member States and in line with the JTS priorities? (budget size, duration of the project, topics, focus of the calls)?

What lessons have you learnt during the implementation of the programme that you will apply for future programmes?

Do you believe that the training content and material developed can be implemented at national level or be used in future trainings beyond the EU supported training period?

Do you have any observations or recommendations how the Commission can change or improve its support for training providers? Do you have any other comment?

Future needs for digitalisation

1. Relevant training for adoption of digital tools:
    - What specific training programs would you recommend enhancing digital skills of justice professionals? Are justice professionals open for new ways of working/ change processes?
    - How should these training programs be designed to ensure maximum effectiveness and engagement? Do you anticipate specific training design depending on the age group (better: level of knowledge?) of trainees?
    - What are the key learning outcomes that these training programs should aim to achieve in the next few years?
    - Can you suggest any innovative approaches or technologies that could be incorporated into these training programs to facilitate digital tools adoption?
2. Assessment of digital skills of justice professionals:
    - How would you rate the proficiency of justice professionals in basic digital skills like email management and online platform interaction?
    - What methods are currently in place to assess the ability of justice professionals to handle online calls and use data/text analysis tools?
    - How do justice professionals fare in terms of safe online behaviour?
3. Learning needs for digitalisation of justice:
    - Can you identify any specific areas or specific Member States where justice professionals lack the necessary digital skills or knowledge ?
    - Could you provide examples of successful digitalisation initiatives in any Member States? What learning needs were addressed in these cases? What kind of training strategy was applied?

Interview questions for European professional organisations/ networks/experts

Background

Job title/ function

Background/ work experience in the justice sector

Understanding training needs, effective course design and participation trends

How do you identify training needs within your professional group?

To what extent do you believe the current training offer (national level/ EU funded training offer – via EJTN/ FRA or CoE) caters the needs identified?

To what extent do you believe there is a good range of training provided to those with different levels (beginners, intermediate, advanced)?

How do you rate the current training offer for your profession (national level/ EU level)?

Do you believe the current training offer for your profession is covering their specific needs with regard to digitalisation of justice? If not what are the specific gaps you identified, specifically concerning cross-border legal issues/ EU law?

What are main barriers to develop an EU cross-border training project for the justice professionals you represent ?

What are main barriers that prevent justice professionals in participating in continuous professional training? What do you see in terms of solutions/ support (from Commission? Employers?)?

Do you find that training standards (better: level playing field across the EU?) for continuous professional learning have standardised/ equal level of quality in EU Member States – more harmonisation?

What is the added value of the training being delivered at an EU level for the professionals you represent?

Type of support needed to improve training offer

What type of networking activities would you find useful/ are helpful for improving the understanding and application of EU law across Member States?

Do you see that more EU budget should be specifically ear-marked for your profession?

What is in your opinion the added value of EU funding for training for the profession you represent? Prompts – does it lead to additional training offer at national level, fill gaps in training at national level, create professional networks to facilitate work in cross-border cases

Future training needs

What type of training needs do you foresee that will be most important in the next years considering digitalisation of justice – e.g. to facilitate digital tools adoption, or to train for new skills due to changes in the profession you represent, general digital literacy skills?

How could the EU support best your profession to prepare for changes and adopt digital tools? What type of training/ learning could be provided at EU level?

Interview questions for training course participants

Guidance interviewer: Please adapt the questions to the specific training activity in which participants of the course have taken part, as well to the specific profession of the participant.

Background information:

Member State: (interviewer)

Your occupation/job title:

Indicate your affiliation/ unit (e.g. court in region x/ country):

Level of seniority/ experience in justice:

Information about the course the participant took part; (interviewer from sheet or from participant)

Course design and relevance

Why did you apply for this training? *Prompt for what development needs they wanted to address, importance of the EU dimension, and what other training options were available to address their learning needs.*

How did you hear about the training?

Did you undertake any pre-training preparation? If so, was this valuable?

Level 1: Reaction

To what extent did the course content meet your expectations? *Prompt for whether it contained the depth of knowledge that they were expecting, and whether they felt it contained the latest developments in the area*

How would you rate it on a scale of 1-10, with 1 being poor quality and 10 being excellent quality.

To what extent do you believe the design and structure of the course was appropriate for your needs? What worked well and what worked less well? What could be improved?

[for classroom-based sessions] how would you rate the quality and accessibility of the venue and facilities? [for online courses] How would you rate the quality and accessibility of the platform and technology

Did you feel you had sufficient opportunity to network with other participants (during the course)? To what extent did you feel this was a valuable part of the programme? Are you still using the contacts you made or have referred them to someone (either at their workplace or the workplace of the person in the other country)

How would you rate the expertise of the trainer ? *(prompt for why they rate this way)* To what extent did you feel they had a good up-to-date knowledge of the topic area and delivered the training in an engaging way. Please rate using a scale of 1-10 with 1 being poor expertise and 10 being excellent expertise

How would you rate the quality of the training material? *(prompt for why they rate this way)* To what extent was it well written, easy to understand and linked for further reading?

At the end of the training did you have a clear sense of how you could apply what you learnt from the programme to your work?

What has been the value of the programme being delivered at an EU level (*instead of being a purely national training course)*?

Do you think the course was an efficient use of your time? *(prompt for why they considered efficient or why not to provide a concrete answer)*

Level 2: Learning

How would you rate your knowledge of the training topic before attending the training? How would you rate it afterwards? (*prompt for concrete reasons for the rating)*

What were the key topics that you learnt from the training programme? *Prompt for specific changes in knowledge on:*

EU law and its application

EU case law (e.g. CJEU and ECHR developments)

The use of digitalisation in justice

What did you find most useful/ helpful from the training, and why (please give a concrete example)?

Have you undertaken any further learning (either taught or self-directed) on the topic of the training to further deepen your understanding? If so, what have you done?

To what extent did the training affect your motivation for applying improvements to your work to support the better application of EU law (*prompt for a specific explanation)*.

Level 3 Behaviour

Please name what changes have you made to your work practices as a result of what you learnt from the programme?

Have you made any changes to organisational processes that affect the wider workings of your team and/or organisation? If yes, please describe

Have you made any changes to your organisation processes to increase the digitalisation of justice? If so, please describe

Have you disseminated the learning from the programme to other individuals in your organisation? If so, please describe how you disseminated this information and who to

Have there been any barriers that have prevented you from making all the changes you would like to your work as a result of the training? Prompt for:

Insufficient time to make changes

Lack of autonomy to make changes to certain processes

Lack of support from other members of the team

Do you require any further support to apply what you learned? If so, please describe

Has the training led to an advancement in your career? If yes, please explain

Has your motivation to undertake further learning on EU law increased as a result of the participation in the training? (*prompt for specific example how this translates in practice, e.g. already looking into new training options)*

Level 4 Results

As a result of the training, to what extent do you feel more comfortable when dealing with EU law and/or cross-border issues? How would you rate this before and after the training, using a scale of 1-10 with one equal to very uncomfortable and 10 equal to very comfortable. (*prompt for explanations of the rating)*

What affect has this had on the efficiency of your work in relation to the application of EU law? (prompt: specifically regarding cross-border issues, cross-border cooperaton

Did you professionally stay in touch with other training participants? (if not already asked)

Have you made use of the training material in your daily work after the completion of the training? (*prompt for a concrete example how this was used)*

Were you able to discuss/ ask any follow up questions with the trainer or other course participants after the training? (if, yes ask for the specific clarification)

What affect has this had on the way your organisation deals with cross-border disputes and the application of EU law? Prompt for:

Changes to the quality of work (more consistent application of EU law in justice, fewer incorrect decisions, better outcomes for the public)

Changes to the efficiency of work (speedier processes, fewer appeals which generates efficiencies, quicker answering of queries)

Changes to the use of digitalisation in justice (introduction of new technology-based solutions, new data sources, new communication channels etc)

Do you/your organisation have future plans for changing their organisation processes as a result of training? If so, please describe.

Did you observe longer term benefits of the training provided? (e.g. efficiency, judgement quality – references to EU law)

Future needs for training

Are there any topics not currently available on EU Law where you feel there is a need for more training?

Are there any particular judicial professional groups in your organisation/country that you feel would benefit from more training on EU law?

Are there any particular topics related to the digitalisation of justice that you feel would be useful to have more training in?

Can you describe the digital tools you use frequently. How do they assist you in your daily work?

How comfortable are you with learning and using new digital tools? Can you share an example of a tool you had to learn for your work?

What is the most challenging aspect of integrating digital tools into your work? How do you overcome these challenges?

Can you share an instance where a digital tool significantly increased your productivity or efficiency at work?

How do you stay updated with the latest digital tools relevant to your field of work?

Are there particular judicial profession groups that you feel would benefit from training on particular digital topics?

Are you interested in taking soon another EU training course?

Survey national training institutes judges, prosecutors, court and prosecution staff

This sub-section presents the survey questionnaire for national training institutes and/or ministries in charge of training of judges and prosecutors (court staff). These are members of the EJTN. The questions are centred on the following key themes:

- Estimation of budget on training and development of this;
- Forecasting of training needs and training provisions;
- Staffing levels in training institutions;
- Strategic annual plans for training and how training is rewarded/ recognised;
- Outcomes and impacts of the activities, where known.

Invitation to participate in the European Judicial Training Strategy Survey

INTRODUCTION

Dear Madam, Sir,

We invite you to take part in an independent study aimed at taking stock on the implementation and impact of the European Judicial Training Strategy (JTS) for the period 2021-2024. As part of this initiative, the European Commission has entrusted ICF with the task of collecting evidence and insights regarding the JTS's effectiveness in enhancing the quality of legal knowledge, promoting correct application, and ensuring uniform interpretation of EU law among judges, prosecutors, and other justice professionals.

Purpose of the Survey: The survey seeks to gather national contextual information related to training activities and explore how EU-funded initiatives contribute value to national-level training efforts. By sharing your insights, you will play a crucial role in evaluating the JTS's impact on engaging justice professionals in training and highlighting the importance of EU-financed training activities in supporting cross-border collaboration. Additionally, the survey aims to identify future training needs as we transition toward a more digitalized justice system.

Survey Details:

- **Format:** The survey comprises a mix of open-ended and close-ended/multiple-choice questions.
- **Duration:** Approximately 30 minutes.
- **Confidentiality:** Your responses will remain strictly confidential and accessible only to the research team (from ICF). They will not be attributed to any official ministry position. Results will be presented in an aggregated format. Please also consult the privacy notice [embedded document here].

We sincerely appreciate your time and valuable insights. Your participation will contribute to shaping the future of judicial training within the European Union.

To begin the survey, please follow the link provided here.

Thank you for your commitment to advancing training activities for justice professionals and professional development opportunities.

If you have any specific questions, please write to the study team using the following email: stock-taking-jts@icf.com

SECTION A: General Information

Please provide us your background:

- Your country:
- Your name:
- Indicate your affiliation/ unit (e.g. Ministry of Justice./ unit:)
- Email (for follow up questions):
- Your role in relation to training activities/ EU law related training

SECTION B: Key features of national institutional framework regarding continuous professional development of judges and prosecutors

Please provide a brief overview about the national training objectives (for continuous professional development (CPD)) for judges and prosecutors and provide a weblink to the national training strategy (if available). [Open text]

Please provide an estimation of the annual budget spent to maintain national training centres for CPD training activities for judges and prosecutors. Please explain how you reached the estimated amount.[Open text]

Please provide information on the selection criteria for trainers (e.g. qualifications and experience required).[Open text]

Please provide a brief overview if judges and prosecutors have to complete annually specific training courses/ proof participation in training (number of hours annually)[Open text]

Do national judges and prosecutors have specific days allocated for CPD training? If not, are they paid while being on training? [Open text]

To what extent could the authorisation process to participate in EU training for judges/ prosecutors as well as cross-border exchanges hamper participation? [Open text]

Who is responsible for the planning and organisation of training (CPD) of court staff (other than judges/ prosecutors)? [Open text]

SECTION C: National training providers

Do you provide an e-learning platform for training courses for judges and prosecutors? YES/NO

[If YES], are there links to the European Training Platform/ CoE HELP platform?

When providing courses on specific legal issues, is related EU law content systematically embedded into the course content? Please provide an estimation of average share of course content with EU law related content (and explain your assumptions for the estimation).[Open text]

Briefly explain the required profile of trainers for training courses of judges and prosecutors (specific qualifications required, years of experience):[Open text]

Do you provide training to trainers about EU laws/ cross-border issues topics? YES/NO

Have trainers participated in EU level exchanges? YES/NO

Have trainers participated in EU level courses about EU law and training methods? YES/NO

Have trainers been trained to exploit full potential of e-learning or new training methodologies? Yes/ No If Yes – Please provide examples and explain what was the approach:[Open text]

Provide information who is responsible for training evaluation, frequency of evaluation (per course/ programme), evaluation model applied and how evaluation outcomes are used (best to explain based on a recent example).[Open text]

What training course support/ quality measures do you have in place (judging from a general perspective):

Quality criterion	Yes	No	Not applicable	Do not know
Administration support – provide communication to training participants (questions, course advisory services)				
Administration support – management of feedback after training, request for materials, post course advisory services				
Profiling course participants (to ensure that course is fit for purpose to needs/ level of knowledge)-				

Pre-course training materials offered to participants				
Training materials provided to participants (updated/ accessible after training)				
Tracking of knowledge acquired by participants (post-training tests)				
Individual follow up in case of request by participant (after training)				
Training method standards – format (specific pedagogical approaches)				
Monitoring of training standards				
Training of trainers				
management feedback to trainers				

Please provide (additional) criteria that your organisation applies (if applicable)

SECTION D: Impact of the JTS on national training activities

For each of the statements below, please indicate your level of agreement regarding the benefits delivered by the JTS. Kindly select one option per row.

JTS delivered over the past three years tangible, measurable benefits, such as (listed below)	**Strongly agree**	**Agree**	**Disagree**	**Strongly disagree**	**Don't know / Unsure**
JTS has helped inform the development of your national training strategy for judges and prosecutors in your country					
JTS has extended the training offer on EU law matters in your country					
JTS has contributed to improve participation of judges and prosecutors in training activities					
JTS has contributed to improve knowledge on EU law and improve correct application of it through EU funded projects in your country					
JTS has contributed to improve knowledge about fundamental rights through EU funded projects in your country					
JTS has contributed to better align the training offer to needs of judges with regard to judgecraft across Member States					
JTS has contributed to better align the training offer to needs of judges with regard to non-legal skills across Member States					
JTS has contributed to increase the training budget for judges/ prosecutors in your country					
JTS has contributed to build capacity to network/ collaborate with training institutes outside of your country					
JTS contributed to provide and develop more e-learning tools at national level					
JTS has contributed to develop innovative training tools (e.g. online micro-learning courses, virtual reality learning, interactive e-learning tools) via EU funded training projects					
Training content and material developed in an EU financed training under the current JTS or previous JTS was integrated into national training modules					

JTS stimulated the creation of training activities that contributed to help justice professionals better deal with the digitalisation of justice					
JTS has contributed to provide a sustainable training offer (regular courses) on EU law in your country					
JTS has contributed to improve quality of training offered for justice professionals					

Routing: If selected disagree/ strongly disagree to any of above >>

Please briefly explain why you “disagree” or “strongly disagree” with the above statement(s) and give indication what can be done to improve. (open text)

In your opinion, what enabling factors best ensures that gained knowledge is applied post-training participation?) [Open text]

In your opinion, what type of training format ensures best that judges and prosecutors transfer their skills and knowledge to peers with regard to the correct application and uniform interpretation of EU law? [Open text]

In your opinion, did networks established, or connections made by judges and prosecutors in EU training activities have lasting impact for the daily work or specifically cases with a cross-border element or EU law related element? [Open text]

Did you establish a network that of EU law coordinators for judges and prosecutors? Yes/ NO – if yes – Can you explain how you promoted cross-border cooperation and reach of the network?[Open text]

Did you use EU training advisory tools to improve your training offer and quality of training implemented (e.g. Guidance – Advice for training providers or the EJTN Handbook on judicial training methodology)? Yes/ No – if No – Please explain why not and what other tools you used: [Open text]

SECTION E: EU added value of JTS

In your opinion what training activities/ measures would your country have provided if the JTS was not in place? Please answer for each of the training topics listed below the likelihood that they would be delivered.

In your opinion, to what extent did the training offer financed by the EU enable more judges/ prosecutors to participate in training? [Open text]

Training activities undertaken by your country	Likelihood				
	Highly unlikely	Unlikely	Likely	Very likely	Don't know / not sure
Training on EU law and EU case law (CJEU and ECHR) developments					
Training on rule of law and fundamental rights as set out in EU Treaties and Charter of Fundamental Rights systematically available in continuous training offer for judges and other justice professionals					
Embedding EU law in national law training (initial and continuous training offer where relevant)					
Training on individual rights in the digital space (e.g. data protection, privacy, non-discrimination) and of specific groups (e.g. children, persons with disabilities)					
Training on digital tools facilitating daily work of judges and prosecutors					
Foresee annual training targets					
Monitor regularly training needs of justice professionals and adapt training curricula					
Cross-border professional exchanges					
Provide training opportunities for judges and prosecutors from other countries					
Initial training including cross-border experience					
Other (please specify):					

SECTION F: Support from the EU Commission to implement cross-border training activities

Do you have recommendations for the European Commission to support the creation/ design of cross-border training activities? [Open text]

What type of support would national trainers need to offer more training on EU law and justice training? [Open text]

SECTION G: Coherence of the JTS

Do you find the JTS objectives and priority actions aligned and coherent? Yes/ No – if No Please specify any incoherence or overlap among the objectives and priority actions of the JTS that you observed? [Open text]

Do you believe that specific groups of justice professionals should receive more attention and support? Yes/ No – if Yes – Please provide which groups of justice professionals and why – [Open text]

Do you find that the JTS is well aligned with other EU policy priorities? Yes/ No – if No – additional question: Please specify what is missing from your perspective: [Open text]

SECTION H: Needs regarding digitalisation of justice

This question aims to take stock of the current situation regarding the knowledge, skills and attitudes of judges and prosecutors towards digitalisation at their workplace. Please indicate the extent to which you agree or disagree with the following statements or when these are not applicable (because the process does not exist or tool is not required). Please tick one option per row. .

Justice Professionals	Skills	Advanced skills	Intermediate	Basic skills	Don't know / not sure	Not applicable (process does not exist in national justice system)
Judges and prosecutors	Basic digital skills (e.g. inputting data into online platforms, efficient web-based research, can distinguish fake news, using word processing software tools, email management)					
Court staff						
Judges and prosecutors	Are comfortable to use advanced digital tools and platforms (consulting electronic registers, using case management systems, e-filing, information exchanges, cross-border tools)					
Court staff						
Judges and prosecutors	Are familiar with and comfortable in the use of electronic signatures/seals					
Court staff						

Judges and prosecutors Court staff	Are aware of new technologies to deal with higher case load (e.g. AI)					
Judges and prosecutors Court staff	Understand rules on personal data protection in the context of using IT tools handling cases (e.g. transmission of names, personal information in online platforms).					
Judges and prosecutors Court staff	Understand issues on personal data protection in the context of cross-border data exchanges through electronic means of communication in cases with cross-border implications					
Judges and prosecutors Court staff	Understand key processes to ensure cyber security of justice tools (safe online behaviour, phishing attempts)					
Judges and prosecutors Court staff	Are motivated to apply new digital tools to their work – readiness to change to digitalisation process					
Judges and prosecutors Court staff	Are aware of the impact of digital technologies on fundamental rights (e.g. right to a fair trial, hate crime online, cyber mobbing, cyber grooming,					

	discriminatory AI tools					
Judges and prosecutors Court staff	Are comfortable when working with electronic evidence (e-evidence)					
Judges and prosecutors Court staff	Are comfortable to conduct online court hearings for domestic cases (e.g. by videoconferencing)					
Judges and prosecutors Court staff	Are comfortable to conduct online court hearings in cross-border situations (e.g. by videoconferencing) – including for the purpose of hearing victims who are resident abroad or to facilitate participation of victims who are resident abroad					
Judges and prosecutors Court staff	Are comfortable with audiovisual recording interviews with child victims and using recorded interviews as evidence in criminal proceedings					
Judges and prosecutors Court staff	Are familiar with the new EU rules on the digitalisation of cross-border judicial cooperation (est. by Regulation (EU) 2023/2844)					

Routing: If selected don't know/ unsure to any of above >>

Please briefly explain why you "don't know/ are unsure" with the above statement(s) and give indications. (open text)

Do you anticipate hiring more specialised staff (more IT technical staff) that will handle digital tools/ support judges in their daily work in the future?

What training needs have you identified that would support judges / prosecutors to make use of digital tools in their daily work?

How can the EU support these training needs?

The following statements aim to take stock of knowledge and skills of judges and prosecutors regarding impact of digitalisation in society and law, hence the cases they may hear and deal with. Please indicate the extent to which you agree or disagree with the following statements. Please tick one option per row:

Judges and prosecutors have the following skills:	**Advanced knowledge**	**Intermediate**	**Basic knowledge**	**Don't know / not sure**
Are aware of modus operandi of cyber criminals (standards of cybersecurity, user theft, fake accounts, cyber-attacks, online harassment, online extortion)				
Understand the use of blockchain (smart contracts, authentication processes, crypto based currencies)				
Understand application of fundamental rights in the digital space				
AI legal framework, (regarding transparency, fairness, non-discrimination)				
Understand the internet of things				

Routing: If selected don't know/ unsure to any of above >>

Please briefly explain why you "don't know/ are unsure" with the above statement(s) and give indications. (open text)

What type of training needs do you see emerge regarding the impact of digitalisation on society and the law (legal developments)? [Open text]

How can the EU support addressing these training needs? [Open text]

Next to the digital transformation what other training needs do you experience? [Open text]

What continuous training activities do you find important that the EU maintains? [Open text]

Thank you for submitting your answers. We thank you very much for your time!

Annex 8 - Call for evidence (DG JUST)

Below are the responses to the call for evidence published by the DG JUST in the context of this study:

- **Austrian Chamber of Civil Law Notaries, Austria** The Österreichische Notariatskammer highlights the success of a seminar on European company law held in May 2022 in collaboration with the Council of Notariats of the European Union (CNUE). The seminar improved the understanding and application of EU law among notaries and judges. However, they suggest that clearer guidelines from CNUE regarding the organization of such seminars and the inclusion of online participants in group work are needed. They express a desire for more training on non-contentious procedures and emphasize the importance of expanding training on anti-money laundering and the EU Succession Regulation. They also note the need to consider Austria's specific situation regarding Liechtenstein in these trainings.
- **Supreme Court of Estonia, Estonia** The Supreme Court of Estonia explains that judicial training in Estonia is based on strategies and annual training programs. Judges can participate in trainings abroad through the EJTN. Judicial training financed under the Judicial Training Strategy has improved the quality of knowledge on the correct application and uniform interpretation of EU law. They also highlight the relevance of training on digitalisation of justice.
- **District Court Kranj, Slovenia** The District Court Kranj notes that judicial training financed under the Judicial Training Strategy has improved the quality of knowledge on the correct application and uniform interpretation of EU law by judges, prosecutors, and judicial staff in Slovenia. They suggest that workshops on the practical application of regulations and directives are still needed, and highlight the need for specially designed training on digitalisation.
- **Federal Ministry of Justice Austria, Austria** The Federal Ministry of Justice Austria notes that the training provided by the EJTN has significantly improved the quality of knowledge on the correct application and uniform interpretation of EU law among the target groups. They highlight the importance of training on digitalisation of justice, AI, and combating cybercrime. They also suggest including topics like diversity, non-discrimination, and leadership training in the new training strategy. They mention that obtaining project funding is challenging for small countries and call for more support.
- **UNION INTERNATIONALE DES HUISSIER DE JUSTICE et UNION EUROPENNE DES HUISSIERS DE JUSTICE, France** The International Union of Bailiffs (UIHJ) and the European Union of Bailiffs (UEHJ) are not in a position to comment on the impact of judicial training on the quality of knowledge regarding the correct application and uniform interpretation of EU law. However, they recognize the importance of the European Commission's efforts in training judicial staff and encourage the continuation of these actions. They emphasize the need for judicial training to focus on the digital.
- **Ministerium der Justiz des Landes Nordrhein-Westfalen (Germany)** The Ministry of Justice of North Rhine-Westphalia emphasizes the importance of training legal practitioners in EU law due to its significant influence on applicable law. They find EU-funded training measures very useful for their staff, as they acquire expertise in EU law and engage in professional exchanges with colleagues from other Member States. However, they note that EU-funded training programs have had limited effectiveness in their own measures, events, or projects. The reasons include a comprehensive existing training program, budget constraints, lack of networking, and limited personnel resources. Despite these challenges, the Ministry expressed interest in participating in EU funding programs and mentioned

their current participation in the TSI-Flagship-Programm PACE of the EU Commission.

- **European Training Institute, Germany** The European Training Institute mentions that the Academy of European Law (ERA) conducted a survey among its Programme Department staff. The feedback collected is included in an attached file.
- **Judicial Academy, Czechia** The Judicial Academy explains that the Judicial Training Strategy (JTS) aims to improve the quality and effectiveness of judicial training programmes through standardisation, needs assessment, continuous improvement, a multidisciplinary approach, technology integration, and international cooperation. They see value in building on existing good practices and introducing training in new areas, such as the use of AI in justice.
- **Studiecentrum Rechtspleging, Netherlands** The Studiecentrum Rechtspleging (SSR) highlights that they provide training on the rule of law, fundamental rights, digitalisation, and artificial intelligence. These trainings are open to all judges, prosecutors, and court staff. EU law is incorporated into continuous training programmes, and SSR follows EJTN recommendations. SSR offers e-learnings, blended learning courses, and lunch events, and has recently adopted a new evaluation system to monitor the impact of the trainings.
- **EU Citizen, Spain** An EU citizen argues that the allocation of EU resources for training is redundant and wasteful unless educational materials are made available online for free to the general public. They believe that free e-learning should become the predominant venue for training, as public awareness of legal principles would facilitate informed scrutiny of judicial decisions.
- **EU Citizen, Hungary** An EU citizen expresses that there is a lack of information on the judicial training strategy. They suggest that communication should be improved via national judicial training institutions and that the focus should be on the actual needs of judicial actors rather than theories and long-term strategies.
- isation of justice and the application of new technological tools, such as e-Codex.
- **EU Citizen, Romania** An EU citizen acknowledges that judicial training financed under the Judicial Training Strategy has significantly enhanced the comprehension and consistent application of EU law among judges, prosecutors, and judiciary personnel. However, they note that the impact may vary across different regions and institutions. They suggest that continuous monitoring and assessment mechanisms are necessary to ensure uniform adherence. They also highlight the importance of addressing educational needs related to digitalisation in the future strategy.
- **EU Citizen, Greece** An EU citizen expresses a lack of confidence in the Judicial and Executive Power in Greece and notes similar discontent in other countries. They urge the European Commission to take serious action to address this justified indignation.
- **European Forum for Restorative Justice, Belgium** The European Forum for Restorative Justice calls for the inclusion of restorative justice in the new Judicial Training Strategy. They suggest training judicial practitioners in restorative justice, including restorative justice professionals as a target group, and enabling European level professional organisations to offer trainings and study visits under the EJTN structure.
- **WWF European Policy Office, Belgium** The WWF European Policy Office emphasizes the importance of addressing environmental crimes through judicial training. They highlight the need for specialized knowledge on EU environmental legislation and suggest that the European Commission should prioritize the environment in its next Judicial Training Strategy. They recommend using real-life cases during training, developing train-the-trainer modules, mentorship programs, and online training accessible 24/7. They also suggest offering joint training with

other competent authorities and breaking silos by linking environmental crimes with other crimes.

- **Vulture Conservation Foundation, Spain** The Vulture Conservation Foundation provides information about the Wildlife Crime Academy (WCA), which aims to improve law enforcement efficiency in combating wildlife crime. The WCA offers training courses tailored to different professional profiles and has successfully trained representatives from various countries. They highlight the need for continued training and expansion to other countries, with a new LIFE proposal aiming to train approximately 500 people from governmental agencies.
- **NIJ, Bulgaria** The NIJ's feedback is provided in an attached file, which includes their opinion on the Judicial Training Strategy.
- **European Coalition for Corporate Justice (ECCJ)** The ECCJ emphasizes the importance of judicial training in the context of the Corporate Sustainable Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD). They highlight the need for training on both broad corporate accountability and specific elements for the effective application and enforcement of the CSDDD. The ECCJ recommends using case law as a training basis, defining specific criteria for experts who can be consulted as amici curiae, considering power imbalances among actors involved, and opening space for contributions from civil society organizations. They stress the urgency of timely action to prevent corporate capture of judicial training and suggest that academics can provide impartial sources of training.

Annex 9 - Literature

Here a list of literature consulted.

Author	Year	Title
EU Legal Acts		
European Commission	2011	Communication from the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: Building trust in EU-wide justice - A new dimension to European judicial training (COM/2011/0551 final).
European Commission	2018	Proposal for a Regulation of the European Parliament and of the Council on the European Social Fund Plus (ESF+), COM/2018/382 final, 2018/0206(COD) Available at: EUR-Lex – 52018PC0382 – EN – EUR-Lex (europa.eu).
European Commission	2020	Communication from the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: Ensuring justice in the EU — a European judicial training strategy for 2021-2024, COM/2020/713 final, available at: 1. EU Judicial Training Strategy 2021-2024_Ensuring justice in the EU.pdf (sharepoint.com).
European Parliament and Council	2021	Regulation (EU) 2021/817 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 20 May 2021 establishing Erasmus+: the Union Programme for education and training, youth and sport and repealing Regulation (EU) No 1288/2013, Recital 23, available at: EUR-Lex – 32021R0817 – EN – EUR-Lex (europa.eu).
European Parliament and Council	2021	Regulation (EU) 2021/693 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 28 April 2021 establishing the Justice Programme and repealing Regulation (EU) No 1382/2013, Recital 13, Available at: EUR-Lex – 32021R0693 – EN – EUR-Lex (europa.eu).
European Parliament and Council	2023	European e-Justice strategy 2024 to 2028, available at European-e-Justice-Strategy-2024-2028.pdf
European Parliament and Council	2023	Decision (EU) 2023/936 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 10 May 2023 on a European Year of Skills, available at https://eur-lex.europa.eu
Commission Communications, Reports, and Studies		
European Commission	2006	Communication from the Commission to the European Parliament and the Council on judicial training in the European Union, COM/2006/356 final, available at: Microsoft Word – EN.doc (europa.eu).

Author	Year	Title
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